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India beat New Zealand by 4 runs via DLS method in rain-hit, pace-dominated ODI in Wellington to take 2-0 lead in 5-match series. Chasing 135 in 47 overs, India were 113/7 in 26 overs when rain stopped play, with KL Rahul unbeaten on 26, and the DLS par-score at 109

FLOPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA

A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE. Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in **TOI**

From celebrity feuds to a troubled childhood and years of rejection and heartbreak, Hollywood legend **Sylvester Stallone** opens up in an exclusive interview to **TOI**, P 14

'Little regard for civil liberties': HC slams UP police

Criticising UP police for the unlawful detention and disregard for citizens' fundamental rights in a habeas corpus plea, Allahabad HC ordered the release of a Bijnor resident who was unlawfully detained with little regard to his fundamental rights. The court also directed the state govt to pay him Rs 20,000 in costs within seven days, citing repeated CCTV footage lapses. P 20

PG doctors quitting top med institutions

RTI replies show postgraduate doctors continue to leave residency programmes at leading institutions, including AIIMS-Delhi. A doctors' body blamed it on 36 hours-plus shifts, harassment, toxic work culture and inadequate support. P 10

IT exec shot dead over parking row

A neighbour allegedly pumped nine bullets into a senior IT executive, during a parking dispute outside his Faridabad home Friday, killing him on the spot. Paramjeet Dhankar was in India for a family wedding. P 11

Duplicate IDs found, K'taka CEO admits lapses in SIR

Multiple Form 6s, Pending Name Deletions Blamed

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Duplicate voter ID numbers and same electors appearing on the rolls of two different assembly constituencies have surfaced in Karnataka, following special intensive revision (SIR), with chief electoral officer (CEO) acknowledging procedural lapses in processing applications.

In a clarification issued Saturday, the CEO's office said the discrepancies came to light through two separate lapses in handling voter applications. In the first instance, some applicants submitted multiple Form 6 applications through the Citizen Service Portal during SIR. Since each application was processed independently, multiple Elector Photo Identity Card (EPIC) numbers were inadvertently generated for the same voter.

The second issue involved voters moving their residences from one assembly constituency to another. While their Form 8 applications seeking transfer of address were approved and their names added to new constituency's rolls, corresponding Form 7 applications seeking deletion from the previous constituency remained pending, leading to their names appearing on the rolls at both the addresses.

The cases have now been referred to district election officers, additional district election officers and electoral registration officers for verification and corrective action in accordance with the law.

However, the clarification from the CEO's office did not say how many voters were affected, how many duplicate entries were identified for deletion, or when the corrections would be made. It also did not clarify whether these discrepancies had affected the final electoral rolls.

It attributed the delay in carrying out corrective measures to a statutory freeze on electoral roll changes ahead of their final publication.

THE ROLL MIX-UP

- **Multiple Form 6 submissions** by some through **Citizen Service Portal** led to duplications
- **Applications processed independently,** resulting in more than 1 ID for same person
- With deletion requests pending, **voters who moved continued to have their names at their erstwhile addresses**
- Cases **referred to election officials for corrective action**
- **No disclosure on no. of voters affected** or if discrepancies figured on final electoral rolls

30L gap in Raj SIR roll, local body polls' list

Jaipur: There's a difference of nearly 30 lakh names between Rajasthan's final electoral roll after SIR and the voter list used for the ongoing local body elections, **reports Siddhartha Dutta**. State election commission (SEC) has defended the discrepancy by saying it relied on an older EC roll, rather than the final SIR list. Activists, however, have questioned how the gap escaped scrutiny.

An analysis by rights activist Nikhil Dey found that 26.63 lakh voters deleted during SIR continued to figure in SEC's 2026 urban and panchayat rolls. The lists were matched using EPIC numbers. Women accounted for 58% of these names.

▶'No objections', P 11

Army: Claims of China incursions in Arunachal fake

New Delhi/Guwahati: Indian Army and govt have debunked a series of reports, especially from Pakistan-sponsored social media accounts, in the past 11 hours that claimed Chinese forces have "defeated Indian troops and advanced nearly 50km into Arunachal Pradesh and established PLA control over Indian territory", **report Surendra Singh & Prabin Kalita.**

Army's fact-check account on X said Saturday, "Coordinated inauthentic behaviour exposed. These false claims are being amplified in a coordinated manner to promote a misleading anti-Indian Army narrative."

▶'Verify claims', P 11

Bodies of Bengaluru cabbie's wife, her mother found in TN

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: City police Saturday recovered the bodies of two more victims, Sunitha, the wife of the accused, and her mother Rupavathi, from the forests of Yercaud in Salem district of Tamil Nadu, taking the number of bodies recovered in the gruesome Rajajinagar serial murder case to three.

Seven-year-old victim S Puneeth's body was found in the forests near Nandi Hills on the outskirts of Bengaluru Friday. BS Nemagoud, DC (North), said the bodies recovered Saturday were in an advanced state of decomposition and DNA tests would be conducted to establish their identities.

The accused, S Indushekhar aka Arjun, led the police team to locations where he had dumped the bodies of the victims. The remains will undergo autopsy at Salem Govt Hospital and will be handed over to the families after completion of legal formalities, Nemagoud said. In a series of murders in late Oct, Indushekhar killed seven members of his family.

▶Bereaved kin want death penalty for killer, P 4

▶Sold wife's gold, P 4

Boy's autopsy finds four head injuries

An autopsy on Puneeth revealed four deep blunt-force injuries to his head, including wounds on the forehead and crown. Doctors found that these injuries had caused his death, an investigating officer said. The seven-year-old boy's body was handed over to his family on Friday night and buried at Harishchandra Ghat near Devaiah Park. TNN

Vijay asks PM not to approve Mekedatu dam

Bengaluru/Chennai: Tamil Nadu has taken the Mekedatu dispute to the Prime Minister's door, with chief minister C Joseph Vijay urging Narendra Modi not to approve Karnataka's proposed dam without the consent of all Cauvery basin states. The demand comes as Karnataka pushes ahead with steps to secure land and forest clearances.

CM D K Shivakumar, however, has maintained the project is necessary to regulate Cauvery water releases, particularly during years of deficient rainfall. In a letter dated Nov 6, Vijay objected to a recent visit by central govt officials to the proposed site to assess its feasibility. TNN

▶DKS: Help in distress, P 4

Shivamogga girl tops NDA entrance exam

Shivamogga: Joining the armed forces was **Shreya N Gowda**'s dream since childhood. When National Defence Academy (NDA) opened its doors to women, Shreya from Bhadravathi in Shivamogga district found a way to pursue that dream. She has now secured all-India first rank in UPSC's NDA exam, clearing the entrance test on her first attempt, **reports Udaya Sagar**.

"My family, relatives and parents have been a huge pillar of support in this journey," the 18-year-old said.

▶Missile division, P 4

Imposing Emergency a mistake, even Indira came to feel the same: Sonia

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi has called the decision to impose the Emergency in 1975 a mistake, adding that she believes that her mother-in-law and then PM Indira Gandhi had eventually come to feel the same.

Her remarks came in an interview with British daily The Guardian ahead of the launch of her memoir "Belonging: A Journey of Love".

The newspaper reported that Gandhi has written in her book that "keeping Sanjay (Gandhi) in check could have prevented much of the damage that followed".

> I always feel that Mrs (Indira) Gandhi was a democrat at heart. I know that many would laugh at this, but I believe she was never comfortable during the course of the Emergency. I think it sat heavy on her
>
> —Sonia Gandhi

▶'BJP's rise', P 10

Sonia's comments expose anti-Ram face of Cong: BJP

BJP on Saturday hit out at Sonia's statement on demolition of Babri mosque, saying it has again exposed the "anti-Ram" face of Congress. "From Mahatma Gandhi's conception of Ram Rajya, Congress has now limited its memory to Babar. While Ayodhya is illuminated in the light of record numbers of diyas..., darkness can be seen in Congress," said Sudhanshu Trivedi. P 10

Trump names anti-India hawk Miller chief of staff

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

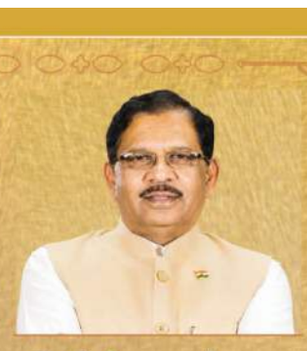
Washington: US President Donald Trump on Friday promoted as White House chief of staff Stephen Miller, a foreign policy hawk with hardline views on the H-1B visa programme who once accused India of "cheating on immigration" and financing Russia's war on Ukraine.

The already powerful Trump aide, currently deputy chief of staff, was elevated after the MAGA supremo exiled the incumbent, Susie Wiles, following the midterm election debacle suffered by Republicans. Trump did not blame her directly, but amid a civil war and bloodletting in MAGA circles furious at the monumental drubbing in midterms, she became one of the first casualties.

▶Champion of Trump, P 17

Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister

KARNATAKA SOAPS & DETERGENTS LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
BENGALURU



Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister

Hon'ble **Shri C.S. Appaji Nadagouda**, Chairman of Karnataka Soaps and Detergents Limited (KSDL), welcoming Hon'ble **Shri M.B. Patil**, Minister for Industries, Commerce and Infrastructure Development, Government of Karnataka.

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After public furore, authorities plan to block only one lane of KIA Road

Elevated Corridor: 2 Lanes & Service Rds Will Remain Open For Access To Airport

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Pics: Syed Asif, TOI

Bengaluru: Amid mounting criticism over traffic restrictions announced on the busy Ballari Road in the run-up to Deepavali festive rush, Bangalore Development Authority (BDA) Saturday said only one lane on either side of the stretch will be barricaded for construction of the ambitious elevated corridor project. The remaining two lanes, along with service roads, will remain open to traffic moving towards Kempegowda International Airport.

The clarification comes after traffic police faced public fury over announcing restrictions on one of the city's busiest arterial roads without first ensuring that alternative routes leading to and from Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) are ready to absorb extra traffic load.

TRAFFIC TROUBLE

TOI, in the report titled "No Escape: Alternative Roads Are In The Pits", published Saturday, had explained how alternative routes, including New BEL Road, Nagawara Road and RT Nagar Station Road, could lead to severe congestion without any improvement in the condition of carriageways.

Responding to the concerns, BDA chairperson NA Haris and commissioner P Manivannan, along with joint commissioner (traffic) Karthik Reddy and other police officers, conducted an inspection of the project site Saturday. They reviewed traffic conditions at Mehkri Circle and adjoining stretches.

Clarifying the extent of the proposed restrictions, Haris said construction activity will require barricading only one lane, measuring approximately 4.5m, on either side of the road. "Both sides of the road have three lanes each. Only one lane will be barricaded for construction. The remaining two lanes, along with the service road, will continue to be available for vehicular movement," he said.

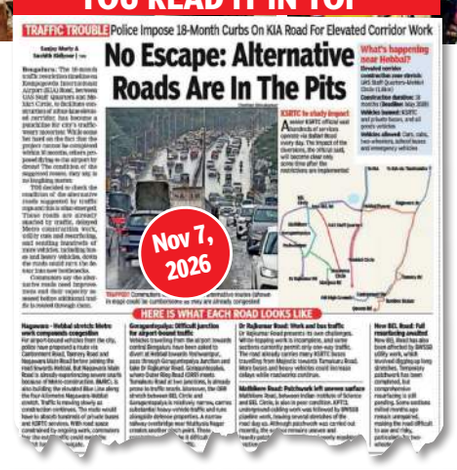
Acknowledging the need to strengthen alternative routes, Haris said commuters could use New BEL Road and RT Nagar Station Road to avoid congestion on the project stretch. BDA plans to repair key roads connecting to Ballari Road, following suggestions from traffic police to ease congestion during construction work.

The roads identified include BEL Road and Gangaanagar–RT Nagar stretch.

Reddy said: "Additional personnel will also be deployed near construction sites and on alternative routes to regulate traffic."

The project involves the construction of a four-lane elevated corridor from UAS staff quarters to Mehkri Circle at the estimated to cost Rs 445.7 crore.

YOU READ IT IN TOI



TRAFFIC TROUBLE Police Impose 18-Month Curbs On KIA Road For Elevated Corridor Work

No Escape: Alternative Roads Are In The Pits

What's happening near Hebbal?

Nov 7, 2026

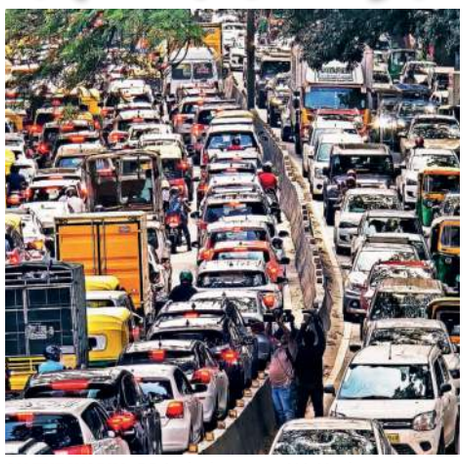
HERE IS WHAT EACH ROAD LOOKS LIKE

Two more signals to regulate traffic

Construction of the elevated corridor will require the demolition of two vehicular overpasses on the main carriageways. Their removal is expected to affect traffic flow not only on Ballari Road, but also on roads connecting nearby localities. Officials said two traffic signals will be installed after the overpasses are dismantled. Construction will then be taken up along the median while traffic continues on either side.

Widen road near Mehkri Circle: Cops

During the inspection, traffic police stressed the need to widen the road near Mehkri Circle to ease the existing bottleneck. The proposal requires the acquisition of 1.2 acres of defence land, an issue that has been pending for several years. Widening the existing road will help improve traffic flow towards both Jayamahal Road and Yeshwantpur. Haris said efforts are underway to secure the land from defence authorities.



ON THE WORKS: BDA chairperson NA Haris and commissioner P Manivannan, along with a senior police officer, inspected the project site even as traffic choked Mehkri Circle area Saturday

Will BDA stick to 18-month deadline?

On whether the elevated corridor could be completed within the stipulated 18 months, given BDA's track record of delays in executing projects, Haris expressed confidence that the deadline will be met. "This will be a new road infrastructure facility for Bengaluru, aimed at easing congestion between Esteem Mall and Mehkri Circle. Construction will have an impact on traffic, but measures will be taken to minimise inconvenience to commuters. **We are not banning public transport (including BMTC/KSRTC and private buses) or private vehicles on this road, only goods vehicles will be diverted,**" he said.

Master plan on cards for Tin Factory jn's makeover

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: One of the city's most notorious traffic bottlenecks, KR Pura Tin Factory Junction, could finally be in line for a comprehensive makeover, with Bengaluru development minister Krishna Byre Gowda directing officials to prepare a master plan for its holistic redevelopment.

During an inspection of the junction Saturday as part of the second phase of Ward One campaign, the minister instructed officials to draw up a people-centric and pedestrian-friendly plan that addresses traffic movement, public transport integration, footpaths, road geometry and commuter convenience.

The junction serves as a critical gateway connecting KR Pura with Whitefield, ITPL, Marathahalli and the city's eastern suburbs while also handling traffic entering Bengaluru from the outskirts. The convergence of multiple traffic streams, ongoing Metro construction and increasing commuter volumes have made it one of the city's most congested intersections.

The minister stressed the need to improve pedestrian connectivity around the junction, especially for commuters shifting between different modes of transport. Road widening, scientific redesign of traffic movements and provision of free-left turns wherever feasible should also be incorporated into the plan, he said.

Calling for coordinated action, Byre Gowda directed GBA, BMRCL and other stakeholders to jointly prepare the master plan. Urban planning organisations Janaagraha and Agra Indians have also been asked to contribute.

He expressed concern over the condition of roads around the junction, many of which have been damaged due to ongoing Metro and K-Ride works. Officials were instructed to ensure roads are restored immediately after civil works are completed.

According to Byre Gowda, around 90% of the works across 43 wards identified in the first phase of Ward One campaign have been completed, while the second phase has now been launched in around 40 wards across the city.

WHAT CAMPAIGN ACHIEVED SO FAR

- 1,035 potholes filled across Bengaluru
- 564 black spots cleared
- 598 tonnes of garbage removed from black spots
- 1,542 debris dumps cleared, with **1,965 tonnes of waste removed**
- 52.7km of footpaths repaired
- 720 encroachments removed from footpaths
- 57 junctions improved
- 56.8km of roadside drains and 10.2km of stormwater drains desilted
- 300 new streetlights installed and **783 streetlights repaired**
- 300 public complaints resolved on the spot

*Source: GBA

Political sparring overshadows civic drive

A routine civic inspection at Tin Factory Junction briefly turned political after supporters of BJP and Congress started making accusations over development works in KR Pura constituency. It escalated into a verbal spat involving BJP MLA Byrathi Basavaraj and former Congress MLC Narayanaswamy, with both arguing over road conditions and utilisation of development funds.

While Basavaraj alleged that residents raising civic concerns were being targeted, Byre Gowda said political differences should not distract from the larger goal of addressing public infrastructure issues.

City eye hospital reports first cracker injury before festival; 6-yr-old boy under treatment

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Syed Asif

Markets get decked up with diyas, lanterns and firecrackers for Deepavali shopping

Bengaluru: Even before Deepavali festivities officially began in the city Sunday, eye hospitals have started reporting cracker-related injuries.

Minto Ophthalmic Hospital has reported its first case of the season — a six-year-old boy who sustained a grievous eye injury while watching a bijli cracker being burst Friday (Nov 6).

The boy was diagnosed with a grade-two chemical injury to his right eye.

Doctors have classified the injury as grievous and the boy is undergoing treatment at the hospital.

EMERGENCY HELPLINES

- **Minto Ophthalmic Hospital** - 9481740137
- **Dr Agarwal's Eye Hospital** - 9594904060
- **Narayana Nethralaya** - 080-66121641 & 9902546046
- **Vasan Eye Care** - 1800 5713 333
- **Nethradhama Eye Hospital** - 9845195898

No family gathering? Singles find their own spark this Deepavali

Mini.Thomas@timesofindia.com

Festivals are often imagined as occasions for family reunions, elaborate meals, and crowded homes. But for those living away from family, navigating separation or building independent lives, celebrations can also bring a sense of absence. Social media, filled with photographs of family gatherings and festive get-togethers, can make that feeling more pronounced.

Yet being single does not necessarily mean spending the festive season alone. Across Bengaluru, individuals are finding new ways to experience festivals — through communities that offer companionship and a sense of belonging, friendships that become chosen families, and personal rituals that make celebrating alone equally meaningful.

Finding A Festival Family

Seeking to foster connections and ease festive-season loneliness, Singles Social, a community for singles and those seeking companionship, is hosting a Deepavali celebration in Bengaluru on Nov 14. Founder Harsh Vardhan Arya said the event will feature festive lights, food, and an opportunity for members to connect. People who are single, separated, or have lost spouses can take part in the celebration. "Singles Social seeks to create meaningful human connections in a world increasingly shaped by swipes and algorithms," said Arya, adding the community has a dedicated chapter for single parents.

The community does not charge a membership fee. Participants share the cost of individual events. "If the hotel charges Rs 2,500 per person, members will pay the same amount," said Arya.

The community currently has about 2,500 members across India, including more than 700 in Bengaluru. "Our gatherings are intended to provide a comfortable, non-judgmental setting, without the expectations associated with dating platforms, and offer members an extended support network, like a family," said Arya, adding, "We also provide women with a space where being single is not seen as being available. After late gatherings, members accompany women travelling alone or drop them home."

Phoenix Family, a support group for single parents, hosted a Deepavali party last week. "Festivals like Deepavali are all about warmth and belonging. We offer a safe, welcoming space — especially for single mothers — to simply relax and feel part of a family again," said Vignesh Balan, founder.

Rather than formal gatherings, the community organises lively, child-inclusive celebrations, with games that bring parents and children together. "The idea is to ensure our members don't just get through the holidays as singles, but genuinely celebrate them as a chosen family," said Balan.

Singles Club India, a community for people over 40, brings members together through festival gatherings and other social activities.

The community, whose members include divorced, separated, widowed and never-married people, has organised festival get-togethers for three years.

Co-admin Srobona Das, a single mother who co-parents a teenage daughter, recalled spending New Year's Eve alone while her daughter was in Mumbai. She said meeting even one friend or joining a larger gathering could help.

BETTER TOGETHER: Members of Single and Strong, a B'luru-based community find chosen family in one another, lighting up the festive season with companionship and belonging.

From Festive Gatherings With Chosen Families To Quiet Rituals At Home, Singles In B'luru Are Finding Their Own Ways To Celebrate

There is no membership or participation fee, although members cover their own costs when events are held at external venues. Events have ranged from vineyard visits to Sunday breakfasts and nights out. They are generally organised around themes and include food, music, icebreakers, games, and alcohol for those who choose to drink. Attendance is confirmed in advance before venues, decorations and small giveaways are arranged. Previous gifts included Deepavali cookies, candles, and cakes.

For Koramangala café-bookstore owner Susan Timothy, 45, the experience of becoming a single parent changed the way her family celebrates Christmas. The gatherings are now quieter. She also invites her household staff, their children and other single women, bringing everyone together for meals, gifts, and time around the Christmas tree.

Joy Of Celebrating On Your Own

Alone, however, does not always mean lonely. For many singles, festivals have become more personal and intentional. The celebrations may be smaller, but they can be deeply meaningful.

Social media strategist Ishita Banerjee, 25, who hails from Dibrugarh in Assam, misses the familiar chaos of celebrating at home. However, she has come to enjoy creating her own traditions and finding comfort in quieter celebrations.

Film director, screenwriter and lyricist Kavita Lankesh, a single parent, celebrates Deepavali with her daughter Esha and their pet dog, lighting a few diyas at home.

Being single has not diminished Saleela Kappan's festive celebrations. Living alone in Bengaluru, she remains closely connected to her family, friends, and neighbours.

She decorates her apartment with lights, particularly during Deepavali, and spends time with her six cats. When alone, she enjoys cooking a special meal, decorating her home or travelling.

Hareeni Shetty, a single woman who works as a software engineer, lights one diya after finishing a late shift. Shetty also cooks a festive meal using a family recipe while video-calling home. Her mother, an elderly widow, decorates her doorway every year, not for guests but because the ritual continues to give the day meaning.

For some, the festive season means a crowded home and a table full of guests. For others, it may be a meal with friends, a video call with family, a diya lit after work or simply an evening spent in their own company. As Bengaluru's singles discover, the meaning of celebration does not have to depend on relationship status or the size of the gathering.

"When you live alone, getting together with friends, sharing food and celebrating familiar customs bring a sense of belonging
Souvik Datta | HOD & FACILITATOR AT CBS

"Living alone has changed the way I celebrate Deepavali, but not how much I look forward to it. I like dressing up, arranging flowers and lighting diyas. I also make it a point to video call my family. And, of course, there's the added pleasure of having an entire box of kaju katli to myself!
Ishita Banerjee | CONTENT AND SOCIAL MEDIA STRATEGIST

"As people get older, being single can lead to a reduced sense of community. Many singles avoid parties where they might be the only single person present. Some do not use dating apps either. In such circumstances, joining a community or group could help
Srobona Das | CO-ADMIN, THE SINGLES CLUB INDIA

"Once we became a single parent family of just the kids and me, the celebrations have become smaller. I run a community for single women, and I invite them over for lunch. Throughout December, we host multiple gatherings for single women aiming to ensure no one feels forgotten during the festive season, as I did after becoming a single parent
Susan Timothy | RUNS A CAFE BOOKSTORE IN KORAMANGALA

LEARN SPOKEN KANNADA

Lesson 8E

Speaker	Conversation in Kannada	Meaning in English
Amma	Enu maga? ooTa maaDade Dabbi yaake tandideeya?	What happened, son? Why did you bring your lunch box back without finishing food?
Maga	amma, nanage ooTa iSHTa aagalilla. Dustbinge haaki.	Mom, I didn't like the food. Throw it in the dustbin.
Amma	haage maataaDabaaradu maga....Yaake aahaaravannu vyartha maaDabEku? ooTa ellinda barutte anta gottaa?	You should not talk like that. Why should we waste food? Do you know where our food comes from?
Maga	kSHamisi amma ,elli inda barutte?	Sorry, mom. Where does it come from?
Amma	raitaru holadalli dudidu namagaagi aahaara beLeyuttaare. bisilu chaLi maLe-yalloo.	Farmers work hard in the fields to grow food for us. In the heat, cold and rain.
Maga	yaaru avarige sahaaya maaDuttare amma?	Who helps them, mom?
Amma	raitaru tamma shrama dinda taane aahaara bLleyuttare. bisilannu sahisi, bevaru surisuttare.	Farmers grow food through their own hard work. They tolerate the heat and sweat.
Maga	avaru hEge kaSHTa paDuttare?	How do they work so hard?
Amma	bhoomiyannu utti, beejavannu bitti, beLe beLeyuttare. aahaarada hinde iSHTu shrama ide.	They plough the land, sow seeds and grow crops. So much effort goes into our food!
Amma	Ene paristhiti iddaroo raitaru adakke hondikondu kelasa maaDuttare. avaru namma dEshada bennelubu.	No matter what the situation is, farmers adjust and continue to work. They are the backbone of our country.
Maga	nanage eega artha aagtaa ide, amma. innu munde aahaara vyartha maaDalla.	Now I understand, mom. I won't waste food anymore.
Amma	sari. yaarige aahaarada bele gottirbEku?	Alright. Did you understand the value of food?
Maga	amma, innu munde nanage bekaadaSHTu maatra tegedukonDu, poorti tinnuttEne.	Mom, from now on, I'll take only as much as I need and finish it.

Answer keys for the last lesson: 1-c; 2-d; 3-b; 4-a; 5-f; 6-e;7-h; 8-g

Winners of the last contest

Usha Narayna | Nagaraju KS | Vijay kumar

Exercises: Section 2:
Translate the following sentences into Kannada. Read out the sentences, record your voice and upload the recording by scanning the QR code below, by Nov 9, 2026 (Monday), 11: 59pm. Top three submissions will be recognized

- Why did you bring the lunch box back without finishing food?
- Farmers work hard in the fields
- Who helps the farmers?
- They tolerate the heat and sweat
- Everyone should know the value of food

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Is govt shifting its responsibility? Experts slam school adoption plan

Sruthysusan.Ullas
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: The state govt's proposal to involve private schools in adopting govt schools to improve enrolment, learning outcomes and student retention has drawn criticism from educationists, parents' groups and teachers' representatives. They argue it amounts to shifting the state's constitutional responsibility to private players.

On Wednesday, chief minister DK Shivakumar, addressing a programme organised by the department of school education and literacy, urged private school managements to take up govt schools and contribute to their development. He suggested that private schools could provide teachers, school buses, laboratory equipment and computers. Schools that help develop govt institutions could also append their names to them.

"If you cannot spend Rs 5-10 crore on constructing buildings, depute your skilled teachers to govt schools. Provide 10 teachers from your school and pay their salaries. Do not sell off unused private school buses; give them to govt schools," he said.

However, educationists questioned the rationale behind the proposal, arguing that govt cannot outsource its responsibility to provide quality public education through school-adoption arrangements. "The state cannot sign away its constitutional responsibility through a school-adoption MoU. Article 21A and the Right to Education Act, 2009, place a binding obligation on govt to ensure free, compulsory and quality elementary education. Any arrangement that uses 'adoption' to surrender public control or dilute that obligation is an abdication of constitutional duty," said development educationist Niranjanaradhya VP.

He also flagged a potential conflict of interest if private school operators or corporate entities are allowed to manage govt schools while remaining subject to regulation by the education department. He called for transparency in the proposed MoUs, protection of public ownership and adequate govt funding.

Educators call for clear framework

Some educators said private schools could contribute constructively if govt established a clearly defined framework.

They suggested consultations with private schools to identify practices that could be replicated in govt institutions. A few schools could first be developed as prototypes before successful models were replicated elsewhere.

If the state govt intends to pursue public-private partnership models, it should formulate a comprehensive policy with strong safeguards and accountability mechanisms, including per-student payments to participating institutions, an educator explained.

'Children's rights first'

Sijo Sebastian, joint secretary of Voice of Parents, said voluntary contributions could supplement govt spending but should not replace it. "A govt that can find thousands of crores for roads, railways and airports should not have to rely on voluntary donations to provide basic school infrastructure and teachers. Children's fundamental rights should come first in the budget, not last," he said.

Shivakumar's comments on teacher accountability, along with remarks by his daughter on the efficiency of govt school teachers, also drew objections from teachers' representatives.

A statement signed by at least 12 academicians, including A Murigeppa, state president of the Save Public Education Committee, accused govt of unfairly blaming teachers for the decline in education quality. The statement said the CM had highlighted govt school teachers' salaries, ranging from Rs 70,000 to Rs 1.5 lakh, while questioning the quality of education, without acknowledging the role of govt policies and systemic deficiencies. It said recruiting adequate teachers and addressing shortcomings in public schools remained the govt's responsibility.

AP Ranganath, MLC from the Bengaluru Teachers' constituency, said govt school teachers were frequently burdened with administrative and other non-teaching duties, leaving them with less time for classroom instruction. He said the state should relieve teachers of unnecessary responsibilities and create an environment conducive to teaching and improving learning outcomes. Questioning teaching quality while assigning teachers non-teaching duties amounted to shifting the blame for administrative failures, he added.

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Grinding stone horror: Bereaved kin want death penalty for killer

MURDER OF SEVEN
Relatives Left To Grapple With 'Senseless' Crime

Rajiv.Kalkod@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: The anguish and grief of the families of the seven serial murder victims in the city have given way to anger, with one demand echoing among the bereaved relatives: alleged killer Indushekhar must be hanged for the brutal crime. The manner in which the victims were allegedly lured and killed has further compounded the trauma of their kin.

Amid the pall of gloom, Kumar, a close relative of the victims and maternal uncle of the murdered Nalini, told **TOI** the sheer brutality of the crime was beyond comprehension. He said the accused had shown no mercy even to a seven-year-old boy, who had done nothing to invite such cruelty. "What kind of cold-blooded murders are these? He didn't even spare a seven-year-old child who had absolutely nothing to do with his alleged vengeance. The victims were called separately for dinner and then bludgeoned to death with a grinding stone while they were asleep. What is even more disturbing is that he allegedly made his own daughter assist him in committing this heinous crime. It is good that police have arrested him, but we want him to be hanged for what he has done. His senseless act of vengeance has destroyed 3-4 families," Kumar said.

He also expressed concern for the 10-year-old boy who managed to escape from the clutches of Indushekhar and his daughter. "The boy will have to carry these painful memories for the rest of his life. Every day, he will be reminded of how his parents and other family members were killed. No child should endure such a nightmare," Kumar said.

Tungamma, Nalini's mother and the complainant in the case, questioned why the accused targeted her daughter. "What had my daughter done to him? She never spoke to or interacted with him. Only on a few occasions, when Indushekhar came for dinner, would she speak to him and ask what he wanted. A few days ago, Nalini told me that Indushekhar was seen fighting with Sunitha and Rupavathi over domestic issues. I had asked her to stay away from such fights as she was not involved. She never spoke ill of him or insulted him. Yet, he decided to kill her.... When police told me in detail what happened, I fainted. Yes, he should be hanged," she said.

N Venugopal, another relative of Tungamma, expressed concern over her health. "Since the news broke, we've been with Tungamma and the others. She refuses to eat or drink water. She repeatedly asks me to take her to the place where her daughter's body was dumped. I tried to explain that even police have not found Nalini's body yet... I knew Nalini since she was a child, and it is horrifying that she was killed in such an inhumane manner. I had also seen her son, the 10-year-old boy who fortunately escaped. Now, who will look after him? Tungamma is elderly and cannot care for him the way his parents did."

WIFE DISTANCED HERSELF AFTER MAN'S CHAIN-SNATCHING ARREST IN 2018

House where the murders happened

A police probe has revealed that the seeds of bitterness between accused Indushekhar and wife Sunitha were sown following his arrest in a chain-snatching case in 2018. Sunitha is said to have distanced herself after he was arrested for allegedly stealing a woman's gold chain in Madanayakanahalli near Nelamangala.

A senior police officer said Sunitha was upset over the incident and gradually cut off communication with her husband. "Sunitha almost stopped speaking to Indushekhar. She did not help him secure bail or assist him with legal proceedings. Her brothers, too, refused to interact with him or support him financially. This further widened the rift between him and his wife's family," the officer said. Investigators also learnt that Sunitha allegedly humiliated Indushekhar repeatedly by questioning his "manliness" and openly ridiculing him in front of her family members. On several occasions, she allegedly vented her anger before her mother, even in the presence of her brothers and their spouses, leaving him embarrassed. Police suspect such repeated humiliation, financial dependence and estrangement from his wife's family may have deepened Indushekhar's resentment over the years. TNN

He sold gold taken from wife's body

▶ Continued from page 1

Indushekhar, 52, a cab driver, allegedly killed his wife and six members of her extended family and dumped their bodies at multiple locations. His wife, mother-in-law and seven-year-old nephew were among the victims.

Police will continue searching for the remaining bodies from Sunday. A senior officer said **Indushekhar** would remain in Salem until the necessary legal formalities were completed, after which he would be taken to other locations where he had allegedly disposed of the rest of the bodies. Meanwhile, investigators have found that Indushekhar allegedly removed gold ornaments from his wife's body after killing her and sold some of them. Police are now trying to trace the jewellery.

Malayalis in B'luru furious after steep insurance hike

Anush.S@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Thousands of Keralites in the city are up in arms over a steep hike in premiums under Keralam govt's health insurance scheme for non-residents. Last Tuesday, 12 Malayali associations staged a protest outside Non-Resident Keralites' Affairs (Norka) office on Infantry Road, demanding a rollback.

Norka Care, a digital health insurance initiative for non-resident Keralites (NRKs), was announced in Sept 2025 and became operational in Nov of that year. It combines group medical insurance and group personal accident coverage. Thousands of Malayalis across India and abroad enrolled, attracted by coverage ranging from Rs 3 lakh to Rs 1 crore and annual premiums starting at Rs 8,101 for individuals and Rs 13,411 for families.

Norka claims the scheme recorded a 99.5% claim settlement ratio within a year, the highest in the country. However, from Nov 2026, premiums will be linked to the policyholder's age, with senior citizens facing the steepest increase.

A person aged 51-60 will now have to pay Rs 35,664 annually to insure their family, while those in the 61-70 age group will pay Rs 48,718. A joint committee of Bengaluru Malayali organisations said premiums for families with policyholders above the age of 41 have increased two to seven times. "The hike is equivalent to looting hardworking migrant Malayalis. Govt has hiked premiums for other policies as well, even though the Rs 5 lakh claim policy has many members," the committee said.

Jojo PJ, president of Bengaluru Malayali Forum, urged Keralam chief minister VD Satheesan to exempt existing members from the hike and allow them to renew at the same premium. He also sought their inclusion in the newly announced Oommen Chandy health insurance scheme.

Jojo alleged that welfare schemes for non-resident Keralites were being changed based on political grounds.

Aswathy Raveendran, a Bannerghatta resident, said she had switched to Norka Care because of its low premiums and wide coverage. She persuaded around five other families to do the same. "The Norka Care scheme was very attractive as it offered good coverage for very little premium, which made me quit the previous policy which I had."

When **TOI** contacted Norka-Roots satellite office in Bengaluru, officials declined to comment. City-based Malayali organisations have sought Satheesan's urgent intervention.

Vacant MBBS seats: 109 new registrations

Times News Network

Bengaluru: Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA) has received 109 new registrations for a special counselling round to fill 191 MBBS seats left vacant in the state after all previous rounds. In all, 153 students have entered options.

Medical Counselling Committee announced the special schedule after 2,000 seats remained vacant across India. KEA allowed candidates who had not registered earlier to apply online and participate. Candidates who have not been allotted a medical seat are eligible, while those allotted dental seats can participate only for medical seats. Students must pay a caution deposit of Rs 25 lakh for medical seats and Rs 1 lakh for dental seats.

Mithesh Kumar Moodukonaje, founder of National PU Students, Parents and Teachers' Association, said colleges have stopped sharply reducing fees after doing so during the final days of the previous round. He said lower-tier colleges were charging Rs 65 lakh to Rs 75 lakh, while top-tier colleges were quoting Rs 85 lakh to Rs 1 crore for seats.

A medical college owner with 10 vacant seats on the KEA list said students who had planned to take a gap year and repeat National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test were reconsidering admission if the fees were affordable.

According to KEA, Srinivasa Institute of Medical Research Centre, Mangaluru, has the most vacancies at 32, followed by PES University Institute of Medical Sciences and Research with 26 and Sri Chamundeshwari Medical College Hospital & Research Institute with 21.

Khader orders end to paper prescriptions

Bengaluru: Health minister UT Khader directed officials to immediately stop doctors at govt hospitals from prescribing medicines on plain paper and asking patients to buy them from private medical stores.

He warned that doctors and officials found violating rules would face strict action, while pharmacies accepting such prescriptions could lose their licences. The directions follow a Vijaya Karnataka reality check published on Nov 6, which exposed the practice of doctors issuing "white slips" and directing patients to private medical stores. The report highlighted how a practice that bypasses official hospital prescriptions has been affecting patients who approach govt facilities expecting free medicines. Khader said, "Poor patients coming to govt hospitals must receive free, quality medicines at the hospital itself." TNN

NDA topper says ambition is to serve in army's missile division

▶ Continued from page 1

Speaking to reporters Saturday, Shreya said she had been preparing for the examination for a long time and had hoped to finish among the top 10. "Achieving first rank is an indescribable joy."

She recalled learning about the opportunity to join NDA while in class 8. That gave direction to her ambition, and she remained focused on the goal thereafter. Shreya completed her primary and secondary education at BGS Central Vidyalaya in Karehalli, Bhadravathi taluk, where she topped her school in the class 10 board examinations. She pursued PU education at Base PU College in Rajajinagar, Bengaluru, before taking up engineering in Surathkal, near Mangaluru.

She will undergo three years of training at the Army Air Defence College, including a stint at Khadakwasla near Pune, followed by a year of training in Dehradun. Her long-term ambition is to serve in Indian Army's missile division.

Shreya recalled learning of the opportunity to join National Defence Academy while in class 8. That gave her direction and focus

Her father, J Nagendra, a retired employee of Visvesvaraya Iron and Steel Plant, and mother Asha BM, a guest lecturer, said they were proud of her achievement. "Right from her school days, Shreya was resolute about taking NDA exam and underwent rigorous preparation. Knowing that our daughter is stepping forward to serve the country fills our hearts with immense pride," Nagendra said.

DKS: Reservoir will help regulate supplies during times of distress

▶ Continued from page 1

Vijay questioned the field inspection by central govt officials when the project remains contentious. He warned that the dam could affect downstream water availability, threatening irrigation and the livelihoods of farmers in Tamil Nadu's Cauvery delta. He urged the Centre not to grant statutory or administrative approval until the objections of all concerned states were addressed.

During a recent visit to Mandya, Shivakumar said 2,500 acres had been identified for the project, including alternative land to compensate for forest land. About 500 acres of private land belonging to farmers would need to be acquired. "For the benefit of the people of Mandya, I have fought during my tenure, ensured that an affidavit was filed in the Supreme Court, won the case, and obtained the Supreme Court's permission to take up the Mekedatu project," he said.

He said a committee headed by the deputy commissioner had been formed to identify alternative land for the forest department. "We have given 2,500 acres, we will give the remaining," he said.

Making a case for the project, Shivakumar said Karnataka was required to release 177 tmc of Cauvery water to Tamil Nadu annually and that the proposed reservoir would help regulate supplies during periods of distress. The project, with a proposed storage capacity of 66 tmc, would also benefit farmers in Mandya and areas dependent on Hemavathi, Kabini and Harangi reservoirs, he said.

Shivakumar also said he had requested that an all-party delegation be taken to the Centre to press for approval. Tamil Nadu has consistently opposed the project, arguing that a reservoir at Mekedatu could affect its share of Cauvery water. Vijay, in his letter, said the Cauvery was a vital source of irrigation and drinking water for the state, particularly its delta districts with thousands of farming families.

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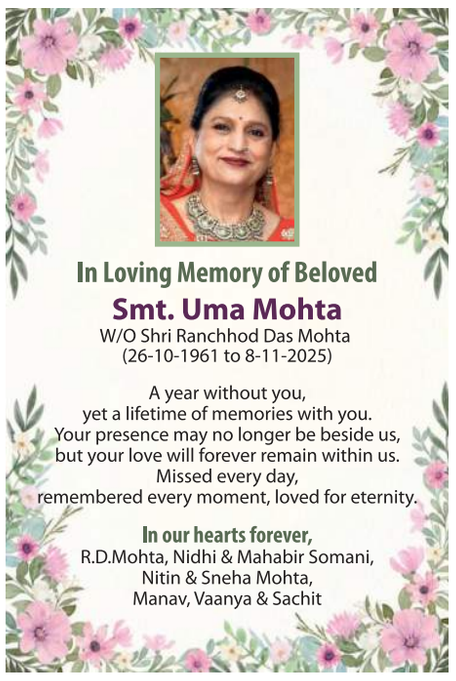

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'Krishna to Kaveri' explores K'taka's art & culture

Vindhya.Pabolu@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: It was the celebration of Karnataka's culture at Bangalore International Centre as children were engrossed in games and enjoyed performances during 'Krishna to Kaveri' festival presented by Azim Premji University Saturday.

The festival brought together artists, performers, craftspeople and audiences to showcase Karnataka's diverse cultural heritage through traditional and contemporary art forms, crafts and stories. It runs till Nov 8. Students of Suraaghavi Foundation presented the state anthem followed by folk dance *Karaga Kolata* by Neladavva Kala Kendra troupe.

The music and dance programme featured *Raga and Resonance* with Ustad Faiyaz Khan, Sarfaraz Khan and Vighnesh Kamath, and *Bhava geethe* by vocalist Sangeeta Katti Kulkarni. Folk artist Rudrakshi Bai led a Lambani dance workshop, while a traditional puppet show, *Narakasura Vadhe,* and a stand-up performance by Raghavendra Acharya rounded out the line-up.

Pics: TOI

CURIOUS MINDS: Children huddle around a traditional board game at the 'Krishna to Kaveri' festival at Bangalore International Centre Saturday

Children were among the happiest of the lot, enjoying the mystery-solving activity *Crack the Case*, a terracotta diya-making workshop as well as Kannada quiz *Sutta Mutta Gotta?* Other workshops explored mixed-media art.

Elizabeth A, an 11-year-old class 6 student, said the games were a hit. "It was fun to watch and play with friends the games that I play with my parents at home. It's so different from my usual weekdays," she said.

Namma Jala Namma Nela, a conversation on water, urban ecology and Karnataka's environmental future, also drew audiences. Exhibitions on handmade silver gelatin photographs, traditional textiles and local crafts offered a glimpse into the state's artistic traditions, while visitors rediscovered traditional games through *Ancient Games, Timeless Connections*.

Mangala Narasimhan of Karnataka Crafts Council stressed the need to introduce crafts early. "Craft awareness should reach children and adults. When they are exposed to new things, we will understand their interests," she said.

Explaining the theme, Sudheesh Venkatesh, chief communications officer, Azim Premji Foundation, said, "We realised that while we had been contributing to the state's socio-economic development through various initiatives, there was a gap in our contribution to Karnataka's art, heritage, culture and literature. We wanted to give back to the state and introduce people to its rich cultural heritage. Many children here come from underprivileged backgrounds and some are migrants, who may not have opportunities to experience these art forms. We wanted to introduce them to Karnataka's culture in an interesting and entertaining way."

Prof falls for fake stock trading apps, loses ₹1.2cr

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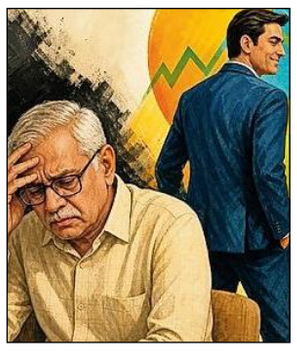
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LURE OF HIGH RETURNS

Bengaluru: A promise of massive stock market returns cost a 65-year-old engineering college professor Rs 1.2 crore after he fell victim to a WhatsApp investment scam. Fraudsters allegedly lured him into downloading fake trading apps and persuaded him to transfer money to bank accounts they provided, promising substantial profits.

Between Oct 1 and 31, he transferred a total of Rs 1.2 crore from two bank accounts. However, when he tried to withdraw his money and the fraudsters repeatedly insisted that he invest more, he realised he had been cheated.

According to the complaint filed by Joseph (name changed), a resident of Indiranagar, he came across an advertisement about stock market investments while browsing social media on Aug 1. After clicking on the link, he was directed to a form seeking his personal details, which he filled in. He subsequently began receiving WhatsApp messages from two groups named 'EQIRUS CONNECT B310' and 'AXIS GROWTH FORUM PP'.

The group administrators regularly shared trading tips and claimed that investing in stocks and trading regularly could fetch huge profits. Some members, who were allegedly part of the fraud network, also posted screenshots of their profits and bank credits to make the scheme appear genuine.

Convinced by these claims, Joseph agreed to invest. The fraudsters provided him with online training and promised to guide him through the investment process using what they claimed were legitimate trading platforms.

They then sent him links to download three applications — 'EQR HNI', 'Y-S CORE' and 'AXIS SECURITIES'. He downloaded them and entered his personal details to complete the identity verification process. The fraudsters subsequently shared bank account details through WhatsApp and instructed him to transfer money to those accounts for trading. They also recommended stocks for him to purchase through the apps and advised him to sell them the following day after the stock market opened, promising substantial returns. On Oct 1, Joseph initially transferred Rs 2 lakh through RTGS from one of his bank accounts to an account provided by the fraudsters. The amount was reflected in the trading app along with apparent profits, reinforcing his belief that the platform was genuine.

Trusting the platform, he continued making transfers over the next month, depositing a total of Rs 1,19,12,000 from his two bank accounts between Oct 1 and 31.

However, when he attempted to withdraw the money, he was unable to do so. The fraudsters instead kept demanding additional payments, citing taxes, processing fees and other charges, while promising to release his funds. Suspecting foul play, Joseph realised he had been duped.

He filed a complaint on National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal and approached East cybercrime police on Nov 4.

A case has been registered under Information Technology Act and Section 318 (cheating) of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Hijack threat: Lucknow-bound IndiGo flight returns to B'luru

Bengaluru: A handwritten note threatening to hijack an IndiGo flight from Bengaluru to Lucknow triggered a security scare Saturday evening, forcing the aircraft to return to Kempegowda International Airport (KIA).

According to sources, the note was discovered 30 minutes after flight 6E451, carrying 178 passengers, took off from KIA at 5.50pm. A passenger who entered the toilet spotted it and alerted the cabin crew. "The piece of paper carried the message, 'This plane is going to get hijacked exactly at 6.30. Ignore this and see the consequences.'

The crew conveyed the information to the pilot, following which the aircraft returned to Bengaluru," an officer said. At Bengaluru, security personnel conducted a search for around 90 minutes. The threat was later declared a hoax, and the flight resumed its journey to Lucknow, an officer said.

An IndiGo spokesperson said authorities were informed and the pilots decided to return to Bengaluru for security checks. The airline apologised for the inconvenience and said it provided passengers with refreshments and regular updates. TNN

Darshan to undergo physiotherapy in jail

Bengaluru: A sessions court in the city Saturday permitted Kannada actor **Darshan** to receive physiotherapy and medical treatment in Bengaluru central prison. Also, the court directed prison authorities to submit a detailed report on his medical status by Nov 12.

Darshan, currently in judicial custody for alleged involvement in Renukaswamy murder case, had approached the court citing severe back pain. His legal team said the pain had intensified significantly due to changing weather and conditions inside the jail cell. If facilities are found insufficient, Darshan should be referred to govt hospital or specialised institution, the court said. TNN

Deeply rooted in Karnataka, says BIAL after activists allege hiring bias

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: After several pro-Kannada organisations alleged there was an increasing number of employees from other states at Bengaluru's Kempegowda International Airport (KIA), its operator refuted the allegations.

On Saturday, KIA operator Bangalore International Airport Limited (BIAL) clarified that the airport is deeply rooted in Karnataka and the state's identity, culture and aspirations are reflected across the airport through its art, architecture, design and passenger experiences.

While it didn't provide any demographic data of its employees, BIAL said Kannadigas constitute the majority of the airport workforce, adding the state govt remains a key stakeholder. "We are aware of the concerns raised around local employment opportunities at the airport and are engaging with relevant authorities and stakeholders to address these concerns. As the airport continues to grow and expand, it will generate further opportunities for Kannadigas across multiple sectors," a BIAL spokesperson said. The controversy began after pro-Kannada group Kannada Whistleblowers launched an online petition urging the state govt to investigate the alleged rise in Malayalam- and Telugu-speaking employees at the airport.

KANNADA ROW

The issue gained traction after a Karnataka Rakshana Vedike (KRV) delegation met BIAL officials on Friday. Representatives of several airport operators, airlines, hospitality and service companies attended the meeting.

"The meeting with leaders of major organisations was the first step. They acknowledged that the number of Kannadigas employed was low and promised to increase it within a year. They asked us to revisit after a year to assess the change," KRV president T A Narayana Gowda said.

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Shri D.K Shivakumar
Honourable Chief Minister

Forest, Ecology and Environment Department and
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Dr. G. Parameshwara
Honourable Deputy Chief Minister

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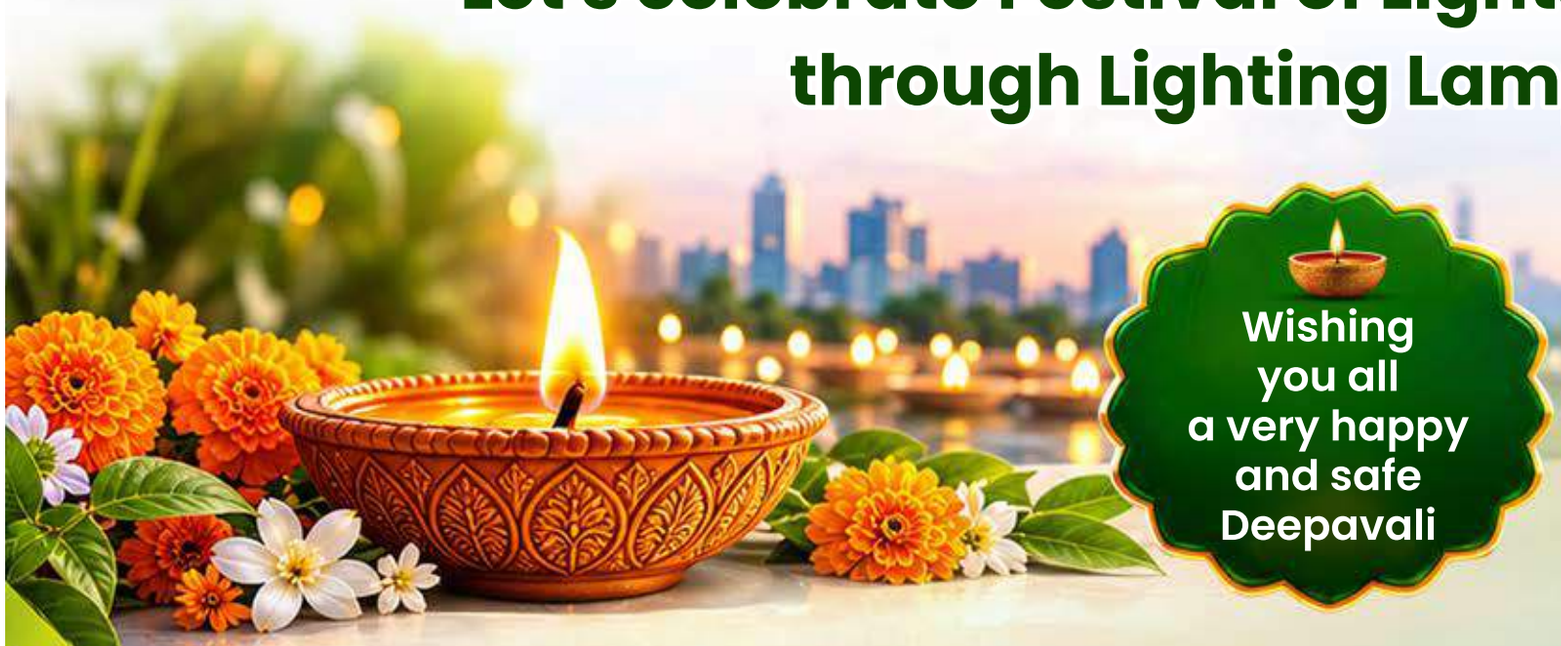

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Shri Ramalinga Reddy
Honourable Minister of Forest, Ecology and Environment,
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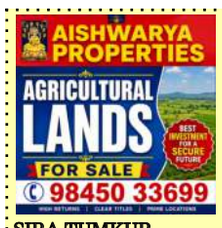

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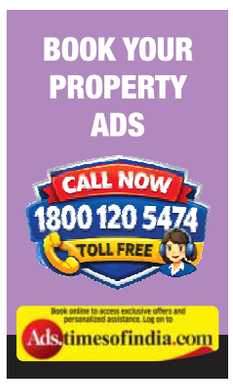

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Siddaramaiah absent at Rahul's Diwali Milan, fuels speculation

DK Shivakumar And Hariprasad Attend Delhi Event

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi/Bengaluru: Chief minister DK Shivakumar and MLC BK Hariprasad attended the Diwali Milan hosted by Rahul Gandhi at his New Delhi residence Friday, but the absence of Congress Working Committee member and former chief minister Siddaramaiah sparked speculation about tensions within the state Congress.

Siddaramaiah, who was personally invited by Rahul, skipped the gathering, citing prior engagements.

His absence assumes significance as it comes days after he reportedly met Rahul and sought his intervention in the investigation into the alleged sting operation linked to him. Siddaramaiah was understood to be unhappy with the probe, believing that it had not been pursued properly.

In Mysuru, Siddaramaiah's son and MLC Yathindra Siddaramaiah said his father had conveyed his version of the alleged sting operation controversy to Rahul.

"We are waiting patiently. I have faith in govt and trust that action will be initiated against whoever is responsible. Everything will be done in accordance with the law, and the case will soon reach a logical conclusion," he said.

Union minister HD Kumaraswamy has alleged that the CM had a role in the sting operation controversy.

Whether Siddaramaiah's absence was linked to any dissatisfaction with Rahul or the discussions during their recent meeting remains unclear. There was no official explanation beyond his stated prior engagements.

Shivakumar and Hariprasad, meanwhile, shared photographs from the gathering with Rahul and other senior party functionaries. Hariprasad said he exchanged Diwali greetings with Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi and held discussions with party leaders from different states.

TOI

FESTIVAL GREETINGS: CM DK Shivakumar with Rahul Gandhi at the event in New Delhi Friday

Yathindra to Pramoda Devi: Mys Palace built with public money

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Responding to erstwhile Mysuru royal family member Pramoda Devi Wadiyar's remarks on the ownership of Mysuru Palace, district minister Yathindra Siddaramaiah Saturday asserted that the palace was built with taxpayers' money and was ultimately a public asset, though it was constructed by the Maharajas.

"Whether it was the Maharajas or govt, it was the people's tax money that went into building the palace. Ultimately, everything is a public asset," he said, responding to Pramoda Devi's recent press conference in which she addressed his earlier remarks on the palace, golden howdah and erstwhile royal family's role in Dasara celebrations.

Clarifying his position on the Ambari, Yathindra said he had never claimed that the golden howdah or the royal throne belonged to govt. He had only pointed out that govt paid the erstwhile royal family for using the golden howdah during Jamboo Savari. Whether the payment was termed royalty or rent, as clarified by the royal family, the govt had paid for its use, he said.

Yathindra also stood by his earlier statement that the palace board and the palace, barring the portion allotted to the erstwhile royal family for residence, belonged to the state govt.

Acknowledging the royal family's cooperation in organising Dasara over the years, he said there had been only a few instances of confusion. CM DK Shivakumar has offered to speak to the family to resolve differences. "Govt expects the family to continue extending its support as in the past, as Dasara is the people's festival or Nada Habba," he said, adding that the celebrations were organised for the people.

HC quashes case against DKS, ex-CM

In a relief for senior Congress functionaries DK Shivakumar and Siddaramaiah, high court has quashed proceedings in a defamation case registered by BJP state secretary S Keshava Prasad.

The case was registered in relation to the controversial "corruption rate card" advertisement issued on May 5, 2023, just before the assembly elections, against the then ruling BJP. Rahul Gandhi, then Congress president and presently leader of opposition in Lok Sabha, was arraigned as accused no. 4 in the case. In Feb this year, a coordinate bench quashed proceedings against him. TNN

Defer KPSC exams until reforms ensure transparency: HDK

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: With allegations of recruitment irregularities under investigation and candidates staging protests, Union minister **HD Kumaraswamy** demanded that all ongoing Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) examinations be put on hold until the commission is reformed. He specifically sought postponement of the Nov 15 examination for recruitment to 319 gazetted probationer posts.

The JD(S) state president said investigations by Enforcement Directorate (ED), Criminal Investigation Department (CID) and a special investigation team (SIT) into alleged examination and recruitment irregularities over the past three to four years had raised serious questions about the commission's credibility. "Given the ongoing probe, I have no confidence that KPSC can conduct examinations and make transparent and fair appointments. Several job aspirants have also raised similar concerns," he said.

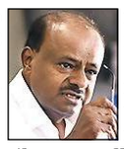
He pointed out a committee headed by former minister RV Deshpande, appointed to recommend reforms in the KPSC, is yet to submit its report. With candidates protesting at Freedom Park, conducting examinations amid such uncertainty would be unfair to deserving aspirants, he said.

'Contractors await ₹39,000cr from govt'

Kumaraswamy said contractors were waiting for nearly Rs 39,000 crore in pending payments even as the cabinet had cleared road projects worth Rs 26,000 crore. Calling the situation "ridiculous", he alleged that a package-based contracting system was sidelining local contractors in favour of firms from Andhra Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

'Govt failed to release crop insurance dues'

Turning to farmers' distress, Kumaraswamy accused the state govt of failing to release its share of crop insurance payments, leaving farmers who had paid their premiums at the mercy of insurance companies. "Making announcements alone cannot solve the problems faced by farmers," he said. He also alleged that CM DK Shivakumar's announcement of an additional Rs 2,500 in farmer relief was intended to divert attention from protests against the bus fare hike.



Meanwhile, more than 20 Congress functionaries from Kunigal joined JD(S) in Kumaraswamy's presence Saturday.

Yellow-red branding must on govt scheme vehicles

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Vehicles and machinery distributed under Karnataka govt schemes will have to carry a prescribed yellow-red colour scheme and the official logo. Chief secretary Dr Shalini Rajneesh has directed all departments, corporations, boards and authorities to implement the guidelines immediately.

The rule covers autorickshaws, cars, other vehicles, street-vending vehicles and machinery. The chief secretary will monitor compliance with the cabinet-approved designs. The move aims to make govt-provided assets easily identifiable to the people.

VHP urges govt not to dilute anti-conversion law as repeal looms

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: With Congress govt considering repeal of Karnataka's anti-conversion law ahead of the winter session in Belagavi, Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) has urged chief minister DK Shivakumar not to withdraw or dilute the legislation, bringing the party's unfulfilled election promise back into focus.

In a memorandum submitted to Shivakumar Saturday, VHP functionaries and civil society representatives opposed demands by Archbishop of Bangalore Peter Machado and other organisations to repeal Karnataka Protection of Right to Freedom of Religion Act-2022.

The BJP govt, led by then CM Basavaraj Bommai, enacted the law in Sept 2022. Ahead of 2023 assembly elections, Congress had promised to repeal "all unjust and other anti-people laws passed by BJP govt within one year". Siddaramaiah reiterated the commitment after the first cabinet meeting on May 20, 2023.

The VHP maintained that the law was religion-neutral and prohibited conversions through force, fraud, misrepresentation, coercion and material inducement

Nearly three years later, the promise remains unfulfilled. Meanwhile, 25 cases have been registered under the Act since Congress came to power in May 2023, taking the total number of cases filed since its enactment to 46.

VHP maintained that the law was religion-neutral and prohibited conversions through force, fraud, misrepresentation, coercion and material inducement. "We urge the state govt to reject these motivated demands and maintain the rule of law to protect the demographic, social and cultural fabric of Karnataka," the memorandum stated.

TIMES interact

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Government of Karnataka
KARNATAKA FOREST DEPARTMENT
ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಅರಣ್ಯ ಇಲಾಖೆ
Office of the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Head of Forest Force), Karnataka, Aranya Bhavan, 18th Cross, Malleshwaram, Bengaluru – 560 003. 080-23346551

No. KFD/HOFF/B10(PUR)/12/2026-ICT-KFD Date: 07-11-2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Karnataka Forest Department (KFD) has published e-tender No. KFD/2026-27/IND0422 Dated: 07-11-2026 in the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal of Government of Karnataka for **Supply & Installation of All-in-one-Desktop Computers and Server, with five years Comprehensive Warranty; A4 Monochrome Multifunction (Laser Jet and Inktank) Printers, A3 Color Multifunction (Laserjet and Inktank) Printers with three years Comprehensive Warranty; and Supply of Microsoft Office 2025 Standard Perpetual Licenses, Microsoft Windows Server 2025 Standard edition perpetual license and MS SQL Server Standard Licenses, across various offices of KFD.**

The e-tender No. KFD/2026-27/IND0422 Dated: 07-11-2026 can be accessed through **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** Interested bidders may download the detailed tender notification from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal. The last date for submission of tender is **07-12-2026 at 5.30 PM.** The technical bid will be opened on **09-12-2026, 11.00 AM** and financial bid will be after completion of evaluation of technical bid.

Sd/- Deputy Conservator of Forests (Head Quarters)

DIPR/CP/YC/3624/2026-27

KARNATAKA STATE MEDICAL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LIMITED
No.1, Dr. Siddaiah Puranik Road, KHB Colony, Magadi Road, Bangalore – 560079.
Phone: +91-80-29619801 Email: md.ksmscl@gmail.com

TENDER NOTIFICATION

No: KSMSCL/EQPT/HFW/DFS/RETND/22/2026-27 Date: 07.11.2026

Ref: Tender Notification No:

1. KSMSCL/2025-26/IND0257/CALL-2 Dated: 07-11-2026.

2. KSMSCL/2025-26/IND0313/CALL-2 Dated: 07-11-2026.

3. KSMSCL/2025-26/IND0366/CALL-2 Dated: 07-11-2026.

Nationwide Tender is invited through **e-Tendering system** under KTPP Act 1999 and Rules 2000 for the following tender:

1. RE-TENDER FOR SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION OF EQUIPMENT FOR DIABETIC FOOT SCREENING & PERIPHERAL NEUROPATHY ASSESSMENT UNDER STATE FUNDS (IND-0257 Call 02)

2. RE-TENDER FOR SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION OF COLPOSCOPE AND THERMAL ABLATION FOR SCREENING OF CERVICAL CANCER UNDER GRUHA AROGYA YOJANE (KSMSCL/2025-26/IND0313/CALL-2)

3. RE-TENDER FOR SUPPLY OF POINT OF CARE TESTING DEVICE FOR TROPONIN UNDER NCD PROGRAMME (KSMSCL/2025-26/IND0366/CALL-2

Details regarding EMD, Terms and Conditions and other information are available in the Tender Document, which can be downloaded from the website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 07.11.2026. The eligible tenderers shall submit their e-tenders under e-procurement platform for above mentioned tenders. Further information if any may be obtained from this office.

Sd/- General Manager (A&P) KSMSCL, Bangalore

DIPR/CP/3613 /AKAR/2026-27

CAUVERY NEERAVARI NIGAMA NIYAMITHA
(A Government of Karnataka Enterprises)
Office of the Executive Engineer, No.02, VC Division, Maddur-571428. Mandya Dist Ph:08231-200282

This office's tender Notification No.09/2026-27, Dated: 06.11.2026 for a 8 No. of Works (Minimum Amount put to tender Cost Rs.32.60 lakhs & Max. Amount put to tender Cost Rs.160.00 lakhs) tender is invited from eligible contractors from KPWD. Tender queries and clarification as per e-portal, E.M.D should be paid through E-payment. Last date of submission of tenders through on-line : As per e-Portal, Date of opening of tender As per e-portal. For additional Information log on to http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in and contact on official Land-line number 08231-200282 during office hours

Sd/-Executive Engineer, Cauvery Neeravari Nigama Ltd, No.02, VC Division, Maddur.

ಬಾಣಾಸಂಇ/ಓಸನ–ಮಂ/ಕೆಮಸ್ ಎಂಎಂಎ/535/2026–27

RAIL COACH FACTORY, KAPURTHALA

On-line bids are invited by PCMM, RCF on behalf of President of India for following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No. and Due Date	Description	Quantity (Nos./Sets/ Cum/MTR)	EMD (Rs.)
1.	05261723 03/12/2026	4 TYPES OF SHELL ASSLY KIT FOR HS. SPART COACHES (PL No. 1) 31103558, 2) 31103560, 3) 33523782, 4) 33523794	1) 10 Set 2) 10 Set 3) 10 Set 4) 10 Set	20,00,000/-
2.	05261730 04/12/2026	CROSS MEMBER (PL No. 33553890)	4112 Nos.	1,79,530/-
3.	13265224A 13/11/2026	Manufacture, supply, installation and commissioning of the following: 1) One complete set of stacking stands for underframe of Vande Bharat Coaches against Drawing No. XA007801, Alt. Nil (one complete set consisting of three stands as per the drawing). 2) One complete set of stacking stands for stacking 04 Nos. of underframes as per Drawing No. XA007601. (PL No. 659056940011)	1 Set	80,500/-
4.	14261030B 04/12/2026	COMPOSITE FIRE EXTINGUISHER	350 NUMBER	3,87,810/-
5.	17261542 04/12/2026	Set of Seat and Berth for L.H.B SLR HOG Coaches (31-SEATER)	45 Sets	8,65,470/-
		Set of Seat and Berth for L.H.B SCN Coaches	59 Sets	
6.	05261543B 04/12/2026	4 TYPES OF SET OF CARLINE (PL No. 1) 33520290, 2) 33536480, 3) 33536508, 4) 33538529	1) 06 Set 2) 14 Set 3) 28 Set 4) 14 Set	1,32,080/-
7.	14261140 04/12/2026	RESIN SYSTEM FOR GLASS FRP PANELS.	54538 kg	2,04,650/-
8.	02261738 03/12/2026	WHEEL SET EARTHING EQUIPMENT **(PL No. 1- 33635067)**	2018 Sets	10,05,900/-
9.	04261084 30/11/2026	SS CONDUIT 32 OD	36196 MTRS	1,62,210/-

1. For details and making On-line bids, visit **Website http://ireps.gov.in** Drawings/specifications, wherever required can be downloaded from RCF Website http://www.rcf.indianrailways.gov.in. Class III-b digital signature certificate required for on-line bidding, can be obtained from licensed certifying agencies listed at **http://www.cce.gov.in., 2.**Tenders will close at **14.25 HRS.** on due date and Tender will be opened at **14.30 HRS for Sr. No. 1 to 8 at RCF Kapurthala and for Sr. No. 9 at Tilak Bridge, New Delhi-110002, 3.** For querries, contact IREPS Helpdesk at **011-24102855,011-24105180 or RCF helpdesk at 011-23378658.**

PCMM

CORRIGENDUM

1) Tender No.: 05261533, **Description:** FUEL TANK COMPLETE, Due Date to be read as **"12/11/2026"** instead of **"03/11/2026". 2) Tender No.:** 13265180, **Description:** Supply of Robotic Welding Manipulator for Bogie Frame and Bogie Bolster, Due Date to be read as **"11/11/2026"** instead of **"02/11/2026". 3) Tender No.:** 7261224A, **Description:** REVISED, Due Date to be read as **"16/11/2026"** instead of **"05/11/2026", EMD** to be read as **"Rs. 1,49,900/-"** instead of **"Rs. 1,37,310/-", ESTIMATED VALUES: REVISED. 4) Tender No.:** 04261040, Due Date to be read as **"20/11/2026"** instead of **"05/11/2026". 5) Tender No.:** 04261079, Due Date to be read as **"20/11/2026"** instead of **"04/11/2026". 6) Tender No.:** 01261258, **Description:** BOGIE FRAME COMPLETE MACHINED FOR VB TRAIN SET (2 types), Due Date to be read as **"11/11/2026"** instead of **"02/11/2026"**

PCMM

No. 080-S/2026-27 Date: 07.11.2026

BANGALORE DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
T.Chowdaiah Road, Kumarapark West, Bangalore-560 020.

NO: BDA/2026-27/SE0142 Date: 07.11.2026

TENDER NOTICE
(Through Gok e-Procurement platform https:kppp.karnataka.gov.in)

Bangalore Development Authority invites tenders for "providing Live Streaming, Multi-camera Videography, Photography and Technical Production Services for BDA Open House Meetings and Project Review Meetings".

Tender documents are available on the e-Procurement portal from **07.11.2026** and the last date for bid submission is **16.11.2026, 2:00 PM.** Technical bids will be opened on **17.11.2026 at 03:00 PM.** Interested bidders may refer to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** for detailed information or contact the EDP Cell, BDA head office Bengaluru-560020. Any changes or updates will be published only on the e-Procurement portal, so bidders are requested to check the portal regularly. Helpline/ WhatsApp: 9483166622 (24x7) @BDAOfficialGok

Sd/- Head of EDP, EDP Cell BDA, Bengaluru

Government of Karnataka
Office of the Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation And Ground Water Development Division, Ballari

IFT No. EE/MI & GWDD/Bly/AE-1/2026-27/1553 Date :04.11.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION(KW-4)

On behalf of Hon'bleGovernor of Karnataka the Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation and Ground Water Development Division Ballariinvited the tender for the work of underHead of Account 4702 Plan work in Vijayanagar Dist., Harapanahalli Taluk 01 Work in Two Cover System Estimated amount put to tender is Rs.304.69 lakhs, the tenderers should download and submitt the tenders from date : 05.11.2026 to 07.12.2026upto 17.30 hours. Date & Time of opening Technical Bidis on 09.12.2026 at 11.00 hours. Opening of Financial Bidis on 11.12.2026 at 11.00 hours. Anyother information shouldget by login the website "KPPP" websitehttp:// kppp.karnataka.gov.in

Sd/- Executive Engineer, M.I. & G.W.D. Division, Ballari.

DIPR/Ballari/2026-27/KSMCA/RO No/595

Government of Karnataka
Karnataka Public Works Department
Sirasi Division(U.K), Karnataka
Telephone: 08384- 223164 Fax: 08384- 224100.

No. PWD/SR./Dn/AE/IFT/ KRDCL Bridges/NDRF/SDRF /2026-27/ 2449 Date: IFT No.: 02.11.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (IFT) (SHORT TERM) KW-4

e-TENDER NOTIFICATION

(1) **The Executive Engineer, PWD Division, Sirasi** invites tenders from eligible tenderers, for the construction of works detailed in the Table below. The tenderers may submit tenders for any or all of the works given in the Table. The price tender which will be opened only if the Tenderer is found to be qualified to execute the tendered works. The Tenderers are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 3 of the Instructions to Tenderers to qualify for award of the contract. **(26.03.2021)** (2) Tender documents may be downloaded from Government of Karnataka e-Procurement website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/eportal/index.seam** under login for Contractors. (3) Tenders must be accompanied by EMD Declaration form Proforma attached. (4) Tenders must be electronically submitted (on-line through internet) with in the date and time published in e-procurement portal. The technical bid will be opened after prescribed time and date in the eprocurement portal, in the presence of the Tenderers who wish to attend at the Office of the Executive Engineer, PWD Department, SIRSI Division. (5) Other details can be seen in the tender documents.

(Total 2 Work)

(1) Last date and time for Tender Queries/Clarifications : **11-11-2026 up to 16.00.00**
(2) Last Date and Time for receipt of tenders : **12-11-2026 up to 16.00.00**
(3) Date and Time for opening of Technical Bid : **13-11-2026 @ 16.30.00**
(4) Date and Time for opening of Financial Bid : **16-11-2026 @ 16.00.00**

Sd/- Executive Engineer
Public work Department Division
Sirsi (Uttara Kannada)

DIPR/KWR/KSMCA/532/26-27 dt. 06.11.2026

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No: DHS/NHM/Man power/313/2026-27. Date: 06.11.2026.

ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ (ಇ–ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರ್‌ಮೆಂಟ್ ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಮಾತ್ರ)

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DIPR/KWR/KSMCA/540/26-27 dt. 07.11.2026

ಸಹಿ/– ಜಿಲ್ಲಾ ಆರೋಗ್ಯ ಮತ್ತು ಕು.ಕ ಅಧಿಕಾರಿಗಳು, ಉತ್ತರ ಕನ್ನಡ, ಕಾರವಾರ

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INDUSTRIAL EXTENSION BUREAU

Request to Bid (Tender) for selection of agency for third party inspection (TPI) in Vibrant Gujarat Global Trade Show 2027.

Bids are invited for selection of third party inspection (TPI) agency for Vibrant Gujarat Global Trade Show/Exhibition 2027 as a part of Vibrant Gujarat Summit 2027. Bid documents can be obtained from website **www.indextb.com** and **https://tender.nprocure.com** from **07.11.2026**. Last date of submission is **20.11.2026 up to 1600 Hrs.** Interested agencies are requested to visit the website for any further communication. Pre- Bid Meeting is scheduled on **13.11.2026 at 1600 Hrs.** at

Industrial Extension Bureau
Block No. 18, 2nd Floor, Udyog Bhavan, Sector-11, Gandhinagar 382010.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No.: e-Tender/2026/39. For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works **before 15.00 hrs.** on the date mentioned against items and will be **opened at 15.30 hrs. Sl.No.**-1. **Tender No.: E-KGP-South-44-2026. Description of work:** Provision of drainage arrangement (Balance work) at West side of Balasore station under ADEN/Balasore. **Tender Value:** ₹ 5,96,10,852.39. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 11,92,200. **Date of Opening:** 19.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-2. **Tender No.: E-KGP-East-64-2026. Description of work:** Santragachi-Amta - Closure of four MLCs (HA-5, HA-8, HA-19 & HA-26) & one UMLC (HA-25) by providing a connecting road under Sr. DEN/East/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 8,75,68,983.86. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 17,51,400. **Date of Opening:** 20.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-3. **Tender No.: E-KGP-East-60-2026. Description of work:** Execution of P-Way works Kharagpur Division - FS+TWS+WCMSC - 17 Sets & DS - 8 Sets, WCMSC - 6 Sets & TTR(TSR) - 17 Sets. (2) Santragachi: Removal of defective layout by conversion of 1 in 8.5 X-over to 1 in 12 of Pt. no. 223A & 223B & shifting of X-over no. 207A/B. (3) TWSEJ- 52 nos. & Glued joint - 351 nos. (4) CTR(P)- 1.122 Tkm. (5) Howrah-Kharagpur - TSR(P) - 1.874 Tkm & Howrah-Amta - TSR(P) - 7.681 Tkm. (6) Tikiapara, Santragachi & Bauria: Conversion of Diamond Xings from 52kg to 60 kg. (7) Howrah-Kharagpur - TBR - 16.354 Tkm under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/Kharagpur (2nd Call). **Tender Value:** ₹ 6,30,53,628. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 12,61,100. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-4. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-58-2026. Description of work:** Execution of the work of Standardization of different type of Engineering Indicators, Boards, Post on track in Panskura-Haldia and Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/HQ/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,43,63,768.41. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 4,87,300. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-5. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-59-2026. Description of work:** Miscellaneous repair works to toilets, Doctor's chambers, Wards, upgradation of Physiotherapy unit, Parking Area, Removed Cycle stand area including Doctor's parking space, Acoustic panel Installation in auditorium of Divisional Railway Hospital, Kharagpur and wall paneling work in hall room of S.B. 03, extension of boundary wall besides Bungalow no. 633 under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Settlement/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 84,28,756.99. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 1,68,600. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-6. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-60-2026. Description of work:** Execution of the work of (i) Through Sleeper Renewal (TSR) Primary (P) of 27.353 TKm in Tamluk - Digha section (ii) Through Sleeper Renewal (TSR) Primary (P) of 6.978 TKm in Panskura - Haldia section and (iii) Through Rail Renewal (TRR) Primary (P) of 13.711 TKm in Panskura - Haldia section under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/HQ/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 13,16,58,314.29. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 26,33,200. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Tender Document Cost:** ₹ 0 (for all). **Completion period of the work:** 12 months (for all). **Bidding start date:** From 05.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 19.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 1), from 06.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 20.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 2) & from 12.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 26.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 3 to 6) . Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ descriptions/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for these works will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-988)**

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SCAN FOR STORES

Koramangala: Plot 36, 6th Block 100 Feet Rd Venkappa Garden, Koramangala, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560095, Contact- 9769921556

Jayanagar: Shravanee Premier, Ashoka Pillar Rd, 2nd Block, Jayanagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560011 Contact - 7039736551

Banashankari: JSS Tower, 100 Ft Road Outer Ring Rd, 3rd Stage, Banashankari, Bengaluru, - 560085 , Contact- 9833008629

R R Nagar: 30, Uttarahalli, Kengeri Road, Channasandra, Rajeshwari Nagar, - 560098, Contact - 08065935500

Rajaji Nagar: 721, Modi Hospital Rd, opposite Kadamba Veg Restaurant, Manjunath Nagar, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560086 Contact-08065472600

Marathahalli: Rajatha Plaza, Marathahalli Village, Old Airport Road, varthur Main Rd, Hobli, bengaluru - 560037 Contact-9833009237

Raghuvanahalli Kanakpura Road: 6/3 Shivaganga Sai Raksha, Raghuvanahalli, Kanakpura Main Road, Bengaluru 560062, Contact - 08065411300

Bommasandra: RS GARDENS, No. 55, Attibele Hobli, opposite SKF, RS Gardens, Vidyanagar, Bommasandra, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560099 Contact - 9769907759

Nelamangala Ground Floor, Sy No. 122/3, 122/4, Nelamangala, BH Road, Arisinakunte Village,Kasaba Hobli, Bengaluru, Bengaluru Rural, Karnataka, 562123

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Father natural guardian, but can't take forced custody: Madras HC

Chennai: A father is a natural guardian but cannot take forcible custody of his children, Madras high court has observed, ordering a Puducherry man to hand back his two-and-a-half-year-old child to his estranged wife, **reports Sureshkumar k**. "Though the husband is the father and natural guardian of the child who is just about 2 ½ years old, the custody of the minor child cannot be taken by force and it must be sought in accordance with the procedure established by law," Justices A D Jagadish Chandira and B Karthikeyan said Thursday.

KARNATAKA HOUSING BOARD
3rd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, Bengaluru.

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Karnataka Housing Board invite tender from the eligible Pre qualified contractors & willing to Pre qualify in Karnataka Housing Board through KPP portal for below mentioned work.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Work Indent & IFT No.	Amount put to tender (in Rs.)	Last date of submission of bid
1.	Construction of New Creation & Renovation at Government First Grade Degree College at Koppal in Koppal District under PM USHA 2024-25 Scheme.	Tender Reference No. KHB/ 2026-27/BD/ WORK_INDENT 826 & IFT No. 93/2026-27, Date: 07.11.2026	2,15,03,388/-	07.12.2026 Upto 4.00 PM

For further information, contact below mentioned Office Address:
Executive Engineer, Karnataka Housing Board, Head Office, Cauvery Bhavan, Bengaluru.
Telephone No.: 080-22273511 / 080-22100077. Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in
DIPR/CP/YC/3627/2026-27 Sd/- Executive Engineer, KHB, Head Office, Bengaluru

Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF MINES & GEOLOGY
Office of the Director, No. 49, Khanija Bhavan, South Block, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560 001 Phone No:22384134/35

No. DMG-17012/26/2025/2026-27 Dated: 05.11.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Department of Mines and Geology is calling tender for auction of Seized iron ore at Karnakata state mineral corporation limited. Mining lease no 2629 under notification through MSTC.

Eligibility conditions, terms and conditions, date and time for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Separate Lot wise auction notifications are published in MSTC portal. Tender Documents, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process of respective lots shall be available in electronic form only at the website of MSTC Ltd. **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/aucsearch/search.jsp**

The auction of Iron ore for each lot is "AS IS WHERE IS AND NO COMPLAINT BASIS". The interested bidders shall ascertain the quantity and quality of the Iron ore before participation. The Department is not responsible for any dispute arising after confirmation of the bid. Interested bidders may visit the MSTC Ltd website.

Sd/-
Director,
Department of Mines & Geology
DIPR/CP/3595/NR/2026-27

Long hours, toxic culture drive PG docs to quit top institutes

AIIMS-Delhi Alone Reported 34 Junior Resident Exits in 2025: RTI

Anuja.Jaiswal@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Postgraduate doctors are walking away from residency programmes at some of India's leading medical institutions. RTI replies show exits across All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) campuses and Jawaharlal Institute of Postgraduate Medical Education and Research (JIPMER), with AIIMS-Delhi alone reporting 34 junior resident departures in 2025.

While several institutes lack consolidated data on psychiatric counselling or workplace stress among residents, Dr Lakshya Mittal, chairperson of United Doctors Front, said multiple RTI applications filed by its members had revealed PG doctors quitting premier medical institutions despite securing top NEET-PG ranks.

He cited complaints of duties extending beyond 36 hours, workplace harassment, toxic work culture, and inadequate support.

"Residency is meant to train doctors, not break them. Discipline is not humiliation and dedication is not exploitation," Mittal said, urging authorities to enforce working-hour regulations, establish independent grievance-redressal mechanisms, and fix institutional accountability. United Doctors Front has also filed a PIL in Supreme Court in this regard.

Figures from individual institutions show while departures have continued, some of them have reported a decline. At AIIMS-Delhi, 34 junior resident doctors quit in 2025, compared with 60 in 2024 — a decline of about 43%. The number of residents joining also fell, from 324 in 2024 to 267 in 2025.

Residency is meant to train doctors, not break them, United Doctors Front chairperson said

Department-wise figures show the highest number of exits from anaesthesiology at seven, followed by ophthalmology at six. Surgery reported three exits, as did pathology. Ophthalmology had recorded 14 exits in 2024.

JIPMER, Puducherry, also reported a decline in resignations. A combined count of departures from its Jan and July batches shows that 44 residents resigned in 2025, compared with 60 in 2024, a fall of nearly 27%. However, exits continued across several specialities, including anaesthesiology, emergency medicine, orthopaedics, pathology and surgery. AIIMS-Kalyani reported 15 exits across all three years of PG training in 2025, including 13 from the January and July batches. Another 11 students from the 2026 batches had left by the time of its RTI reply. AIIMS-Raipur reported 19 exits from its 2025 batches, AIIMS-Patna 12, while AIIMS-Gorakhpur also reported departures. At AIIMS-Rishikesh, 30 students across various PG and super-specialty programmes left in 2025.

The RTI also sought details of psychiatric counselling and asked whether stress, depression or sleep deprivation were recorded as reasons for leaving. AIIMS-Delhi said it had no compiled counselling data, while AIIMS-Rishikesh reported six postgraduate students receiving psychiatric counselling in 2026, though it had no consolidated record of workplace-related stress.

BJP targets Sonia over Babri remark

New Delhi: BJP on Saturday hit out at Sonia Gandhi over her statement that she had cried witnessing the demolition of Babri mosque, which stood at the site that is now home to Ram temple in Ayodhya, and said it has again exposed the "anti-Ram" face of Congress.

"From Mahatma Gandhi's conception of Ram Rajya, Congress has now limited its memory to Babar. While Ayodhya is illuminated in the light of record numbers of diyas on the eve of Diwali, darkness can be seen in Congress," BJP's Sudhanshu Trivedi said. Accusing Congress of being double-faced, Sudhanshu said Rajiv Gandhi had started his unsuccessful campaign to retain office in the 1989 election from Ayodhya and promising Ram Rajya, while his widow Sonia Gandhi is now remembered for crying at the killings of suspected terrorists in the Batla House encounter and the demolition of Babri mosque. TNN

Sonia says Congress complacency partly contributed to BJP's rise and Hindutva politics

▶Continued from page 1

According to the daily, Gandhi recalled crying as she witnessed the demolition of Babri Masjid on TV in December 1992. She said that she knew then that they faced "a long battle for the secular nation that Mahatma Gandhi, Nehru and their colleagues had striven to build".

She accepted that failures of her own party had in part contributed to the rise of BJP and its Hindutva politics, the daily reported. "I think we have been too complacent in many ways. There was a laissez-faire kind of an attitude," she was quoted as saying.

Reflecting on the Emergency era, Gandhi said, "I always feel that Mrs (Indira) Gandhi was a democrat at heart. I know that many would laugh at this, but I believe she was never comfortable during the course of the Emergency. I think it sat heavy on her."

According to Sonia, the family was split on the decision to impose the Emergency. Her husband Rajiv Gandhi was against the move, telling his mother to wait for the next election, but her younger son Sanjay pushed for it. In another interview published in The Hindu on Saturday, Sonia said, "It was not only Sanjay, though in the public mind he is often seen as synonymous with the Emergency. There was a lot of pressure from some of her senior colleagues, and I think there were very few people around her like Rajiv who had a different point of view. I think eventually my mother-in-law began to understand the situation through her own wisdom and took actions to remedy it.

"It was only after the Emergency that I came to know about the true gravity of what had been happening. Yes, democratic rights had been curtailed, and there was a suspension of habeas corpus, but it was done constitutionally," the former Congress chief said.

"Yet, when I take myself back to that period and try and see it from Mrs Gandhi's point of view, I see her struggling to cope with the rapidly deteriorating prevailing circumstances....," Gandhi said. "Hindsight allows us to put things in perspective," she added.

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SECOND MARRIAGE

PQM4 Jaipur based Shwetambar Jain Issueless Divorcee 44, 5'7" CA in own business, 4LPM. Upper CNB. W/app BHP 9899315625

BY LANGUAGE

MARATHI/ KONKANI

MBA(US) BE 6 ft 86 born Maratha US based professional seeks life partner in the US or with US work/student visa to settle in the US. +919987673105

PUNJABI

ALLIANCE invited from an affluent Business family for their fair handsome Punjabi Khatri Computer Engg (US) boy 31 years, 6'2", working in Mumbai. Seeking a well qualified girl from an affluent family. Mob.: 9152529148. Email: skcon23@gmail.com

PUNJABI-BOY, 5'7" 1990, job in Bangalore, seeks Punjabi girl Working in Bangalore or Bangalore resident. 9897210059/ 9258621070

PUNJABI Arora Fmly A'bad Seeks B'ful Slim Edu Girl For Elder Son 30/5'6"/ 65kg 80 LPA Settled in Fmly Eng. Business. # 9099025798

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

PQM4 Kayastha bachelor 36/5'11" B.Tech(NSIT) Asst. Director in rptd MNC (Ireland). Cultured & highly educated south delhi based bengali family. sg3210@gmail.com

AGGARWAL boy, 33 yrs (1993), 5'11", MSc Computer Sci, working in Munich, Germany. Seeks professionally qualified girl willing to settle in Germany. Ph: 9313188666

SM4 Gupta 33/5'10 Soft Ware Engineer USA on H1B visa. Pref girl working/Studying in USA. All upper caste Jain, Khatri accepted. 8795810135

VERY Religious. Strict vegetarian Age 57/ 5'11"/ Never married. Interested can Contact on WhatsApp: +15166035067, USA.

BY COMMUNITY

RAJPUT

IIM, NIT pass out Dec 90 born, 5' 2" Sr. Mgr in MNC, 55+ lakh package seeks alliance from equivalent qualified person, preferably Kumaoni, Garhwali, Himachali, Rajput cont.9358671358

BY PROFESSION

DOCTORS

SM4 b'ful Hindu div., 52/5'3"/58kg, BDS, MSc, pract. dentist. Seeks WELL-SETTLED PROF. match, 50-60 yrs, Delhi/NCR based. 9811260416.

SUITABLE MATCH FOR A GIRL
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Currently Senior Resident at GMC Kozhikode. Belongs to a respectable Punjabi family from Mumbai. Father is into Construction Business, Brother is Deputy Commissioner (IRS). Looking for a highly qualified professional (Medical/Civil Services/Business) from a Cultured Background. Pref : 5'7"+, Age : 29-33 Yrs.
Call: 9820053170
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MBA/CA

PQM4 Btech+MBA girl, working MNC Bangkok, 80 lakhs+; Dob: 8-Oct-90,7:39 AM, Delhi; #9818839789

BY RELIGION

HINDU

WELL Settled groom from elite business/affluent family be a top rank corporate professional from Rajput uppercaste for good looking 31yrs, 5'8", successful corporate professional BE, CS belonging to reputed business family 8770148091, 6268474143

BENGALI Hindu Girl 40/5'3" fair N'veg BE MBA IIM w'kng MNC Sr. position can relocate. Seeks suitable Hindu groom. M.No. 9892115895

MUSLIM

ALLIANCE invited for a 27-year-old, 5'9" tall, Well-cultured Sunni Muslim girl from an educated and respectable family. B.Com Graduate, Professional International Sports Player, currently serving in the Central Government's Income Tax Department. Well-mannered with strong family values and an excellent upbringing. Seeking a suitable, well-settled groom from an educated, cultured and respectable family. Interested families may contact with a detailed profile & photograph at: 98451 65132

GENERAL

CASTE NO BAR

SUPER superspecialist M.D, DM doctor working in Bangalore 40 lakhs PA upper middle class Hindu 34years /155 cm, fair, slim, seeks suitable groom with good habit preferable doctor, caste no bar. Contact 9845522122

NAIDU Girl Ph.D, cultured, 36,165cm respectable family seeks a qualified well settled groom not later than 1988. Caste no bar. Divorcees please excuse . Ct 9790908109

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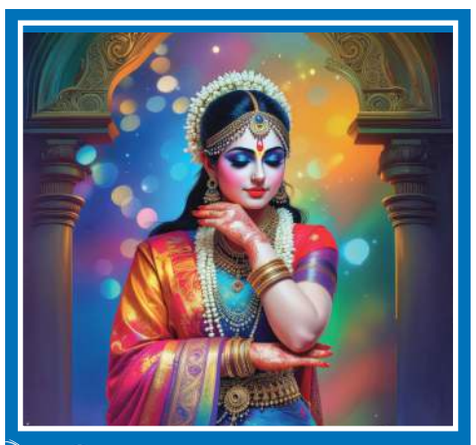

WANTED BRIDES

MATRIMONIALS

WANTED BRIDES

BY CASTE

BRAHMIN

ALLIANCE invited for USA based, 32/5'11", MS (Finance),H-1B, well-settled finance professional from a reputed Sanadya Brahmin family.Seeking educated, compatible bride, preferably USA-based or willing to relocate. Contact:9425093237

TAMIL, BRAHMIN KashyapaGotharam,51 years, tall, good physique,single,IT Sr Manager,earning 70-80 lakh PA well to do seeking a suitable unmarried bride from any Brahmin community,currently settled in Bangalore call Mob:9900359142 Ramakrishnan

SM4 Bangalore based Brahmin boy, Vishwamitra Gotram, 37/5'5"/30 lakhs/B.Tech/MNC, Divorce Issue less, seeks Qualified, Smartha/Madhva, Working Girl, mobile +919535146385

SM4 SRIVASTAVA 29/5'10" BTech NIT PGDM IMI Delhi, Sr Cons. MNC GGN 20LPA Seeks PQL bride Mob: 9717394875 rvmat09@gmail.com

1984 Born,Karan,5' 9",BTech IITD,60+lpa Delhi,Veg. Share biodata -shadee.munger@gmail.com , 6201552582/ 9900640222

SM4 MBA Finance Boy 34/ 5'7"Manager MNC GURGOAN Fmly. in Varanasi PRO. QULFD.Girl Kayastha/Caste no Bar. Whatsapp 9450533020

VAISH

SM4 Kesarwani Gupta unmarried boy, Jul 90 born/ 5'-8", MCA, working as Free Lancer 12 to 15 LPA. 84272-76447. bureau excuse.

BY PROFESSION

ENGINEERS

DOCTORS

PQM employed/ employable in UK, for 31/5'11'' handsome Brahmin doctor in UK NHS 60LPA, pursuing MRCP. Well educated Punjabi family based in Delhi, Father retd IRS, WA 9969232994

URGENT matrimonial Doc Boy SMP invite alliance for Their DOC Son MBBS, MD (Anesthesia). 34 yrs, MD, MS from DNB doctor decent 5.4, Bride should be Educated family (Only Doctors please) Call / WA 9985139479.

SRIV, H'some fair Boy 96/6'/MD Psychiatry, SR, Doctors Lucknow family seeks UC Hindu b'ful 5'2"+, 96+, MD/ MS Girl.#9936466883,9415016997

BY RELIGION

HINDU

ANY Caste Telugu Hyd-based affluent business family for only child 31, 170cm, PG, into business Suitable bride Ph:9030627750

HINDU doctor, 67, 173 cm healthy, teetotaler settled abroad looking for well educated Hindu lady no issues: S.N- 9447580176

SIKH

SM 4 Sikh(Rmgr) Clean Shave Boy, US Ctzn, Cmptr Prgr working as Data Scientist, 32Yrs/5'9", Parents retired, only elder sister married, Seeks educated girl. Cast No Bar. Ph. +1(201)245-7455. Email: SinghP@Live.com

GENERAL

CASTE NO BAR

DIVORCEE Male, 48 yrs, Tamil, Engg. Graduate, well settled in Bangalore seeks suitable CNB Girl. Contact: 8310509368.

B.TECH 29yrs, MGR CPSU Chennai 20LPA.Low Vision. Seeks Prof.Qual girl. Preferable without disability. 9663426921

COSMOPOLITAN

SM4 MUMBAI Based 29/179 Master's in Engineering UK handsome Kayastha boy in GOI research project 5Lpa seeks Gori beautiful caring MBBS girl cast no bar. Contact 9969013289/pradeepdob@gmail.com

WANTED GROOMS

WANTED GROOMS

BY CASTE

BRAHMIN

SM4 B'ful Brahmin, Sep94/5', MBA Healthcare(Germany), BDS(Mumbai), Nadi-Aadi, Jestha-03, Rasi-Scorpio, Wrk Mumbai pharma Comp. Seeks well-settled Brahmin/upper class 31-36yrs. Mail: RP37.NAUTIYAL@GMAIL.COM , 9869449736(WA)

PRETTY Cosmo girl 91 born 5' 7", convent educated, masters. Brahmin. Occasional non-veg. Gentle, Caring, respects values. Gainfully employed with 6 fig monthly salary. Seeking similar. Bangalore based Hindu males. Open to O/S relocation Other than USA. 9606846554

B.TECH, Masters in Mngmt (France) b'ful, V.fair Brahmin girl 32/5'4" working in Germany seek qlfd well settled groom # 7303458181 Noida

LOOKING for a Well Educated Settled Groom for Our Qualified Bengali Daughter. Second Marriage. Contact 9936998443.

MS of USA girl medium complexion 5'6" Oct 98 H1B working in leading pharma in seattle seeks H1B holder. Ct.73389 77550 ,9840197694. bana1998@gmail.com

KAYASTHA

MBBS, MD Ansth Tata Kay. 22.7.87/ 5'2" Mum, D. dib fel' Cardio & C care Apollo Hyd. MRCP 1 & ll, now joined Hinduja, prf MD Dr, IT in 43 yrs, Brahmin/ Baidya/ Kay groom. sinhaassociates27@gmail.com 9821212409

SM4 Doc(Pediatric) 5'4"/27 btfl girl. Parents doctor. Up cast, early marriage. 9867229014

SM4 May'89/5'6" Sr. S/W Engineer Girl in Chicago' USA seeks US based working Boy. No Divorcee or Widower. caste no bar # 9415821889

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

SINDHI Girl 49/5'4" Nvr Married B.E. MBA Sr Dir USA visiting India in Dec-Jan 9820303313, Vivah77@gmail.com

PHD(CS) UMD(USA) B'full Agrawal girl,97 born 5' Researcher 2 in Captal 1 California USA $4.5 laks+ Seek equivalent match upr caste 8966046312

B.TECH MS(CS)Non-Mnglk Brahmn Girl 30/5'2"/1.65 LPA in Canada on PR. Seeks Canada based sttld Groom. Hindu upper caste # 9810052137

B.TECH(IITR) SM4 B'ful, girl 1989/156cm, from a V rptd Jat fmly of W'UP, wkng at a good post in a startup (by IIT'ns) seeks an upper cast H'some, well edu and c'tured boy, 9412216866, 8218886530, E-ela.chaudhary7@gmail. com

BEAUTIFUL, Bangalore based,M_Arch, daughter of an Army officer,1995,5'6", mother, sister Doctors.Seeking alliance from well settled upper castes.contact 9885186147

SM for Jatav June 90/5'2 Asst Prof DU. Seeks prof qual match. Delhi based well edu family. Parents retd from govt job. Ph/WhatsApp # 9871216298

IIT /IIM/IAS/IPS match settled in India for beautiful Srivastava girl, 28/5'6", B.Tech(DTU), MBA(IIMK) working in MNC. #9810894794

PHD, US returned girl working in Hyderabad, '93 born, very fair, seeks alliance from like minded professional qualified family, +918522827711

PQM4 Feb 95 B'ful & Fair 5'3", Heavy, Sr UX researcher at MNC B'glore Pal kshatriya looking for well stld IT sector Boy. # 9106511718/9428330317

PQM for Yadav girl, 1983/ 5' 1", Teacher in Lucknow, M.Phil. M.A. Sanskrit. Plz call after 7 PM. Mob. 9591048979.

COSMOPOLITAN

BEAUTIFUL Tamil Chettiar Girl, 32 yrs, 175 cm. Top B-school/Ex-MBB/Global exposure. Seeks Tall, well-Educated, Accomplished Groom. CNB-91768 56965.

BY LANGUAGE

BENGALI

NEVER MARRIED, GOVT TEACHER, JULY 87, NO DIVORCEE, NO UNEMPLOYED, GOOD FAMILY 7084681520

Bennett & Coleman
THE TIMES OF INDIA
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A century for Bharat Ratna Advani!

By Narendra Modi

> As deputy PM and one of India's longest-serving home ministers, he was instrumental in strengthening India's security apparatus. His work in improving the lives of our security forces is remembered with great fondness —NARENDRA MODI

Shri Lal Krishna Advani enters the hundredth year of his life today, Nov 8. This year, his birthday fittingly coincides with Diwali, a festival associated with Prabhu Shri Ram, at a time when we are marking 75 years since the inception of Jana Sangh, 125th jayanti of Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee and recently celebrated a hundred years of RSS.

There are very few people whose lives have touched so many different chapters of modern India. Advani ji was born on Nov 8, 1927, on Dev Deepawali. In 1947, he experienced the pain of leaving behind his familiar world in Sindh. He rebuilt his life without bitterness. This trait of being able to build from scratch, against all odds, has stayed with him throughout. It was seen while he was strengthening Jana Sangh and later building BJP. His tenures as BJP president saw the Congress falling sharply from 400 Lok Sabha seats to below 200 in 1989 and BJP becoming the single largest party for the first time in 1996. Advani ji nurtured generations of karyakartas and gave the party a clear foundation, rooted in the principle of Nation First.

Two qualities always set Advani ji apart. First, his ideological clarity and intellectual sharpness, reflected in his speeches and writings. The Jana Sangh and BJP resolutions he authored remain worth reading even today, while his interviews were consistently incisive and precise. Second, the manner in which he exposed the pseudo-secularism propounded by a large section of the Indian polity for many years.

As an RSS pracharak, Advani ji first worked in different parts of Rajasthan. From there, he went to Delhi, where he started working closely with Atal ji. It is rare for two towering political leaders to work together for several decades, cooperating without becoming competitors. Advani ji and Atal ji set a remarkable example. Together, they changed the course of Indian politics.

I vividly recall the 1991 LS polls. It was decided that Advani ji would contest from two seats, one of which was Gandhinagar. He had an old link with Gujarat. His father had settled in Kutch after Partition. Advani ji had also served as a Rajya Sabha MP from Gujarat. So, it was a homecoming of sorts. I had the honour of helping prepare his papers and assisting him throughout the campaign. The people of Gandhinagar sent him to Parliament time and again. As a voter of Gandhinagar, I also had the honour of voting for him numerous times. The care and attention he devoted to his constituency is something to learn from.

During the Emergency, Advani ji was at the forefront of saving democracy and protecting the Constitution. His experiences found their way into his book, 'A Prisoner's Scrap-Book', in which he beautifully explained the striking similarities between events in India starting June 1975 and those in Nazi Germany in 1933.

Advani ji was a fiery Opposition leader but an equally excellent administrator. As deputy PM and one of India's longest-serving home ministers, he was instrumental in strengthening India's security apparatus. His work in improving the lives of our security forces is remembered with great fondness. His unequivocal stand against terrorism ensured India got a tough anti-terror law.

An iconic moment in Advani ji's life was the Somnath-Ayodhya Rath Yatra. I consider it a privilege that I got the opportunity to be involved in this yatra from the ideation stage to execution. Being present at Somnath when the yatra began was particularly special. A Yatra can be very demanding, requiring long hours, constant travel, physical endurance and an ability to remain focused despite fatigue. Advani ji embodied this endurance.

I also have memories of the saddening moments of Advani ji's arrest in Bihar. Then, in Gujarat, BJP withdrew support from Chimanbhai Patel govt. With this, a message was given, that when it comes to our ideology and Ram Temple, there will never be any compromise. Many of us took an oath that, come what may, a Ram Temple will be built. Years later, with the blessings of the people of India, a grand Mandir for Prabhu Shri Ram became a reality in Ayodhya.

There is so much more of Advani ji that is outstanding. His simplicity, for example. He has always shown what probity in public life is about. He is a voracious reader, a fan of cinema and theatre, and has been an enthusiastic film critic. His sense of history and the need to preserve it is visible in his book, 'My Country My Life.'

Any account of Advani ji's journey would be incomplete without mentioning Kamla Advani ji. She was a constant source of strength and support throughout his public life.

Growing up in Karachi, Advani ji could hardly have imagined the path his life would take. In an expression of gratitude, the people of India conferred upon him the Bharat Ratna in 2024. As Advani ji enters the hundredth year of his life, I pray that he be blessed with good health and that he continues to inspire us all as he has always done.

(The writer is Prime Minister of India)

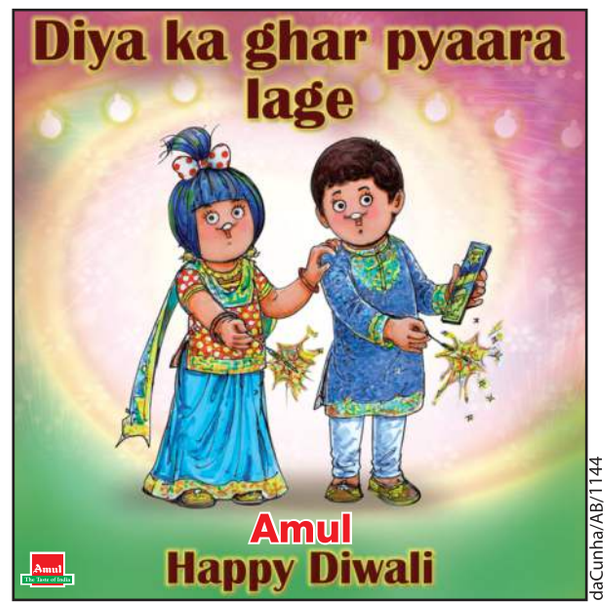
Tech Mahindra ex-APAC head killed over parking

Nikhil.Sharma
@timesofindia.com

Gurgaon: A neighbour allegedly pumped nine bullets into a senior IT executive during a parking dispute outside his Faridabad home on Friday night, killing him before he could be wheeled into a hospital. Paramjeet Dhankar (45), who was senior vice-president at Singapore-based FPT Software Company Ltd and former regional business head of Tech Mahindra's Asia-Pacific operations, had returned home just a day earlier to attend his nephew's wedding.

The shooting took place around 8.30pm on Friday. According to a complaint lodged by Dhankar's son, Shaurya, neighbour Mohan Sharma rang the bell at the family's floor in Sector 21C and called Dhankar downstairs, asking him to move his car. Shaurya accompanied his father to the parking area, where an argument broke out.

Mohan (44), a scrap dealer, allegedly whipped out his licensed pistol and opened fire at close range.



Verify border claims before sharing, urges Army

▶ Continued from page 1

Identifying the handles spreading the false propaganda, the ministry of electronics & IT said, "Six handles have been identified as circulating the same content between 1506 hrs on 06 Nov 2026 and 0146 hrs on 07 Nov 2026: @SongWeilonzob1; @letmehandleyou1; @_Finding_sarah; @DarkReal09; @War_Updates5; and @sumit_sarkr."

Exposing the disinformation pattern, the Indian Army described the narrative as a combination of "fabricated military defeat, exaggerated territorial incursion, unsubstantiated PLA control claims and misleading anti-Indian Army narrative." Cautioning the social media users, the Army's fact-check account urged the public to verify border-related claims through credible and official sources before sharing them.

In Oct too, the Indian Army had rubbished a series of videos on social media that falsely claimed that Chinese troops have taken control of some areas in Arunachal Pradesh. On its X fact-check account, the Army also debunked a deepfake video falsely attributing remarks on China taking control of areas in Arunachal Pradesh to Lt Gen Girish Kalia.

MRPL fuel sample meets E20 norm as Cong questions ethanol blending

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Getty Images

BLEND DEBATE

Bengaluru: Amid Congress's escalating attack on the Centre over alleged excess ethanol blending in petrol, a sample from Karnataka-based Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd (MRPL) has recorded 19.2% ethanol, within the prescribed E20 limit, although tests commissioned by the Karnataka govt have found levels as high as 31.2% in samples from other oil companies.

On Friday, food and civil supplies minister Rizwan Arshad disclosed the findings of tests conducted on 63 samples collected from petrol pumps across seven districts. Fourteen samples reportedly exceeded the 20% limit, including fuel sold by Indian Oil, HPCL, BPCL, Nayara and Shell. An MRPL sample recorded 19.2%, while another Shell sample had 13.5%. The 19.5% reading at MRPL outlets is significant as it falls below the E20 ceiling, while the higher readings reported in other samples have raised questions about variations in fuel quality across outlets.

However, Indian Oil, BPCL and HPCL disputed Karnataka's findings, questioning the sampling and testing procedures. They said all 56 samples from Karnataka tested in their nationwide exercise were within the 19-21% range. Deputy CM G Parameshwara and IT and BT minister Priyank Kharge on Saturday stepped up the attack on the Centre. Parameshwara demanded an investigation, disclosure of ethanol-blending levels at fuel stations and safeguards against possible vehicle damage.

In a post on X, Parameshwara also accused the Centre of restricting procurement of certain sugarcane-based ethanol products even as farmers in Karnataka grapple with drought.

"While motorists face additional costs and risks, the Centre has also restricted procurement of certain sugarcane-based ethanol products, even as Karnataka's farmers struggle with severe drought. Where are the promised benefits for farmers? Who is protecting consumers? I demand an immediate investigation, strict action against those responsible, transparent disclosure of ethanol content and safeguards for motorists. Farmers and consumers deserve fairness, transparency and accountability," he added.

Priyank, minister for IT and BT, alleged that the Union govt was misleading people and experimenting with fuel standards without adequately assessing the consequences.

He said reports from laboratories accredited by the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL) had detected 35-40% ethanol in some petrol samples, significantly above the E20 limit. "The Govt of India is lying through its teeth to the people. You are experimenting on 1.3 billion people. How does that even work?" he asked.

Referring to the Centre's submissions before Supreme Court, Kharge said the Solicitor General had described ethanol blending as an experiment and indicated that it was not intended for nationwide implementation. He alleged that the policy was designed to benefit companies associated with Union ministers rather than serve public interest.

Minister dismisses firms' response

Bengaluru: Karnataka food and civil supplies minister Rizwan Arshad on Saturday stepped up his confrontation with oil marketing companies, rejecting their claims in the dispute over ethanol content in petrol, and said he would issue a detailed response to their clarification on Monday. TNN

IAF IL-76 sets high-altitude landing record

Naseer.Ganai@timesofindia.com

Srinagar: An IAF IL-76MD transport aircraft has landed at 13,629 feet in eastern Ladakh, setting a world record for the highest-altitude landing by the heavy-lift plane and underscoring India's growing military airlift capability near the China border.

Announcing the achievement Saturday, IAF said the successful landing at Nyoma airbase, barely 25km from the Line of Actual Control, marked "the highest-altitude landing ever achieved by the aircraft anywhere in the world". Calling it "a remarkable demonstration of the aircraft's enduring capability, backed by the exceptional skill, precision, and professionalism of its crew", IAF described the landing as "a milestone that reinforces India's strategic airlift capability". At such altitudes, thin air challenges even the most capable aircraft.

IAF said the landing was at Nyoma airbase, 25km from LAC, at 13,629ft

The Soviet-origin, four-engine Ilyushin aircraft was inducted in 1985 and nicknamed Gajraj. A mainstay of IAF's transport fleet, it has been used to airlift troops, T-72 tanks, BMP infantry combat vehicles and disaster relief supplies in difficult terrain.

'No objections raised in Raj regarding final SIR list'

▶ Continued from page 1

Rajasthan's final SIR roll was published in Feb 2026. "Since preparation for local body polls started much earlier, we used EC's pre-SIR roll, last updated on Jan 1, 2025, as the base roll for conducting local body polls in Rajasthan," SEC secretary Rajesh Verma told **TOI**. He said SEC traditionally used EC rolls, updated annually through the special summary revision, as the basis for local elections that began in Sept.

Chief electoral officer Naveen Mahajan acknowledged that the difference arose because SEC had relied on the pre-SIR electoral roll. "No objections were raised in Rajasthan regarding the final SIR list," he told TOI.

Rights activist and Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) founder Nikhil Dey challenged the explanation, saying electoral rolls were continuously updated and SEC could have adopted the final SIR list.

"First, how can they use a pre-SIR electoral roll when updating voter lists is a continuous exercise? SEC's electoral roll was being updated right up to the elections. It could have easily used the final SIR list to conduct the polls," Nikhil Dey said. If SEC preferred its older roll, he demanded that it establish why it considered that list more accurate than EC's final version.

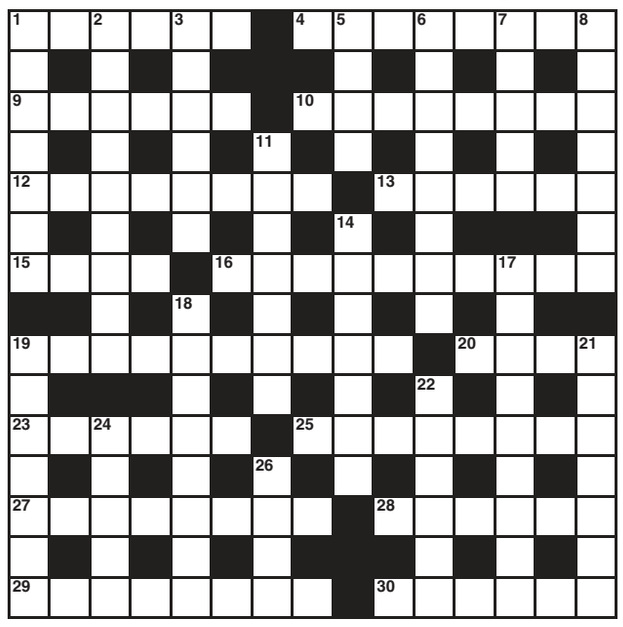
He also questioned how the same booth-level officers (BLOs) could record voters as dead in one roll but retain them in another. "It is unbelievable that the same BLOs were involved in updating both lists, yet a person is marked as dead in one list but not in the other. How can the same officials record someone as deceased in one list and retain them as a voter in the other? If this has been done deliberately, it amounts to a crime and those responsible must be punished," the rights activist said.

EC's final SIR roll reduced Rajasthan's electorate from 5.47 crore to 5.15 crore after 44.28 lakh names were deleted and 12.91 lakh added.

THE TOI CROSSWORD

CROSSWORD No. TCC#0297

The **TOI Crossword contest** is on a short break, but the crossword itself will continue to be featured in The Sunday Times of India, so that you can continue to relish the challenge every week. **Stay tuned!**



The Times of India CROSSWORD EVERY SUNDAY

CRYPTIC CLUES

Across
1 Current line of agreement (6)
4 Left for dead apparently (8)
9 Note to troubled users looks like coercion (6)
10 Its choir could be famous (8)
12 Monk who founded an order on Scottish mountain (8)
13 Threaten a little rascal to the limit (6)
15 Attack the copper with acid (4)
16 Gains money from records? (5,5)
19 Liking getting precedence - for shares? (10)
20 Business settled (4)
23 It's natural in food we hear (6)
25 Frank won't distribute capital (8)
27 Cut to size or followed around (8)
28 Winner takes part in rousing game (6)
29 As a pre-Raphaelite he pledged himself to resist change (8)
30 He has absolute control of the French vessel (6)

Down
1 Bail due for release it's heard (7)
2 The French follow continuing account (9)
3 Desire to live in a new way (6)
5 Prepare to put out with the rising tide (4)
6 One metal fused into many (8)
7 Clipped trees into shape (5)
8 Settles month and day (7)
11 Close shaves? (7)
14 Those that foil trespassers? (7)
17 A somewhat bald description (4,2,3)
18 She confuses people about a couple of points (8)
19 Artist splits ten between two (7)
21 Tower encountered round Iran perhaps (7)
22 Strict clergyman turns up in the diocese (6)
24 Composer's state of ignorance (5)
26 Go to get some citrus flavouring (4)

QUICK CLUES

Across
1 US city, scene of 1773 'Tea Party' (6) 4 Waterproof overshoes (8) 9 Bowman (6) 10 Unchallengeable (4-4)
12 On the other side of the page (8) 13 Spring suddenly in attack (6) 15 Diplomacy (4) 16 Confronting each other (4-2-4) 19 Shabby (4-2-4) 20 Tranquil (4) 23 Reddish brown (of hair) (6) 25 The open ocean (4,4) 27 A culinary herb (8)
28 Slow to understand (6) 29 Capital of Australia (8)
30 Larder (6)

Down
1 Confirm (4,3) 2 Irrationally inviolable institution (6,3) 3 For all to see (6) 5 Sad to say! (4)
6 Conventional (8) 7 One of the Great Lakes (5)
8 Heartfelt (7) 11 Grand manner (7) 14 Advantage (7) 17 Consequently (2,1,6) 18 Legitimate object of attack (4,4) 19 Having powerful effect (7)
21 Inexplicable affair (7) 22 A morbid fear (6)
24 Author of Childe Harold (5) 26 Inferior (4)

SOLUTIONS TO LAST WEEK'S CROSSWORD

CRYPTIC

A	C	C	E	D	E	S		F	O	N	D	A	N	T
T		H		E		P		I		E		L		O
T	H	E	A	T	R	E		R	U	S	T	L	E	R
A		A		E		E		E		T		H		M
C	A	P	E	R		D	I	S	P	A	R	A	G	E
K		E		G				I				I		N
S	E	N	T	E	N	C	E	D		S	P	L	I	T
				N		A		E		T				
M	E	R	I	T		R	E	S	T	R	A	I	N	T
I		A				N				A		T		R
R	E	L	U	C	T	A	N	T		P	I	E	C	E
A		L		A		T		R		P		M		L
C	H	I	A	N	T	I		I	N	I	T	I	A	L
L		E		O		O		E		N		S		I
E	A	S	T	E	R	N		D	I	G	R	E	S	S

QUICK

S	C	R	A	T	C	H		H	O	S	T	I	L	E
P		E		R		E		I		W		N		N
E	X	T	R	A	C	T		T	R	A	F	F	I	C
E		R		N		U		O		R		A		H
D	R	E	S	S		P	Y	R	O	M	A	N	I	A
U		A		P				M				C		N
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O	V	E	R	T		D	E	S	O	L	A	T	E	D
F		N				C				S		W		I
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B		I		U		R		R		U		T		L
E	N	V	E	L	O	P		A	V	A	R	I	C	E
A		E		G		E		M		R		M		C
T	A	N	G	E	N	T		P	R	E	V	E	N	T

TOI Games Enjoy a host of engaging puzzles and games every day. Play now! Scan theQR code or visit **toi.in/games**

8001/466/2627

ଓଡିଶା ବନ ଉନ୍ନୟନ ନିଗମ ଲିଃ
Odisha Forest Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
CIN-U02005OR1962SGC000446
Regd. Off: Plot No. A/84 Kharavel Nagar, Unit-III,
Bhubaneswar, Odisha, PIN-751001
Telephone: - 0674-2534086, 2534269 Fax: 0674-2535934
[website: www.odishafdc.com ● E-mail ID: general@odishafdc.com]

By e-mail

Notice No.19953/OFDC-24012/6/2024-OPER

Dated: Bhubaneswar, the 6th Nov, 2026

This is for information of all concerned that the monthly auction sale date of round timber/sawn timber/round firewood/poles & ballies and bamboo etc. of Muniguda (C) division has been postponed to 17.11.2026 due to some unavoidable circumstances. The time, venue and other terms & conditions of auction sale will remain unaltered.

For Odisha Forest Development Corporation Ltd.
Sd/-
Managing Director

OIPR-8001/8011/1/26-27/0015

25001/1484/2627

By E_Mail/e-Despatch
E_Mail ID: serwcbaripada@gmail.com
Ph-No-06792-261343/261344
Gangraj, Baripada

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA

Office Order No 5755 /Dt 06.11.2026

1st Corrigendum to National Competitive Bidding e_procurement Notice No.4923/Bridge Works Dt.22.09.2026 (NCB No-431).

Due to unavoidable circumstances the important dates of tendering process for the Bridge work being changed as follows.

Sl No	Item	Time Schedule as per Original NCB	Time Schedule as per Corrigendum Notice
1	Availability of tender On-line for bidding	13.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M to 29.10.2026 up to 05.00 P.M	19.11.2026 at 11.00 AM to 05.12.2026 up to 05.00 P.M
2	Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification if any	28.10.2026 up to 01.00 P.M	04.12.2026 up to 05.00 P.M
3	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid	30.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M	07.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M
4	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid	Will be intimated later	Will be intimated later

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Er. A.K Naik
Chief Construction Engineer
R.W. CIRCLE, BARIPADA

OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0022

11001/407/2627

BIJU PATNAIK UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY ODISHA, RAURKELA

Date : 06.11.2026

Tender Call Notice

Sealed Tender (two bid system) are invited from the reputed and experienced Agencies/Firms for the following items.

Sl	Name of Tender	Tender Notice No. & Date	Last Date
1.	Tender for Heat Transfer Laboratory	BPUT/XII/CUPGS/047/2024/ Dated 06.11.2026	11.12.2026 by 5.00 PM
2.	Tender for Machining Science and Technology Laboratory	BPUT/XII/CUPGS/048/2024/ Dated 06.11.2026	11.12.2026 by 5.00 PM
3.	Tender for Material Testing Laboratory	BPUT/XII/CUPGS/049/2024/ Dated 06.11.2026	11.12.2026 by 5.00 PM
4.	Tender for Machine and Mechanism Laboratory	BPUT/XII/CUPGS/050/2024/ Dated 06.11.2026	11.12.2026 by 5.00 PM

The Tender paper along with all terms and conditions may be downloaded from our website i.e **www.bput.ac.in**. The tenders shall be submitted addressing to the Registrar, Biju Patnaik University of Technology, Raurkela-769015, Odisha through Speed Post only. The authority reserves the rights to reject any or all the Tender with out assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
REGISTRAR

OIPR-11001/11059/1/26-27/0013

25001/1481/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE: SUNDARAGADA

AT/PO-SANKARA, SUNDARGARH-770020, E-mail address-serw_sundargarh@yahoo.com

No. Tender Online – RWCCESNG –38 of 2026-27 Letter No. 6326 / Dtd. 03.11.2026

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Type of the Work : Road Work (PR)
2. Class of Contractor : As specified in the column-7 of the Annexure
3. Time of Completion : As specified in the column-6 of the Annexure
4. Detail Projects : As per Annexure attached
5. Estimated Cost : As specified in the column-5 of the Annexure
6. Other details :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada	RWCCESNG-38 of 2026-27	10.11.2026 11:00 AM	25.11.2026 5:00 PM	23.11.2026 5:00 PM	26.11.2026 11:00 AM	Will be intimated separately

Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada

OIPR-25001/25133/1/26-27/0057

1001/217/2627

Website: www.ouat.ac.in
E-Mail: registrarouat@gmail.com
Ph : 0674-2397424
Fax : 0674-2397424

ଓଡ଼ିଶାକୃଷିଓବୈଷୟିକବିଶ୍ୱବିଦ୍ୟାଳୟ,ଭୁବନେଶ୍ୱର,ଓଡ଼ିଶା
ODISHA UNIVERSITY OF AGRICULTURE & TECHNOLOGY,

Bhubaneswar-751003, Odisha
No.E-II-II-02/2022/17795 UAT, Dated. 07th November, 2026

INDICATIVE ADVERTISEMENT

Fresh applications are invited from the eligible candidates in the prescribed format for recruitment of personnels in the cadre of **Assistant Professor / Equivalent** in the following subjects, lying vacant in Teaching/ Research Establishment of Veterinary Science under OUAT.

Veterinary Science

Animal Breeding & Genetics-01, Animal Reproduction, Gynecology & Obstetrics-01, Vety. Medicine-02, Poultry Science-01, Livestock Production Management-01, Animal Nutrition-01, Vety. Pathology-01, Vety. Biochemistry-01, Livestock Product Technology-01. **Total = 10 posts.**

The detailed advertisement with information sheet containing number of vacancies, reservation of posts in different category, prescribed application form, application fee & mode of payment, qualification, experience, scale of pay, age and other required conditions in respect of the vacancies as well as general information and instructions to the candidate can be downloaded from University website: **ouat.ac.in.**

Last date of receipt of application: 07/12/2026 up to 5.00 P.M.

BY ORDER OF THE VICE-CHANCELLOR,
Sd/-
REGISTRAR

OIPR-1001/1533/1/26-27/0029

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED

e-TENDER NOTICE

The TGTransco invites online Bids on e-procurement for supply of 33kV Twin Feeder C&R panels against Tender Specification No.TGPMM21-38/2026.

Tenderers can have further details and download the tender schedule from e-procurement market place i.e., **www.telangana.gov.in**. Contact Nos.:CE/P&MM, Phone:040-23396000 (Extn.:3487/3583/3460/3496) 040-23303736. **www.tgtransco.com**

DIPR R.O.No.750-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:07.11.2026 **Sd/-Chief Engineer/P&MM**

भारत सरकार टकसाल
INDIA GOVERNMENT MINT

भारत प्रतिभूति मुद्रण तथा मुद्रा निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड की एक इकाई
A Unit of Security Printing & Minting Corporation of India Limited
भारत सरकार के पूर्ण स्वामित्वधीन wholly owned by Govt. of India
A Miniratna Category-I, CPSE

डी-2, सैक्टर-1,नोएडा जिला – गौतम बुद्ध नगर, (ऊ.प्र.) पिन-201301
D-2, Sector-1, NOIDA Distt.: Gautam Buddh Nagar (UP) PIN: 201 301
PH.: 0120-4783116 Fax: 0120-2537609 email: igm.noida@spmcil.com

Expression of Interest (EOI)

India Government Mint, Noida invites sealed Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible and qualified tenderers for following goods/services:

Tender No.	Description of Goods/Services	Tender Fee & EMD	Tender shall be available on website from	Last Date of Submission of tender
IGMN-18/11/2026-IGMN-TECH-IGMN "CPPP / etenders ID: 2026_SPMCI_297103_1"	Manufacturing and Supply of 400 MPCs (2696.00 MT) Rs.5 Nickel Brass Coin Blanks at India Government Mints located at Noida, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Mumbai on development tender basis	NIL	07.11.2026	07.12.2026
IGMN-18/12/2026-IGMN-TECH-IGMN "CPPP / etenders ID: 2026_SPMCI_297098_1"	Manufacturing and Supply of 380 MPCs (2941.20 MT) Rs.10 Bi-Metallic Coin Blanks at India Government Mints located at Noida, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Mumbai on development tender basis	NIL	07.11.2026	07.12.2026
IGMN-18/13/2026-IGMN-TECH-IGMN "CPPP / etenders ID: 2026_SPMCI_297082_1"	Manufacturing and Supply of 200 MPCs (1708.00 MT) Rs.20 Bi-Metallic Coin Blanks at India Government Mints located at Noida, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Mumbai on development tender basis	NIL	07.11.2026	07.12.2026

Interested Vendors may submit their offers on or before the last date of submission through e-tender on CPP Portal. Future amendment/revision of Expression of Interest (EOI), if any, shall be published in CPP Portal & our website only.

Please visit our website http://igmnoida.spmcil.com for further details & Hindi version of this advertisement.

Sd-
Chief General Manager

32001/1281/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
EASTERN CIRCLE-I, CANTONMENT ROAD, KATAKA

Email id :- seeccuttack@gmail.com

'e' Procurement Notice No.ACE, EC-I/13 of 2026-27

1. Nature of workCanal : Trough Lining work
2. Total no. of work : 1 No.
3. Tender Amount : Rs.796.50 Lakh (Approx.)
4. Tender paper cost : Rs.10,000/- (**Non refundable**)
5. EMD required : Rs.7,96,500.00
6. Class of contractor : 'A' & 'Special'
7. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar months.
8. Online for bidding : 16.11.2026 at 10.00 hrs. to 30.11.2026 up to 17.30 hrs.
9. Date & time of opening of Tender (Technical bid) : 01.12. 2026 at 11.30 hrs.

Other terms and conditions can be seen from the Govt. website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
All corrigendum / cancellation of tender if any, will only be uploaded in the above web site.

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer,
Eastern Circle-I, Kataka

OIPR-32001/32370/1/26-27/0012

25001/1486/2627

ମୁଖ୍ୟ ନିର୍ମାଣ ଯନ୍ତ୍ରୀଙ୍କ କାର୍ଯ୍ୟାଳୟ ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ନିର୍ମାଣ ମଣ୍ଡଳ, ବ୍ରହ୍ମପୁର
(ଫୋନ୍ / ଫାକ୍ସ: ଆସ୍ପତ୍ରୀ, ଅଇରକ ଇନକମ ଟିକସଘର, ବ୍ରହ୍ମପୁର - ୭୬୦୦୨୧, ଗଞ୍ଜାମ, ଓଡିଶା

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR

(At/Po- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
(E-Mail :- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com, Tel No. :- 0680-2404287)

E-Mail / E-despatch

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement
Bid Identification No. Online Tender/26-2026-27/BPR

Identification No	Name of work	No. of Works	Approx. Estimated Cost (In lakh)	Class of Contractor	Period of Completion
Online Tender / 26-2026-27/BPR	Road Works under PERIODICAL MAINTENANCE	26 Nos.	From Rs. 103.72 Lakhs to Rs. 227.39 Lakhs	"B" Class & "A" Class as applicable	04 (Four) Calendar Month as provided

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender online for bidding	
		From	To
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W.Circle, Berhampur	Online Tender/26-2026-27/BPR	23.11.2026 at 10.00 A.M.	08.12.2026 upto 5.30 P.M.

(i) **EMD / Bid Security, Cost of Bid document is to be transferred through Online as per the procedure mentioned in the DTCN.**
(ii) **Non-submission of the information/documents through online by the bidder as per the items mentioned in the eligible criteria of the DTCN will also liable for rejection of his tender.**

Further details & Corrigendum if any can be seen from the website:- https://tendersodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
R.W. Circle, Berhampur

OIPR-25001/25071/1/26-27/0045

32001/1278/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER
TEL BASIN, BHABANIPATANA

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

"e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE NO.- CE&BM, TEL-P1-09/2026-27

Bid Identification No: CETEL-BOUDH-05/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana (WR Department) on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system to be received in on ONLINE MODE only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below :-

1	Nature of work	Civil Works
2	Number of works	01 (One)
3	Approximate amount put to tender.	Rs. 6,58,82,528.00/-
4	Class of Contractor	**'A' & 'Special'** Class
5	Period of completion	9 (Nine) Calendar months.
6	Date & time of availability of Bid document in the portal	13.11.2026 -10.00 hours to 01.12.2026 up to 17.00 hours
7	Last date & time of seeking Tender clarification.	Dt. 25.11.2026 up to 17.30 hours
8	Last date & time of Receipt of Bids in the portal.	Dt. 01.12.2026 up to 17.00 hours
9	Date, time & place of opening of Technical bids of Double Cover	Dt. 02.12.2026 at 11.00 hours- in the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana

The bidders have to participate in online bidding only. The website for online bidding is **htpp://www.tendersodisha.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager,
Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana

OIPR-32001/32317/1/26-27/0014

12001/200/2627

THE ODISHA STATE POLICE HOUSING & WELFARE CORPORATION LTD.

(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
JANAPATH, BHOINAGAR, BHUBANESWAR - 22.
Ph: 0674-2541545, 2542921
E-mail: ophwc.od@od.gov.in, Website: www.ophwc.com
e-procurement notice No.- 20/OPHWC/2026-27

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The **Chief Engineer (OSPH&WC),** Odisha, Bhubaneswar invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system in **ONLINE MODE** only, for the works as detailed below:

1	Nature of work	**Building works**
2	No. of Works	**33 Nos.**
3	Value of Tender	**Rs. 60.43 Lakh to Rs. 34.85 Cr.**
4	Class of Contractor	**'B' Class to 'Super' Class**
5	Cost of Bid document (To be paid online)	**Rs.11,800.00**
6	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	**Dt.10/11/2026 to Dt.01/12/2026 up to 5.00 P.M.**
7	Last date/time of Receipt of Bids in the Portal	**Dt.01/12/2026 up to 5.00 P.M.**
8	Date of Opening Bid	**Dt.02/12/2026 at 10.30 A.M.**
9	Date of Technical Presentation (among qualified bidders only)	**Date & Time will be notified after opening of the Technical Bid.**
10	Date of Technical Presentation (among qualified bidders only)	**Date & Time will be notified after opening of the Technical Bid.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
(OSPH&WC)

N.B. The quoted rate should be all inclusive but excluding G.S.T. as applicable Under works contract.

OIPR-12001/12025/1/26-27/0024

Tumakuru City Corporation, Tumakuru
Website: www.tumakurucity.mrc.gov.in
Office No:0816-2272200, Helpline: 9449872599
e-mail : ka.tumakuru.cc@gmail.com
No:ತುಮಪಾ/ಕಂ.ಶಾ/ಸಿಆರ್–91/2026–27 DATED: 04.11.2026

"E-Auction Publication"

It is hereby informed to the general public that, as per the Advertisement (Construction and Design) Bye-Laws framed under Section 423 (24) of the Karnataka Municipal Corporations Act, 1976, the LED advertisement displays falling within Tumakuru City limits at (1) Sri Shivakumara Swamiji Circle 2) Batavadi Circle, 3) Kote Anjaneya Swamy Circle, 4) Ring Road(Near Rotigar) and 5) Corporation Office premises (opposite Samruddhi Hotel) are being disposed of through E-auction (e-procurement) for a period of 03 years. Therefore, eligible tenderers may participate in the E-auction conducted through the online, e-portal subject to the following conditions.
Scheduled dates for the e-auction to come into effect.
1. Date for submitting the e-auction bid on the e-portal: From 05.11.2026 to 5:30 PM on 19.11.2026. 2. Date of the e-auction bid: From 10:00 AM to 04:30 PM on 21.11.2026. 3. Initial bid amount Rs. 3,60,16,344/- (Rupees three crore sixty lakh sixteen thousand three hundred and forty-four only.) 4. An EMD amount of Rs.1,00,000/- shall be submitted online through the e-portal collectively for all interested advertisement displays. 5. Bidders may pay the EMD amount on the e-portal through debit card, credit card, or NEFT.
6. For further details regarding the uploading of the auction, the information can be obtained on the website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in and on the Tumakuru City Corporation office website www.tumakurucity.mrc.gov.in.

Sd/- Commissioner,
Tumakur City Corporation Tumakuru

DIPR/TUM/315/KSMCA/2026-27

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Tender notice No. CAO/CN/ BNC/206/2026 Dated 03.11.2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tenders for the following works.

SN	Item of work	Approx. value
1	Providing facilitation to competent Authority for land Acquisition (CALA)including Execution of Site clearance, jungle cleaning, Tree cutting, land boundary marking, pillaring, dismantling, earth work, demolition of old structures, liaisoning, possession and land mutation and miscellaneous civil works under the Railway Act, 1989 work to Railway Projects of Doubling works between Hosur and Omalur (147 Km) of Bangalore Division of South Western Railway.	₹4,02,15,536/-

Last date and time for submission of tender: **25.11.2026 Upto 15:00 Hours**

For details log on : **www.ireps.gov.in**

Deputy Chief Engineer /Construction/Works/ Bengaluru Cantonment

PUB/604/AAD360/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the **RailOne** app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

South Western Railway - SWR SWRRLY @SWRAILWAYHQ @sw_railways

KARNATAKA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD

No. 49, "Parisara Bhavan", Church Street, Bengaluru-560001.
Ph: 25581383, 25589112, 25586520 Fax: 080-25586321

Tender No.: CEL/CEO-3/08/XVFC/2023-24/3553 Date: 05.11.2026

SHORT TERM RE-TENDER NOTIFICATION - CALL-4
(Through e-Procurement Portal)

Chief Environmental Officer-3 (purchaser), Karnataka State Pollution Control Board has invited bids from eligible tenderers for the supply of 4 BS VI mobile ambient air quality monitoring sensors for vehicle through e-procurement portal. **Last date and time for uploading the bids online: 20.11.2026 (till evening 4:00 pm).** More details can be downloaded from website: **eproc.karnataka.gov.in**.

DIPR/CP/DISHA/3620/2026-27 **Sd/- Chief Environmental Officer-3, KSPCB**

Our motto is to minimize waste generation through judicious use of natural resources

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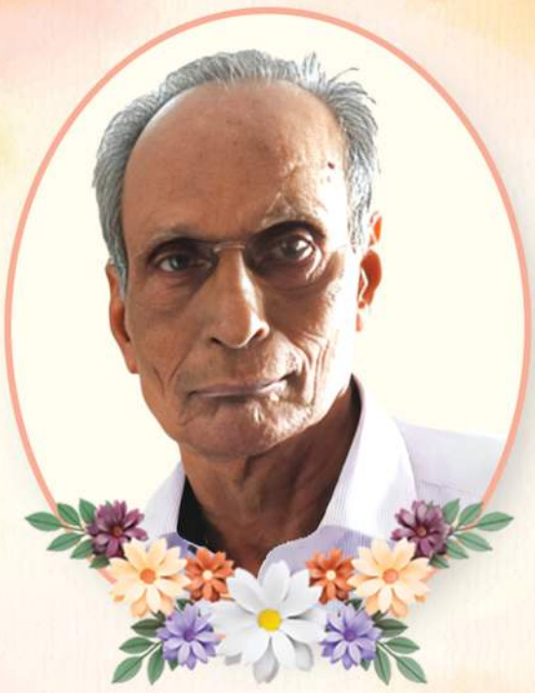
TIMES TRIBUTE
PAYING HOMAGE TO THE DEPARTED SOUL

To book your ad | Logon to: ads.timesofindia.com or Call: 18001205474 (Toll Free) | Scan OR Code

OBITUARY



V K N NAIR (95 years)
Founder Director
Gina Engineering Co
No.151, Ashirvad, 13th Cross, R T Nagar, Bangalore

Cremation on 08-11-2026, 2.0 pm at Hebbal Crematorium

RSVP: 9792002241 / 9008988077

ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಅಂತರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ವಿಮಾನ ನಿಲ್ದಾಣ ಪ್ರದೇಶ ಯೋಜನಾ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ, ದೇವನಹಳ್ಳಿ

ಬಿ.ಎ ನಿವೇಶನ ಖಾತೆ ನಂ. 31–511–371, ವಾರ್ಡ್ ನಂ. 20, ಅಂಬಿಕಾ ಲೇಔಟ್, ಸೌತೇಗೌಡನಹಳ್ಳಿ ಗ್ರಾಮ, ಸೂಲಿಬೆಲೆ ರಸ್ತೆ, ಕಸಬಾ ಹೋಬಳಿ, ದೇವನಹಳ್ಳಿ ಟೌನ್, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಗ್ರಾಮಾಂತರ ಜಿಲ್ಲೆ–562110

ಸಂ: ಬಿಐಎಎಪಿಎ/ಟಿಪಿ/ಎಂಐಎಸ್/ಟಿಡಿಆರ್/52/2026–27/2524 ದಿನಾಂಕ : 03.11.2026

ಅಲ್ಪಾವಧಿ ಇ-ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ

ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಅಂತರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ವಿಮಾನ ನಿಲ್ದಾಣ ಪ್ರದೇಶ ಯೋಜನಾ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರದ ವ್ಯಾಪ್ತಿಯಲ್ಲಿನ ಕೆಂಪೇಗೌಡ ಅಂತರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ವಿಮಾನ ನಿಲ್ದಾಣಕ್ಕೆ (ಸಾತನೂರು – ಹೊಸಹಳ್ಳಿ – ಹುತ್ತನಹಳ್ಳಿ – ಮೀಸಗಾನಹಳ್ಳಿ – ಬೊಯಿಲಹಳ್ಳಿ – ಬೇಗೂರು –ಮುತ್ತುಗದಹಳ್ಳಿ ಮತ್ತು ರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ಹೆದ್ದಾರಿ – 07 ರಿಂದ ಬೇಗೂರು ಜಂಕ್ಷನ್ ರವರೆಗೆ) ಹಾದು ಹೋಗುವ ಪರ್ಯಾಯ ರಸ್ತೆಗೆ ಟಿಡಿಆರ್ ವಿತರಿಸುವ ಕಾರ್ಯದ ಸಂಬಂಧ ಯೋಜನಾ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರಕ್ಕೆ ಸಲಹೆ ನೀಡಲು ಆಸಕ್ತಿಯುಳ್ಳ ಅರ್ಹ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ದಾರರು ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಇ–ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರ್‌ಮೆಂಟ್ ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮೂಲಕ TPA/2026-27/SE0093 ರಲ್ಲಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಡಾಕ್ಯುಮೆಂಟುಗಳನ್ನು ಸರ್ಕಾರದ e-Procurment ಮೂಲಕ ದಿನಾಂಕ: **07/11/2026** ರಿಂದ ಡೌನ್‌ಲೋಡ್ ಮಾಡಿಕೊಳ್ಳಬಹುದಾಗಿದ್ದು, ದಿನಾಂಕ: **26/11/2026** ರಂದು ಸಮಯ ಸಂಜೆ 4:00 ಗಂಟೆ ಒಳಗೆ ಇ–ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ದಸ್ತಾವೇಜು ಅನ್ನು ಅಪ್‌ಲೋಡ್ ಮಾಡಬಹುದು ಹಾಗೂ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ವಿವರಗಳಿಗೆ ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್ ವಿಳಾಸ: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ನೋಡಬಹುದಾಗಿದೆ.

ಸಹಿ/– ನಗರ ಮತ್ತು ಗ್ರಾಮಾಂತರ ಯೋಜನಾ ಜಂಟಿ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಕರು
ಹಾಗೂ ಸದಸ್ಯ ಕಾರ್ಯದರ್ಶಿಗಳು,
ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಅಂತರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ವಿಮಾನ ನಿಲ್ದಾಣ ಪ್ರದೇಶ ಯೋಜನಾ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ,
ದೇವನಹಳ್ಳಿ

ವಾ.ಸಾ.ಸಂ.ಇ/ವಾಪ್ರ/ಶಿರಡಿ ಸಾಯಿ/3617/2026–27

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

E- Tender Notice

Tender Notice No: PCMM/CLW/HWH/ E-Procurement/26/43, Dated: 04/11/2026. PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the followings. The following E-Tender/s is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for detailed instructions. These are E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. **Sl. No.: [166]. Tender No.:14262984F. Description of Stores: 1)** Pantograph Mounting Insulator To Drg.Spec. No. CLW/ES/AC/I-1/L, CLW/ES/SK-4/ AC/I-1/L, **2)** Roof Line Insulator To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/AC/I-1/L, CLW/ES/SK-2/AC/I-1/L.**Quantity:** As Per Tender/Document. **Due On:** 25/11/2026. **Tender Cost:** ₹ 0.00.

PR6/534 **PCMM/CLW/Howrah**

Visit us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-(IREPS) TENDER NOTICE NO. 29UBL 2026-27 Date: 05.11.2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tenders for the following works.

SN	Item of work	Approx. value
1	Hubballi Division: Assistant Divisional Engineer/West/ Hubballi (Excl) to Alnawar to Ambewadi (incl) (ZONE-12)	₹20,07,028.00
2	Hubballi Division: Track Maintenance in yards under Assistant Divisional Engineer/WEST Sub division for a period of one year.	₹1,76,93,051.00
3	Hubballi Division: Track Maintenance lubrication of track under Assistant Divisional Engineer/ WEST Sub division for a period of one year.	₹1,01,14,943.00
4	Hubballi Division: Track Maintenance in mid section under Assistant Divisional Engineer/WEST Sub division for a period of one year.	₹1,70,12,625.00
5	Hubballi Division: Hubballi- Londa(UBL-LD) Section: Ancillary/Balance work of subway in lieu of LC No.286 Km.474/0-474/100 in between Unkal-Baridevarkoppa (UNK-BDKA) station respectively by RH Girder/Cut and Cover method, Special Condition to be followed.	₹6,47,45,435.00

Last date and time for submission of tender: **30.11.2026 Upto 11:00 Hours**

For details log on : **www.ireps.gov.in**

Senior Divisional Engineer/Co-Ordination/ Hubballi

PUB/610/AAD360/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the **RailOne** app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

South Western Railway - SWR SWRRLY @SWRAILWAYHQ @sw_railways

COEP Technological University

(A Unitary Public University of Govt. of Maharashtra)
Shivajinagar, Pune - 411 005.
Ph.: (020)25507009, Web: www.coeptech.ac.in

Tender Notice

COEP Technological University, Pune invites online tender, Tender Id: 2026_DTEDM_1351907_1, Tender for Construction of (G+4) storied Administrative Building at COEP Technological University, Pune. The Details are uploaded on **https://mahatender.gov.in.**
The interested parties / bidders are requested to submit the proposal **on or before 5.00 PM on 23/11/2026.**

Sd/-
Registrar
Dated : 06th November, 2026 COEP Technological University Pune

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

L. No. JHS-ELG-W-T-29-2026-27 **Dated:- 05.11.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Gen) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E- Tendering) for the following work :-

Tender No.: JHS-ELG-W-T-29-2026-27, **Description of work:** Electrical/G work for: JHS DIV: Provision of industrial-type AC in RRI/EI buildings of more than 100 routes over Jhansi Division.

Tender value: ₹ 3,04,92,980/- Only	**Bid Security:** ₹ 6,09,900/- Only
Completion period: 06 months	**Closing date of tender:** 30.11.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)

Note: (1) Tenderer will submit the tender online upto **30.11.2026** (upto 1**5:00 Hrs**.). **(2)** Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website **http://www.ireps.gov.in**. **2544/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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Office of the Commissioner for Sericulture Development & Director of Sericulture
DEPARTMENT OF SERICULTURE

M.S. Building, 5th Floor, Dr. B.R.Ambedkar Veedhi, Bengaluru- 560001. Phone: 080-22252611, e-mail: teamsilk.tech2@gmail.com

No: DOS:EPRO:RFIX(REQ):1:2026 **Date: 04-11-2026**

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR EMPANELMENT OF MANUFACTURERS/MOU HOLDER / IMPORTER FOR SUPPLY OF SERICULTURE FARM MACHINERIES, REARING EQUIPMENT AND POST COCOON EQUIPMENT FOR THE FINANCIAL YEARS 2026-27 & 2027-28

The Commissioner for Sericulture Development & Director of Sericulture, Department of Sericulture, Bengaluru Invites Request for proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Manufacturers/MOU Holder/ Importer for Supply of Sericulture Farm Machineries, Rearing Equipment and Post Cocoon equipment for the financial years 2026-27 & 2027-28 through e-Procurement Portal of Government of Karnataka (https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in). (SD/2026-27/PREQUAL_TENDER_NUMBER_2).

Last Date for submission on **23-11-2026 upto 5.00 PM.** Prospective bidders can obtain more information on the RFP bid document visiting the web site **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Additional Director of Sericulture (Tech)
& Tender Inviting Authority

DIPR/CP/SMCL/3622/26-27

TOURISM CORPORATION OF GUJARAT LIMITED (TCGL)

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The project requirements, technical specifications, eligibility criteria, selection process, etc. are included in the Tender documents, which shall be available for download from the websites: **https://tender.nprocure.com/** and **https://www.gujarattourism.com** from **07/11/2026** onwards.
The last date for submission of the **Technical and Financial Bid (online only) is 19/11/2026 up to 17:00 and Technical Bid (physical only) is 19/11/2026 up to 17:00.** **Managing Director**

UP strengthens its law and order

Uttar Pradesh steps up security measures through better policing, crime prevention, technology-led surveillance and focused action against organised crime to enhance public safety

Uttar Pradesh has intensified efforts to strengthen law and order through improved policing, crime prevention and technology-driven surveillance. Under the guidance of Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath, the state has focused on tackling organised crime, curbing cyber offences and enhancing women's safety.

Cybercrime police stations are operational in all 75 districts, while cyber cells and help desks have been set up at district police stations. Measures such as anti-romeo squads, Mission Shakti centres and women PAC battalions aim to improve women's safety.

The emergency response system, UP-112, has been strengthened, with a reported response time of 5 minutes and 56 seconds. Various CCTV cameras have also been installed to enhance surveillance and assist investigations.

Action against organised crime includes proceedings under the Gangsters Act and National Security Act, seizure of illegally acquired properties and focused prosecution under Operation Conviction. Together, these measures aim to make policing more responsive, strengthen public safety and reinforce citizens' confidence in law enforcement.

PICS: DIPR, GOVT OF UP

Stronger Systems for a Safer State

FIGURE	DETAILS
5 minutes 56 seconds	Current response time of UP-112
1010	Actions taken under the NSA
43,155	Individuals against whom legal action was taken during anti-romeo operations
₹15,516 crore	Estimated value of illegal properties seized under the Gangsters Act
3	Women PAC battalions formed
5	Additional women PAC battalions in the process of formation
₹4,055 crore	Value of illegal properties seized from mafias and criminals
36+ mafias and 109 organised criminals	More than 36 mafias and 109 organised criminals secured stringent sentences through intensive prosecution
314	Criminals killed in encounters between March 20, 2017, and September 6, 2026
1,56,021	Accused persons convicted under Operation Conviction during July 1, 2023 to September 8, 2026
12,202	Criminals injured in encounters
15,917	Convictions in cases registered under the POCSO Act
24,094	Wanted criminals carrying rewards arrested and sent to jail
4,784	Convictions in rape cases

EMERGENCY HELPLINE NUMBERS

- **1030** Cyber Crime Helpline
- **1076** CM Helpline
- **101** Fire Helpline
- **1090** Women Power Helpline
- **1098** Child Helpline
- **102** Pregnant and Newborn Care Helpline
- **108** Ambulance Service
- **112** Emergency Police Service

Firm Action, Stronger Public Safety

07	Women's Police Stations
04	Water Police Outposts
75	Electricity Theft Police Stations
04	Economic Offences Unit Police Stations
06	New Narcotics Police Stations
12.50 lakh+	CCTV cameras installed under operation trinetra
95	New Police Outposts
78	Women's Police Outposts/Counselling Centres
10	Vigilance Establishment Police Stations
75	Cybercrime Police Stations
75	Anti-Human Trafficking Units converted into police stations
19,834	Women police personnel appointed

ENHANCING SECURITY ON ALL FRONTS

CHECK ON CYBERSECURITY

- Cybercrime police stations are operational in all 75 districts of the state
- Cyber cells/help desks have been established in all district police stations
- Provision for freezing/holding funds linked to cybercrime through National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal and helpline 1930

PROMPT POLICE ASSISTANCE

- UP-112 gets more resources and citizen-friendly initiatives
- A decision has been taken to launch a link service to provide a secure environment for industrial establishments
- Integration of 1090, GRP, Fire Services, and Women's Helpline 181

WOMEN'S AND GIRLS' SAFETY

- Effective operation of anti-romeo squads to curb incidents of harassment
- Establishment of Mission Shakti Centres at every police station
- Formation and expansion of women PAC battalions to strengthen women's safety
- Formation of the Women and Child Security Organisation 1090

FIGHT AGAINST ORGANISED CRIME

- Effective police action against hardened criminals
- Action under the Gangsters Act and National Security Act (NSA)
- Seizure of illegally acquired properties belonging to mafias and criminals
- Effective prosecution under Operation Conviction

READER ENGAGEMENT INITIATIVE

AI fears, oil cheers: Trump's loss may be India's gain, and BJP's too

SWAMINOMICS

SWAMINATHAN S ANKLESARIA AIYAR

India has recently suffered from three vicious circles involving stock markets, oil prices, and the rupee. Now, Donald Trump's midterm setback could reverse all three, converting vicious circles into virtuous ones.

Foreign institutional investors (FIIs) had been fleeing India as though it were plague-stricken. But they suddenly poured almost Rs 15,000 crore into Indian equities on Thursday, their biggest single-day purchase in over a year. Nifty jumped 2.4% to 24,536.60.

This could mark a turning point in the Indian economy. That, in turn, could boost BJP's prospects in the coming state elections in 2027 in Uttar Pradesh, Goa, Uttarakhand, and Manipur, with some possible gains in Punjab.

Consider the first vicious circle. Global investors fascinated with artificial intelligence poured trillions into related companies in the US, Korea, and Taiwan. Countries lacking comparable AI-related giants, including India, became relatively unattractive. Foreign investors sold almost $5 billion of Indian equities in the first half of October.

Since Trump's electoral setback, US equities have crashed; a trillion dollars was wiped off the stock value of seven of the world's biggest tech companies, including Apple and Tesla, on Friday. Suddenly, the AI boom is looking like a bubble. Then there is the prospect of Democrats regulating AI and curbing the proliferation of giant data centres through new legislation when they take control of the US Congress in Jan.

Possibility of Iran de-escalation has lowered oil prices. If decline holds, cheaper oil will lower India's import bill, narrow current-account deficit, and reduce inflation

Greater regulation, environmental restrictions, and stock-market reassessment of AI profitability could reverse the billions that earlier flowed from emerging markets like India to AI-heavy countries.

A second potential bonus may flow from Democrats opposing power-hungry data centres. This could force US companies to outsource these, each worth billions of dollars. India is already a major recipient of data centre investment and potentially stands to benefit still more.

The second vicious circle began with oil. Trump's Iran war sent petroleum prices soaring, worsening India's trade deficit and inflation. After his midterm debacle, Trump's own party will strongly urge him to end the war. He was hustled into the war by Israel's Netanyahu. But Netanyahu's bloc lost its governing majority in Israel's recent election, while Trump has said he wants to end US aid to Israel by year-end—a plan whose details remain unclear. That suggests an end to the Netanyahu-inspired war may be near.

The possibility of de-escalation has already seen Brent oil prices fall sharply from $115 on Oct 28 to under $100/barrel, and US crude to just $91/barrel. Cheaper oil will lower India's import bill, narrow its current-account deficit, and reduce inflation. Lower transport and energy costs will improve corporate profitability, exports, and household purchasing power. The Reserve Bank will have more room to ease monetary policy.

Cheaper oil will also reduce US inflation, potentially persuading the Fed to abandon further interest-rate increases or even contemplate cuts. Higher US interest rates have sucked capital out of emerging markets. Falling interest rates will reverse that flow.

The third vicious circle involves the rupee. Rising oil imports increased the demand for dollars, while fleeing foreign investors reduced their supply. Rupee depreciation then reduced the dollar returns earned by foreign investors in India, encouraging still more selling.

PIN IN AI BUBBLE: Earlier, billions flowed from emerging markets like India to AI-heavy countries like the US. The tide may now be reversed

Now imagine the reverse. Cheaper oil narrows the trade deficit. Lower US interest rates encourage capital inflows. These strengthen confidence in the rupee, maybe even producing modest appreciation. A stronger rupee will reduce imported inflation, improve foreign investors' dollar returns, and attract further inflows.

The three virtuous circles will reinforce one another. Rising equities attract foreign capital, foreign capital strengthens the rupee, and a stronger rupee attracts still more foreign capital. Lower inflation and interest rates improve corporate earnings, justifying higher share prices.

Now, for some caveats. Democrats cannot simply end Trump's war by passing a resolution: the man himself needs to change tack. But Trump has often surprised us all. He may surprise us again by doubling down on Iran, but one can be an optimist. Stronger AI regulation could hurt India's technology-services exports even while helping its relative stock-market attractiveness. Nor will the Federal Reserve automatically cut rates merely because oil becomes cheaper.

Nevertheless, the direction of change is encouraging. Vinod Nair of Geojit Investments rightly cautions that the rally's durability depends on whether hopes of de-escalation produce concrete results. Stock markets have a nasty habit of celebrating victories before they occur.

But financial markets move on expectations, not merely accomplished facts. Thursday's FII buying in India suggests investors are already reassessing India. This could be the beginning of a much larger reversal.

There is a final political irony. The economic optimism generated by Trump's defeat could help NDA in India's approaching assembly elections. Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) agitations against SIR in Delhi had soured India's mood and could have dented BJP's votes. Trump's defeat could now lift economic sentiment, potentially offsetting the impact of the CJP. BJP electoral victories are far from assured, but are more likely.

UP chief minister Yogi Adityanath may yet benefit from the "foreign hand" that his party has often complained of. ■

When the Angry Young Man turns toxic

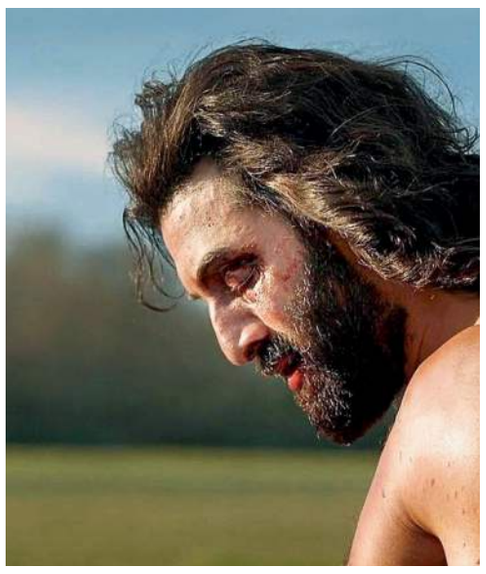
BY INVITATION

NAMRATA JOSHI

Anger is an elemental state of the human mind, an emotion that often manifests as violence, both physical and psychological, inflicted on others or on oneself. As Raudra — one of the Navarasas in Indian performance traditions — anger has been integral to our classical arts and popular culture. However, the way violence is depicted has triggered debates about whether the media and cinema reflect the rage around us or fuel it further in impressionable audiences by making it look cool.

Two recent brutal classroom assaults have sparked this discussion yet again. In one, an eight-year-old boy studying in Class 3 assaulted a six-year-old kindergarten girl in Panchkula. The attack is being linked to violent video games such as PUBG: Battlegrounds, which is itself inspired by the 2000 Japanese film 'Battle Royale'.

In the other case, in Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh, a 21-year-old man, rebuffed by a teenage girl, created mayhem with a chainsaw, severely injuring her and a fellow student in their Standard 10 classroom. Some have speculated that he was influenced by popular films that celebrate the spurned lover and his rowdy ferocity.



GUSSA OVER GORE: 'Raudra rasa' is integral to classical arts and popular culture. The problem is when rage is normalised and glorified

It's a chicken-and-egg conundrum, and one that has people divided. One side sees cinema as a convenient scapegoat to deflect attention from entrenched individual, familial, societal and community ills. The other firmly believes that on-screen bloodshed and brutality are being internalised by the young, given cinema's huge influence on everything from fashion trends and hairstyles to wedding celebrations. Even an essentially North Indian Hindu festival such as Karwa Chauth has gone pan-India, thanks to romantic moon-sightings on screen.

Debate has divided people. One side says cinema has become a scapegoat. The other believes on-screen bloodshed is being internalised by the young, given cinema's influence on everything from fashion trends to weddings

Whatever side of the argument you're on, there is no denying that young people are coming of age amid violence at home and in public. The NCRB's 2024 report says 'cruelty by husband or relatives' accounted for 27% of crimes against women. Beyond the home, hate politics has often put marginalised groups—targeted on grounds of gender, caste, class or religion—in the line of attack.

Cinema too has become all about pummeling the other to submission, be it a nation ('Dhurandhar'), a woman ("Tere Ishq Mein') or a dynasty ('Chhaava').

No passionate cinephile would ever cringe at or object to the portrayal of violence in films, nor call for a ban on it. Some of our most seminal and beloved films have dealt head-on with it. The problem is not with the subject itself but with how a film chooses to approach it. Most filmmakers have not just been adding to the din with their pathological male narratives ('Kabir Singh', 'Animal') but have been normalising, validating and glorifying male violence, with anger becoming an instrument of unbridled rampage.

It's not as though anger has never been a motif in our films. But in the 1950s, it was often a clarion call for change, tied to a cause and social justice. Take Birju in 'Mother India' (1957), whose restlessness and angst were directed against the exploitative moneylender, paving the way for several portrayals of the anti-establishment baaghi or daaku (rebel or bandit) in Indian cinema. But Birju is still made to pay for his intransigence: he is shot by his own mother.

The iconic working-class Angry Young Man of the 1970s nursed a righteous rage against the corrupt system, which often became the reason he turned vigilante. In the 1980s, that vigilante figure mutated into a lumpen, with questionable ways of dealing with women, often objectifying and harassing them in the name of love. In the 1990s, cinema catered to upwardly mobile, urban and NRI viewers; there was no place for rage in the comfortable world of its consumers.

Like the 'not all men' defence, many filmmakers will point out rightly that not all contemporary movies endorse violence. A few good mainstream films have refused to pander to the audience's bloodthirst, instead forcing them to grapple with it and do some introspection. Honey Trehan's 'Satluj' (2026) shook us with the monstrosities that the ruthless state can heap on its citizens. Vetrimaaran's 'Visaranai' (Tamil, 2015) was a visceral exploration of the exploitation of the poor and the powerless at the hands of the police. When it comes to independent cinema, Anmol Sidhu's Punjabi language 'Jaggi' (2022) made us confront the horrors and cruelty faced by a man who can't live up to the ideals of manhood in a hypermasculine world. In P S Vinothraj's 'Kottukkaali' (Tamil, 2024), the simmering rage of a woman in love with a man from a lower caste is pitched against the patriarchal fury of the man she has been betrothed to. In Nagraj Manjule's Marathi feature debut, 'Fandry' (2013), a stone hurled in anger by the young Jabya, who belongs to the oppressed community of pig-catchers, becomes a metaphor for the resistance of the disempowered.

The trouble is not that films show rage; it's when they make us perceive casual, wayward violence as dope. ■

My life's like a movie. I wanted to show people you can be a hero in your own life

"Life will hurt you if you don't fight," writes ***Sylvester Stallone*** *in his memoir, 'The Steps'. And fight he did, enduring years of rejection and hardship before finally getting to star in a film he had written himself. Fifty years later, 'Rocky' is a classic and Stallone a Hollywood legend. In a video interview with* ***Neelam Raaj****, the 80-year-old actor talks about the anger that drove him to succeed and how he has made peace with his past*

You revisit many painful moments about your abusive father and your mother's refusal to attend the Oscars with you. Did writing help you make sense of that pain?
It doesn't make the pain go away. But when you're 80, you can be a little more flexible in your understanding. My parents had problems of their own, but they didn't know how to deal with them. I learned how to deal with mine. As I once wrote: "People have to get rid of their problems, or their problems will get rid of them."

There is pain but also anger: at people who wrote you off, at Francis Ford Coppola for making you wait hours to audition, and even at Richard Gere for getting chicken grease on your trousers during a shoot. Has that rage subsided?

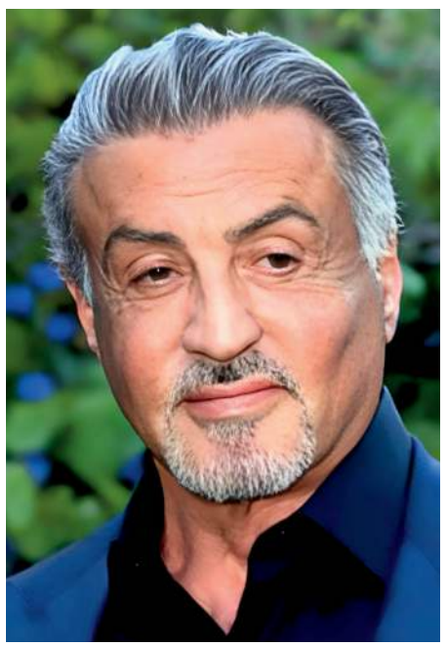
A little bit. Now, I put it into a performance. It comes in handy because it's authentic. It will never go away, but I used to bring it out much more when I was 30 or 40. That has changed. I want to spend my final years in peace with my family, without all the stress. Stress comes from carrying your history and your past with you. It finally did go away. It took a while.

It's been quite a hellish ride – from living on raw eggs and cottage cheese, and doing jobs like cleaning out lion cages at a zoo to ending up in a detention centre. What made you finally put it all down for the world to read?
My life has basically been like a movie, and I wanted to show that you can go through terrible experiences but eventually use them to become successful. I wanted people to understand that you don't have to be a hero in a movie; you can be a real hero in your own life.

This may sound a little crazy, but if I'd had a gentle, respectful, loving childhood, I wouldn't have had that fire inside. So many people who do wonderful things are driven by something inside—a hunger, an inferiority complex they want to overcome. An inferiority complex isn't necessarily a bad thing. If you think you're superior, you can't be taught anything. But when you're insecure, you're motivated to do something better and become less insecure. I think almost every performer and artist is driven by that.

Even billionaires...
Businesspeople especially. To become a billionaire, you have to have something ferocious inside you, almost like a killer instinct. It's not easy, or everyone would do it.

'Rocky', with its message of enduring hope, is about the American dream. Fifty years later, has it become harder to attain it?
Oh, yes. For a variety of reasons. Technology, I think, has given people less of the 'eye of the tiger'. They're not as hungry. It's become easier to find knowledge and understand how things work. Before, you had to go to a library, do research and study. Now, you can learn about the whole world without leaving home. It's also become more competitive and difficult for younger people. The easier technology makes life, the harder it is to become successful, because you don't have that hunger.



FOR THE RECORD

Art seems to have played a big role in your life. In fact, you painted Rocky before you wrote the screenplay. What does painting give you that writing doesn't?
Even before that, when I was making a film called 'Paradise Alley', I drew all the characters. Painting wakes your brain up. Writing is difficult because you look at a blank piece of paper and wonder where to start. Writing is also very precise. I call it mathematics with letters. The sentence has to add up. I constantly rewrite to make it more profound and tighter. Painting gives your mind time to think: this character has a girlfriend; he has a dog. As you paint, your brain is working.

You're also a collector, with works by Picasso, Warhol and many other masters. When did the collecting start?
As soon as I had a little money. In 1976, I was finally able to go to Europe. I bought some mosaics and a few sculptures, and then eventually some paintings. Back then, you could buy masterpieces that would be worth $50 million today for $50,000. Unfortunately, I kept selling them. It was stupid.

Is there a painting you particularly regret selling?
Oh, God, yes. I had a Monet that was a masterpiece. I paid $100,000 and sold it for $3m. It ended up selling for $140m. The same thing happened with Francis Bacon and René Magritte. I had Degas, too. If I had kept them, I could have retired.

At 80, you're still working — acting in 'Tulsa King' and writing for the show. What keeps you going?
That's a mystery. I don't wake up and say, "You have to go to work." You just want to—especially when you're working on a show like 'Tulsa King'. You can ask my wife: I don't sleep past 4:30 or 5 am. This morning before our interview, I got up and wrote about 25 pages of the next episode.

You write about the hours you spent at the New York Public Library. Who was your biggest literary influence?
As a writer, I was very amateurish at first. I wrote only about things that happened to me, and it was pretty boring. Then I started writing about a very famous author, Edgar Allan Poe. Researching Poe taught me how to write more sophisticatedly, because I was writing about a real person. I must have gone to the library a hundred times. I studied everything about him because everyone had a different opinion: he was a genius, a monster, manic-depressive. He influenced an entire genre of horror filmmaking.

You write about wanting the boxing scenes in 'Rocky' to look authentic, even clashing with the boxing director. Did you watch a lot of fights to get it right?
I decided to study all the great fights of the past hundred years. You take little pieces and think, "That was nice; I'll borrow that." I realised it had to become like a ballet—a violent ballet, with in-and-out movements. It takes months and months, and many accidents, to do it. But it was worth it.

You've clarified that 'Rocky' was inspired by a boxer called Rocky Marciano, and not the Muhammad Ali-Chuck Wepner fight. Did Ali influence the film in any way?
Ali was the idea for Apollo Creed. I may never have written Apollo Creed if there had been no Muhammad Ali. That's where I borrowed it all from.

After your son Sage died, you had a Hindu shraddha ritual performed for him. Are you spiritual?
I embraced spirituality very early. I remember J Krishnamurti and other great philosophers from when I was about 17 or 18. I read books like Siddhartha, about the journey of Buddhism, and books on Hinduism. In the '60s, yoga and Indian philosophy were very popular. I like both Indian food and Indian philosophy!

Dem good show! What midterms say about future of populism

BY INVITATION

AMITAV ACHARYA

The US midterm results brought cheer to Democrats and relief to those who aspire to a more democratic world. Though Trump is still in office – in fact, he remains powerful and possibly more vengeful – this is a chance to restore America's checks and balances, critically undermined by Republican control of both houses. Congress cannot rule the country or overturn tariffs, but it can frustrate Trump and make his Iran war much harder to sustain by passing the war powers resolution, which the Republican majority repeatedly blocked.

Foreign policy is rarely decisive in US elections, unless it creates or aggravates domestic economic misery. The Iran war did just that, raising fuel prices, stoking inflation and unsettling voters, much as the backlash against George W Bush's Iraq war flipped both houses to the Democrats in 2006.

Elections in Brazil and Serbia offer two recent examples of how right-wing populism can be checked at the ballot box. In Brazil, Lula's victory after losing the first round to far-right rival Flávio Bolsonaro was stunning. His win, made possible by heightened mobilisation of his supporters, warded off, at least temporarily, a right-wing takeover. Lula's support for multilateralism, the international rule of law and Global South solidarity makes him a more vocal challenger to Western dominance than many other BRICS leaders. A Bolsonaro victory would have undercut that agenda. His win also halted, if not reversed, a run of right-wing victories in Latin America, where democracy is not a wave but a pendulum.

In Serbia, the defeat of the parliamentary alliance led by long-time right-wing leader Aleksandar Vu i shows that the right-wing movement has limits. Together, they show that neither democracy nor right-wing populism is irreversible or universal. One should be careful about judging either's longevity over a limited period.

After the Cold War, pro-democracy forces celebrated democracy's "third wave". It lasted a couple of decades before a turn to right-wing populism, akin to authoritarianism, and fears of a right-wing takeover, particularly in Europe and Latin America. But the world will always remain a mix of polities. There will be no end of history, as Francis Fukuyama predicted, and the fear of right-wing populism was somewhat overblown. Democracy, authoritarianism (with right-wing populism a subset), communitarianism, socialism and extremism will compete and sometimes coexist, with none prevailing for long. This is what I call a multiplex world: not the end of history, but the end of the end-of-history thesis.

Democracy has a chequered history. After ancient Greece, it largely disappeared, reviving with the American founding and the French Revolution, and became global only in the 19th and 20th centuries. Yet republican government, popular participation through councils, and freedom of expression also developed elsewhere, including ancient India. Ideas of popular legitimation existed in Confucian China and in Buddhism, which offered an early social contract theory of the state: government not as divine rule but as a contract to manage society's growing complexity. As a political philosophy, Buddhism legitimised rulers from China to Southeast Asia.

Democracy, authoritarianism, communitarianism, socialism and extremism will compete and sometimes coexist, with none prevailing for long. This is what I call a multiplex world

BEATEN RED AND BLUE: Populists like Trump may win with slogans but delivery is essential to longevity

Democracy, or at least resistance to authoritarian rule, is not uniquely Western. American voters deserve credit for restraining Trump at the ballot box, but his presidency exposed institutional weaknesses. The Global South has a stronger tradition of people's power, often expressed through large-scale peaceful mobilisation. America's No Kings demonstrations were limited by comparison, which is one reason the scale of the Democratic victory surprised so many.

The midterms are also a warning to authoritarian and populist rulers in the Global South, Eastern Europe and elsewhere who indulge in corruption and misrule, overpromise and harass opponents, and to those who play religion and ideology as electoral cards. Trump, who backed such rulers abroad, is no longer an attractive model. His authoritarian friends and allies in the Global South, from Pakistan to Argentina and Venezuela, will be alarmed and deprived of some oxygen. This may mark the point of reversal in the spread of Trump-like populism.

Populists may win with slogans about making their country great again, but delivery is critical to their longevity. A key reason for the Republican loss was Trump's failure to keep his promises: on the economy, on ending the Ukraine war, and on an Iran war he said would end soon but has lasted over six months. Political scientists call this performance legitimacy. Authoritarian rulers in East and Southeast Asia survived not just through repression but by delivering economic growth. The gap between promise and performance can catch up with you, perhaps sooner than you think.

But Democrats in the US, and democratically elected leaders from India and Brazil to South Africa and Indonesia, would do well to keep in mind that electoral legitimacy sans economic performance will bring about their downfall. Identity politics is no substitute. ■

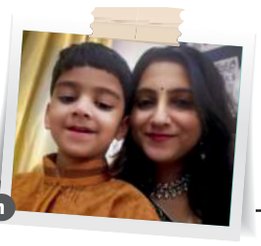
Acharya is the author of 'The Once and Future World Order: Why Global Civilization Will Survive the Decline of the West'

WORD DROP

MOGGING

A friend walks into a party in a sharp new jacket and every head turns. He just 'mogged' the room. Mogging is internet slang for outshining someone so thoroughly that everyone else looks ordinary by comparison. It could be a colleague whose presentation makes yours look amateur, or a new phone that makes your old one feel obsolete. Mogging outshone all other entries to be crowned word of the year by Collins dictionary after usage rose 210% in 2026. The irony is that mogging, now a playful compliment, began as a hierarchy-obsessed term. It was born in pickup artist and manosphere forums where the big question was who the 'AMOG' (alpha male of the group) was. Today, the word may be stripped of its toxic origins but the idea underneath is the same: it's all about who won the room.

Email your letters to the editor at *sunday.times@timesofindia.com* with 'Sunday Mailbox' in the subject line. Please mention your name and city



Pooja with Vidhaan

Times Parenting #ShotOfTheDay
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THE HARSH TRUTH ABOUT 'GENTLE PARENTING' AND HOW TO FIX IT

The child-raising philosophy that swaps punishment and shame with connection and communication has recently come under sharp criticism from parents for creating a generation of entitled teens

Neha Bhayana

Image: AI

Like most young moms, Bengaluru-based Supriti Daga has been following the popular gentle parenting system in her home. She rarely scolds her four-year-old son, Adhrit, and never punishes him for his mistakes. Instead, she explains and offers choices. But when Daga enrolled Adhrit in sports classes recently, she began to wonder whether she had been doing the right thing. "The moment a coach is a little strict, raises his voice or corrects him, he just doesn't want to go back to the class," Daga confessed in an Instagram post. "While I don't want to teach my child that it is okay for someone to shout at him, I also don't want him to walk away from every uncomfortable situation. I'm in a dilemma," she added.

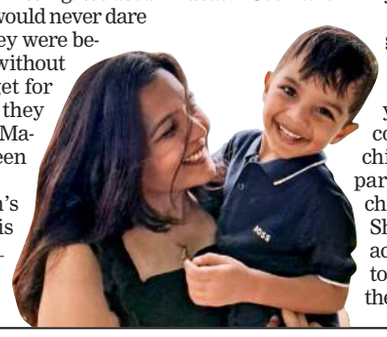
Daga is not alone. Many parents today feel that while gentle parenting sounds good in theory, and is certainly better than the authoritarian 'because-I-said-so" approach of the past, it may not necessarily be the best way to prepare children for the real world.

The term 'gentle parenting' was introduced by British psychologist Sarah Ockwell-Smith in 2016 and gained momentum during the pandemic, powered by social media. The method encouraged parents to view situations from the child's perspective, consider their emotions, and treat them with respect. It advocated using connection and communication rather than fear and shame to teach kids, and promised parents calmer homes with composed, mature children. Considering that many Gen X and millennial parents had grown up in homes where scolding, and even spanking, was considered normal, they wholeheartedly embraced this kinder and more egalitarian philosophy. But now that the first generation of 'gently-raised' kids have entered their pre-teens and teens, many are wondering if they made the right decision. Just type the word gentle parenting on the Gram and you are inundated with posts where parents sharply criticise this system, mock crying about how "gentle parenting is making them mental", and also mourning how spoilt and entitled their kids have become.

COLLAPSE OF AUTHORITY

Many couples who have been following gentle parenting admit that while they have not yelled at (or hit) their child, they have been at the receiving end. "The hierarchy is missing. We used to look up to our parents and would never dare to talk back even if we felt they were being unfair, but our kids shout without inhibition. Is this what we get for being gentle parents? I wish they were a bit scared of me," says Manurag Kaur, mom of a pre-teen and a teen.

Last year, a British mom's video went viral where she is seen sitting on the porch while her four-year-old daughter repeatedly hits her and even throws a plastic chair at her because she is not being allowed to enter the house. The mom patiently explains that they will go inside when she calms down and keeps repeating the prescribed gentle parenting phrase: "Hands are not for hitting", and tells the child she is getting hurt. But the girl does not listen. The mother confesses in the caption that gentle parenting does not work for her child. Many resonated with her and also criticised her for allowing the child to hurt her. A popular TikToker recently rejected the approach, saying, "Gentle parenting is for gentle kids, and mine are raging raccoons." Many teachers have also used social media to point to the growing behavioural crisis in schools, saying they can spot gently parented kids from a distance because they are the worst behaved ones.



SWEET MOM OF MINE: Supriti Daga never scolds little Adhrit

WHAT WENT WRONG

Parenting experts say the problem is not with gentle parenting as a system, but with how it has been interpreted and misunderstood to be permissive parenting (letting children do whatever they want). Parentingss coach Pallavi Chaturvedi says parents have pushed gentle parenting too far and made it almost equivalent to lack of instruction, boundaries, and clarity of who is in charge. "The intent behind gentle parenting came from a good place. It was about building a home with no physical punishment, fewer instructions and deeper listening. But the line has blurred. It is right that parents are not indulging in corporal punishment, but treating the child with kid gloves is not right either," she says.

Experts point out that in many urban homes today, kids decide what the family eats, where it travels, and even which colour car to buy. "It is one thing to take a child's opinion, quite another to blindly allow everything the child is asking for. They are children after all. They don't have enough information and maturity to make important decisions," says parent educator Seemanthini Iyer.

In an article in Psychology Today, clinical psychologist Corinne Masur notes that in the last 75 years, parenting has become progressively more child-centered, with gentle parenting being the most child-centered of them all. She questions whether it is actually good for children to be central to so many of their parents' thoughts and actions. Syed Sultan Ahmed, chairperson of the Association of International Schools of India, says it is time to take a relook. "Gentle parenting is like a joke in today's world. We tolerate all kinds of behaviour. We have created a bunch of free-thinking young individuals who are great to have a conversation with, but not nice to work or live with. If you thought Gen Z was bad, you'd be surprised as to how bad the next gen is going to turn out to be," says the father of two.

'NO' IS NOT A BAD WORD

Experts say the biggest mistake gentle parenting practitioners make is that they don't say 'no'. They agree even if they don't want to, or they give too many explanations to justify denying their child something. Parenting educator Katy Goodwin notes in an Insta post that 'no' has become "an opening offer", and today's 10-year-olds are arguing every rule like lawyers. "Years of explaining 'no' taught my son that a good enough argument changes the answer," she confesses, adding: "Gentle parenting got the warmth right, but what is missing is a 'no' that holds. We need to set a limit that does not move. So, say no and let the child be upset with you while being close by."

Iyer says a 'good parent' can still say no and correct their child. If your child is having a meltdown in the toy shop, and everybody is staring at you and judging your parenting, you can still refuse. Excuses are not going to help. The child is flooded with feelings at that moment, and unable to accept logical explanations. Besides, their brain is just not developed enough to understand the argument. We need to acknowledge the child's feelings but hold firm. Say, "I know you really wanted that toy car, but I can't buy it today. I get how disappointed you are, and I understand that you are really angry with me."

BOUNDARIES ARE BEAUTIFUL

Experts say parents need to remember that it is okay to have some arguments at home. "Conflict by itself has become a bad thing, but respectful conflict is very essential for growth," says Iyer. "We just need to talk to our kids with respect. For instance, you would never yell at your colleague if they didn't do what you asked them to do, or send your mom for a time-out if she didn't heed your advice."

It is also noteworthy that there is little evidence that remaining calm is helpful for children. While extreme outbursts from parents when children misbehave are obviously not good, experts suggest parents remember that there is a natural feedback system which is in place in most parent-infant/child interactions, both in humans and most mammals. When a child or young animal does something dangerous or annoying, the parent naturally reacts with an angry word or growl. From this negative reaction, the child understands that he/she has done something that is not acceptable. So, it is important to respond proportionately.

Experts say parents have forgotten to set boundaries. "Children need boundaries to feel safe and thrive because their brains are still developing. We don't have to rule their life, but they do need guidance," says Iyer.

Ahmed says that a lot of parents today are guilty of being too soft. "You can see how some children are not resilient, and how they find it difficult to handle challenges. There has to be an element of firmness with which we deal with our children. Unfortunately, that is lacking today," he says, adding that he is gentle with his daughters (four and eight) 90% of the time, but firm when required — he does not "allow" them to disrespect elders and staff.

THE PARENTING TREND TRAP

Experts say parents need to stop getting caught up in trends. "One day, people are talking about tiger or panda parenting, and the next day about the FAFO (f*** around, find out) style. But parenting is not about being on-trend. We should try to connect to the child and educate ourselves," says Iyer who works with Parenting Matters, a parent support organisation in Chennai. Ahmed agrees: "A few years ago, everyone was talking about the keto diet. But today we rarely hear about it. The more I learn about children, the less I feel that we need to follow formulas as no two children are the same."

Parenting coaches suggest taking the middle path between being strict and soft. "Parents went from being authoritarian to catering to every whim and fancy of the child," says Chaturvedi. She suggests parents take up an authoritative (not authoritarian) approach where they set clear expectations, while still being the emotional anchor to the child and providing them freedom of choice within limits. "Parental authority is real and kids must deal with it. Your teen does not want to join you for a social outing. That's fine. But there may be a day when you put your foot down and ask them to accompany you for a family wedding. You decide when to allow the child to exercise their preference and when they have to follow your instruction," she says.

BE GENTLE WITH YOURSELF

The most unfortunate aspect of the gentle parenting trend has been that while parents have been "extraordinarily gentle" with the children, they are not-so-gentle with themselves. The first empirical study on gentle parenting, conducted in 2024, found that over one-third of 100 self-identified 'gentle parents' in the US were self-critical and felt ineffective as parents; some even said they were "hanging on for dear life". The researchers, Annie Pezalla and Alice Davidson, said: "The pressures to fulfil exacting parenting standards, coupled with the information overload on social media about the right or wrong ways to care for children, has left many parents questioning their moment-to-moment interactions, leaving them with feelings of burnout."

Chaturvedi points out that cases of burnout among Indian parents are more common now than in the previous generations. "It is time parents get a little lazy, do less, and transfer more responsibility to their children," she says.

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Parent Pulse

NIE NEWSPAPER IN EDUCATION

A column that opens a window into your child's world with insightful articles, activity prompts, and expert tips. Because parenting isn't just about guidance, it's about growing together

BRAINS OVER BUZZ

Turning everyday moments into opportunities for thoughtful learning and growth

Beyond Right and Wrong

- Critical thinking is not about having the right answer; it is about understanding how to arrive at one. In a world full of quick information and easy opinions, children benefit from learning how to question, analyse, and reflect
- This skill does not develop through textbooks alone. It grows through everyday conversations, choices, and experiences

Turning Questions into Conversations

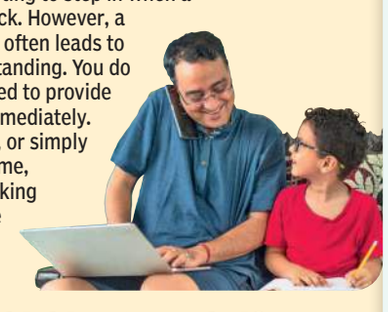
Children are naturally curious, but that curiosity can fade when answers come too quickly. You can support deeper thinking by turning simple moments into meaningful discussions.

Try prompts like:

- "Why do you think that?"
- "What could be another way?"
- "What might happen if we tried something different?"
- These small shifts encourage children to slow down, explore ideas, and build their own understanding

Let Them Work Through It

It can be tempting to step in when a child feels stuck. However, a bit of struggle often leads to better understanding. You do not always need to provide the answer immediately. Offering hints, or simply giving them time, keeps the thinking process active and builds confidence



Linking Thinking to Real Life

- Learning does not have to stay within textbooks. Everyday moments, such as discussing news, making decisions, or solving small problems at home can become powerful learning opportunities
- Talking through choices, weighing options, and considering outcomes helps children see thinking as a practical, everyday skill

Building a Thoughtful Mindset

Developing this habit takes time, patience, and consistent encouragement. With space to question, explore, and reflect, children gradually learn to think independently, approach challenges with curiosity, and make more confident decisions

'Parents should be a lighthouse instead of a helicopter. Show the rocks and let kids sail'

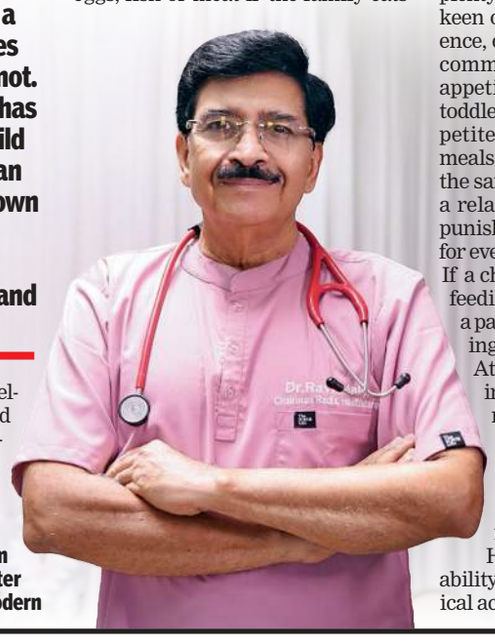
*For over four decades, paediatrician **Dr Ravi Malik** has watched parents and children navigate the everyday challenges of growing up. In his forthcoming book, 'The Parenting Prescription', the Delhi-based doctor questions several entrenched parenting habits — from comparing children with "Sharma ji ka beta" and relying on "because I said so" to being overly protective. In a conversation with **Neha Bhayana**, Dr Malik discusses fussy eaters, parental expectations, and why children should be allowed to play for joy, not just medals*

What is the biggest mistake parents make regarding their child's health?
Comparison. Parents look at a sibling, a classmate, or a cousin and start worrying if that child eats more, behaves better, or is taller. Comparison turns guidance into humiliation, and the worry turns into pressure: forcing food, scolding, as well as a hunt for appetite-boosting tonics. Being the tallest or heaviest child in the class is not a sign of good health. One needs to look at how a child grows over time, on the right growth chart, and keep in mind how the parents themselves grew up. If growth is steady, development is on track, and the child is active and happy, that is reassuring. Forcing a child to eat usually backfires. Meals become a source of fear and anxiety.

Being a parent and a grandparent teaches you things medicine does not. The biggest lesson for me has been humility. Knowing child development does not mean you can predict how your own child will react. You have to listen, adjust your expectations, and understand the child in front of you

China's population has grown taller, reportedly because of better protein intake in childhood. Are modern Indian parents on the right track by prioritising protein?
Paying attention to protein is good, especially for children whose diets are thin or repetitive. But I would not reduce China's height gain to protein alone. Large and long-term studies credit better nutrition overall, healthier mothers, fewer infections, cleaner water and sanitation, better healthcare, sleep and activity, along with genes. No single nutrient did it.

For Indian families, the advice is simple. Give a varied diet with some protein at most meals: dal, rajma, chana, soy, milk, curd, paneer, and eggs, fish or meat if the family eats them. A vegetarian diet, if planned well, gives a child enough protein. But protein cannot make up for a poor diet. Children also need enough calories, vitamins and minerals. Most healthy children eating normal home food do not need protein powders.



"My child does not eat" is a common complaint, yet childhood obesity is rising. Why this paradox?
When a parent tells me "he doesn't eat", they usually mean he doesn't eat what I want him to eat, or as much as I expect. The same child may refuse dal, sabzi and roti and still get plenty of calories from biscuits, namkeen or sweet drinks. In my experience, excess milk is one of the most common reasons a toddler has no appetite for meals. It is normal for toddlers to become choosy. Their appetite goes up and down. Regular meals with planned snacks, offering the same foods again and again, and a relaxed table can help. Pressure, punishment, bargaining, or a reward for every bite can make things worse. If a child is not growing well, or the feeding problem does not settle, see a paediatrician rather than assuming the child is fussy.

At the national level, India is dealing with undernutrition, micronutrient deficiencies and obesity at the same time, sometimes in the same house. A child can be getting too many calories and still be short of iron, vitamins and other nutrients. Heavy marketing and easy availability of junk food and too little physical activity all add to the problem.

You are a father and grandfather. What has parenting taught you that no book could?
My wife (Dr Renu Malik) is an obstetrician. Both our children and their spouses are doctors too, so medicine is a huge part of our home. But being a parent and a grandparent teaches you things medicine does not. The biggest lesson for me has been humility. Knowing child development does not mean you can predict how your own child will react. You have to listen, adjust your expectations and understand the child in front of you.

Earlier generations had something we've lost: free, unstructured play. Children used to come to my clinic with scraped knees; today, they come with anxiety, poor sleep and screen habits. But the answer is not to swing from hovering to hands-off parenting

We think a child has come to be guided by us. In truth, our children and grandchildren guide us just as much.

As a grandfather, I have learnt to slow down, to enjoy a conversation or a game without turning it into a lesson. Children need to feel our love in ordinary moments, not only hear our advice. Spend time with them. Play, read, sing, and answer all the questions on their mind.

According to you, what is an area Indian parents focus on too much? And what do they ignore?
Too much attention goes to what can be seen and measured: finishing every meal, gaining weight, marks, and a timetable packed with classes. Far less goes to the everyday basics of health. Those basics are a varied diet, enough sleep, physical activity, and a secure, loving bond with family. Children need plenty of chances to move and play through the day. Play builds language, social skills and the ability to manage attention and emotions. It deserves its place in childhood without having to end in a certificate or a medal.

You have spoken at length about 'over-parenting' in your book. Do you think parents of previous generations were right to let their kids play outside without constant monitoring? Is laid-back parenting better than today's 'hands-on' approach?
Earlier generations had something we have lost: free, unstructured play. Children used to come to my clinic with scraped knees from the park; today, they come with anxiety, poor sleep and screen habits. But the answer is not to swing from hovering to hands-off. Parents should be a lighthouse, not a helicopter. A lighthouse shows the rocks and trusts the navigator; it does not dive in to rescue every ship. Let children settle small quarrels and survive small failures. Stay close enough to step in when the danger is real.

THE IMPORTANCE OF READING

Why books are your brain's best friend for life

Reading isn't just about finishing chapters. It introduces you to new words, expressions, and ways of thinking. The more you read, the stronger your vocabulary becomes. This makes subjects like science or history easier to understand, because strong language skills help you in every classroom, and exam questions feel easier when you've seen similar words before

Think Better, Learn Deeper : When you read, your brain doesn't just absorb facts; it asks questions, compares ideas, and makes connections. Whether you're discussing a mystery novel with friends or writing about a historical figure, reading sharpens your ability to think, write, and explain clearly. It also builds confidence when you speak or present your thoughts in class

Travel Without a Ticket : Books take you to places you've never been — both real and imaginary. You meet characters from different countries, time periods, and cultures. This helps you understand how people live, what they feel, and how the world works. It also builds empathy and makes you more open-minded

Brain Gym & Relaxation

Just like running strengthens your muscles, reading strengthens your brain. It improves focus and memory, and even reduces stress. Spending time with a good book can calm your mind and give your eyes a break from screens. It's like giving your brain a peaceful holiday while learning something new

Make Reading a Habit

Here are few steps to becoming a reader:

- Read for 15–20 minutes daily—before bedtime or while travelling
- Choose books you enjoy: jokes, comics, mysteries, or non-fiction
- Start a mini book club with friends or family
- Visit your school or public library and explore new shelves!

Lights, sound, camera... These celeb clones are ready for action!

Stars are teaming up with AI studios to create licensed doubles, allowing brands and filmmakers to bypass usual shoot headaches while their avatars keep the till ringing

Mohua.Das@timesofindia.com

Fifteen women cricketers sail into Mumbai harbour on giant Maratha warships. Lavani dancers sway on the dock as Harmanpreet Kaur and her teammates emerge through the Gateway of India in a larger-than-life spectacle, complete with hundreds of extras and a cinematic sunset. Elsewhere, Shah Rukh Khan is congratulating thousands of property investors. Each one hears their name and gets that familiar dimpled smile. Meanwhile, Ayushmann Khurrana is singing a heartbreaking ditty from a mountaintop.

Stars hard at work? Not really. None of them are where they appear to be. This is the celebrity-clone era, where stars can be everywhere and nowhere all at once by renting out their approved AI double to shoot ads, finish scenes, and record personalised messages while the real person gets on with their day.

TWINNING: An AI-generated Harmanpreet Kaur leads teammates through the Gateway of India. (Inset) Hardik Pandya's licensed AI twin starred in a motorcycle ad while the cricketer prepped for the T20 World Cup

SECOND SHIFT

It's a win-win. Celebrities who could once only sell so many hours in a day now have clones who can keep reporting for duty. For instance, while Hardik Pandya was preparing for the T20 World Cup, another Hardik was busy posing for a motorcycle ad. On the other hand, it allows studios to bypass traditional constraints of time and geography, fix scenes overnight or pull off complex shots without calling actors back to set.

Studio Blo, the Mumbai-based AI-native production house behind Pandya's clone, launched what it called the 'official AI clone of Hardik Pandya' some months ago. Dipankar Mukherjee, CEO and co-founder, recalls endorsement contracts carrying broad clauses permitting the use of AI likeness. "We realised early on that unregulated use of celebrity cloning was becoming a problem. Once that clause was signed, celebrity managers had little control, and their shoot schedules became irrelevant," says Mukherjee. "Say a star gets Rs 5 crore for eight hours of shoot. Once they sign off on AI likeness usage, they are available 24/7, 365 days a year, for the same fee. They were losing monetary value."

Studio Blo's answer was Faimous, an ethical cloning platform that facilitates ownership rights of celebrity clones. Brands and agencies can lease access for a fixed period, but every piece of content generated has to be approved by the celebrity before it can be downloaded. Once approved, it carries an invisible, traceable code. "At any point, a celeb can figure out whether an image was created using their authorised clone or whether somebody took a random image from the internet and cloned them," says Mukherjee.

The recent surge in deepfakes that has sent several celebrities to court is also driving interest in authorised clones, says Mukherjee. Vijay Subramaniam of Collective Artists Network (CAN) believes officially licensed AI identities, with "watermarking and provenance systems", will eventually become standard as synthetic media floods the internet. Brands first saw clones as a cheaper substitute before realising their value. "In future, clones will actually become premium assets because you can leverage rights in much bigger ways," he says. Mumbai-based TrueFan AI has built digital avatars for more than 150 public figures, including Shah Rukh Khan, Ranveer Singh, Kareena Kapoor Khan, Anushka Sharma, Rohit Sharma, and Rishabh Pant. Its speciality is turning a single recording into thousands of personalised videos.

"The process involves a five-to-ten-minute recording session that captures likeness, voice, lip sync, and visual mannerisms. The AI trains on those inputs. After that, a single five-minute recording can power thousands of videos across languages, formats, and contexts, without repeated shoots or production cycles," says Nimish Goel, co-founder and CEO of TrueFan AI. The idea, he says, is not to "replace" but to "scale the celebrity infinitely", freeing the brand from "their calendar, cost of production, and the time it takes to shoot in every required language, if it is even feasible". AI, he says, "changes that equation".

Clones have practical uses too. They are being used to finish films after injuries, deaths, and for patchwork shoots. Hollywood got there first. In 2022, Bruce Willis became the first Hollywood star to license his digital twin after his aphasia diagnosis. Last year, an AI clone of Val Kilmer, endorsed by his children, completed scenes in 'As Deep As the Grave' after his passing.

Faces are the easy part. "Visual likeness AI can generate convincingly from photographs alone," says Mukherjee. "Behavioural nuance is what's difficult." Voice, too. "AI can clone a voice accurately, but inflections in how actors speak are difficult to emulate. So, we usually go the traditional dubbing route."

"What makes somebody recognisable is not just how they look, but also how they pause, react, move, smile, or hold emotion between dialogues," says CAN's Subramaniam. His studio has built projects ranging from author Amish Tripathi's digital twin, who presents short-form stories on Indian history and mythology, to actor Rhea Chakraborty's AI alter ego, Mishty. "Audiences forgive visual imperfections much faster than emotional inauthenticity," says Subramaniam.

> Unregulated digital cloning of celebs was becoming a problem. They had little control over its use and were losing monetary value. Now, invisible, traceable codes can distinguish licensed AI twins from unauthorised deepfakes
>
> **Dipankar Mukherjee,** CO-FOUNDER, STUDIO BLO

GHOST IN THE MACHINE

That challenge has created a new category of performers whose faces may never appear on screen. Actors are filmed against chroma screens in a process called performance capture. Their expressions and body movements are then transferred to AI-generated celebrities. "For stunts, you just need a guy to jump out of a helicopter or sit on a horse. AI can handle the rest," says Mukherjee. "Where performance capture becomes necessary is emotional nuance. So, for emotive dialogues, we use performance capture so the clone inherits the actor's limb movement, micro-expressions, and speech patterns."

If the celebrity is well known, performers may spend weeks studying interviews and social media clips to learn how that person reacts, pauses, or moves. The resemblance itself can be surprisingly loose. "We usually try matching the jaw structure."

Mukherjee compares these clone performers to motion-capture actor Andy Serkis, whose performances powered characters like Gollum, King Kong, and Baloo, while he himself remained invisible. "The movie industry has overindexed towards names. Can we compensate talented actors who never got opportunities in traditional cinema?" he asks.

There is a contradiction here. The same technology that makes celebrity identity more valuable is also a way to work around celebrities altogether. "People will continue going to theatres because of big stars. But if you're a great storyteller and don't have money for big-league actors, you should still be able to build a superhero using AI with faceless actors."

There is no formal pool of such performers yet. Studios recruit through casting directors, and contracts spell out exactly how performances will be used. "These performers are not anonymous. They'll be credited, much like voice actors in animation films," says Mukherjee, who believes performance-based work could become an industry in itself and may even perform a minor miracle. "Many sports stars struggle with acting, but now you can clone them and get a very good actor to perform for them," he adds.

APPROVAL FOR AFTERLIFE

Yet, for all the excitement, there are catches. Studio Blo has an internal AI ethics board, chaired by filmmaker Shekhar Kapur, which evaluates politically sensitive commissions, posthumous cloning, and other ethical grey zones. Things become especially thorny when the person being cloned is dead. Mukherjee says, "We're already working on projects involving a deceased musician and a legendary Indian actor, both commissioned by family estates and rights holders." Technically, it can be done. Ethically, he is less certain. "Suppose Dev Anand saab's family agrees to bring him back for a film. Then what stops a beverage brand from making Dev Anand drink cola? Would he want that? Who are we to decide?"

Diwali's not-so-merry gifts go round & round

Vatsala Mamgain

As kids in what seems like the Bronze Age, we celebrated Diwali in a primitive way — courting fire-related hazards by lighting oil lamps and bursting crackers, partying hard like adrenalin-chasing savages, and stuffing our faces with yummies till we were sick all over the oil lamps. Adults spent Diwali preventing said fires and lovingly tending to their diabetes. Now, of course, thanks to rapid progress, these archaic practices are firmly in the past. Today, we celebrate the true essence of this deeply meaningful festival by going shopping.

Of course, I'm kidding! We know that the true essence of Diwali isn't just shopping — it is also competitive gift-giving. And the constant nagging worry that we won't have appropriate gifts to retaliate against everyone who will be giving gifts to us. For those of you who are still struggling in the Diwali shallows and haven't mastered the deeper, more profound values of the season, here as public service is my 'Ready Reckoner to Shopping and Gifting for Diwali':

MITHAI: The OG Diwali shopping and gifting staple. Mithai comes in two basic varieties — delicious and soan papdi. Delicious mithai is a reason to carry on living and, for most of us, the most deeply spiritual and meaningful experience of Diwali. As a self-proclaimed domain expert, I'm happy to share my considered advice on the shopping, gifting, and eating of delicious mithai this Diwali. Just do it.

SOAN PAPDI: Despite its enduring popularity as a Diwali gift, soan papdi is never ever bought. It's a proven fact that there are only 100 boxes of soan papdi in existence. These are packed away inside deep wells and musty caves for 50 weeks of the year. On the other two weeks, which coincide with Diwali, these 100 boxes are brought out, dusted, and wrapped in shiny gold paper and then frenetically gifted and regifted back and forth till Diwali night. It is this energetic re-re-re-gifting that gives the illusion of tens of thousands of soan papdi boxes in existence. Whoever is left holding the parcel when the Diwali music stops is obliged to stash away the box for another year till this whole cycle can begin afresh.

Image: AI

Dryfruit commerce peaks at Diwali and then is pretty static because the dromedary camels need at least 11 months to bring the stash over

LIGHTS: For the Festival of Lights, buying lights every year is non-negotiable. Lights come in two varieties: Chinese and Chinese. The Chinese ones are cheap and twinkle brightly in the shop but will resolutely not work at home. The other Chinese ones are not cheap, but will twinkle brightly on your balcony all the way till choti Diwali. Then they also stop working. A handy tip when buying lights, to save yourself some trouble for the future — shop around for the pre-snarled ones.

DODGY NUTS: Known to us only by their biological name — "Dryfruits." Dryfruits are available everywhere, including plywood and other hardware stores, but it's a rule that the farther you go to get the nuts and the more crowded the place, the better the quality. Everyone has their own "chap", who gets these nuts from where they are produced — a cold, faraway place with dromedary camels and craggy mountains. This chap then sets up shop at locations in Indian cities that obviously remind him of his remote, beautiful home — Crawford Market and Chandni Chowk, for instance. The obvious advantage is that these places help him pass the quality test. Dryfruit commerce peaks at Diwali and then is pretty static because the dromedary camels need at least 11 months to bring the stash over.

SIEVES AND SERVING SPOONS: In keeping with the fact that celebrating the victory of good over evil is traditionally associated in Indian culture with these two household items (kidding again!) Forget good over evil. The goddess of prosperity is propitiated by buying precious metals like gold and silver during Diwali but, for the impoverished amongst us, sieves and serving spoons are kind of, almost, exactly the same thing...

CURATED GOURMET HAMPERS: Modern pre-packaged gifts that artfully combine wicker baskets, hessian cloth, green tea, millets, stevia, and at least one item labelled "artisanal". Characterised as healthy, these hampers contain roughly 0.0% of anything even vaguely qualifying as edible, and therefore are appropriate gifts for people who are into "wellness" or for soan papdi gift-givers.

That's it. Everything I know about how to celebrate Diwali in its truest essence by shopping for yourself and others. In 800 words or less. Happy Diwali. May your lights always shine bright and never be snarled, and your mithai always taste sweet and true. And on Diwali and in life, may you always, always run out of appropriate things to gift loved ones before you run out of loved ones to gift things to.

Mamgain loves food, cooking, running, dogs, trees, books, and telling long-winded stories

FAITH, FILMS AND FORTUNE

Faith can move mountains, and sometimes even the box office. This week is another reminder with Ranbir Kapoor-starrer **'Ramayana: Part 1'** earning Rs 126 cr on the opening day. At a reported budget of Rs 4,000 cr for the two-part story, it is among the most expensive Hindi film projects. Its release also highlights how devotional cinema has expanded from a largely low-budget genre into a market attracting some of the industry's biggest investments

HIGH RETURNS

Some recent devotional films have delivered big bucks, even with low production costs. A striking example is the biographical drama **'Hanuman Ansh'**, based on the life of the spiritual mystic, Neem Karoli Baba. Made on a modest budget of Rs 1.8 cr, the film earned Rs 750 cr with a return on investment of 18,000%, making it one of the most profitable films in recent times. Other hits include the animated movie **'Mahavatar Narsimha' (2025),** and action-devotional films like **'Irumudi'**

BOLDER BETS

This indicates a growing appetite for big-ticket productions. SS Rajamouli's sci-fi epic **'Varanasi',** with a reported budget of Rs 1,400 cr, and **'Jai Hanuman'**, starring Rishab Shetty, (estimated to cost Rs 250-300 cr) are slated for release next year. Other projects on the anvil include **'Mahavatar'**, featuring Vicky Kaushal as Lord Parashurama, Sabarimala-themed Malayalam film **'Harivarasanam'**, and a sequel to **'Hanuman Ansh.'** Call it a leap of faith

Source: koimoi.com

Are the kids alright? Look beyond the screen

An eight-year-old's brutal classroom assault has renewed fears about violent games, but experts also flag unmonitored digital exposure and adults missing early warning signs

Shruti Sonal & Sandeep Rana

If the CCTV footage did not exist, many would struggle to grasp the horrific scenes that unfolded inside a Haryana classroom, as an eight-year-old boy brutally and repeatedly assaulted a kindergarten girl with bricks. Other details soon unfolded: How the attack continued even after the girl lost consciousness, or the nonchalance with which the juvenile allegedly led the authorities to the survivor. In the aftermath, the survivor's family blamed the boy's behaviour on hours spent on aggressive video games, including PUBG and FreeFire. The allegation spread rapidly because it fit a fear many parents already carry — that a screen, a game, an algorithm, or a video clip may be teaching children violence before adults can teach them restraint. Further details from a psychological assessment emerged: the boy allegedly attacked the victim to score points as part of a game-inspired task.

The boy was seemingly oblivious to what he had done. When police arrived, he called them 'mitar' (friend). Later, when produced before the Panchkula juvenile justice board, he smiled and appeared energetic. Assessors would later say that his mind couldn't process the unspeakable horror he had unleashed.

But Panchkula is not an isolated case. In Mumbai's Goregaon, an 18-month-old died after a 10-year-old neighbour allegedly threw her from the building's sixth floor. In Agra, a six-year-old KG student was reportedly bullied, slapped and threatened by an eight-year-old. In Aug 2025, a class VIII student in Ahmedabad hid a knife in his backpack and stabbed a class X student fatally. Later, he uploaded a chilling confession on social media. What is driving children so young to acts of extreme aggression?

Children at ever-younger ages are indulging in violence now, says Monalisa Palit, clinical psychologist for child and adolescent mental health at VIMHANS. The problems faced by teens or older adolescents, she says, are now appearing among kids as young as eight or 10. They struggle with anger, aggression, self-harm, or harm to others, with difficulties emerging earlier than they did a decade ago. But they do not become violent in isolation. "Environment is a contributing factor and needs to be managed by the adults around the child," she says.

> Have children become more violent, or are we not able to nurture the other side of a child enough within their own environment?
>
> **Dr Kavita Arora,** PSYCHIATRIST

Experts point first to exposure — not only to violent games, but to a much larger digital universe where aggression is repetitive, rewarded, and often stripped of consequences. Children watch, imitate, and internalise. "At age seven or eight, children cannot always separate fantasy from reality," says Palit. "If they are exposed to those things multiple times, they may start believing in it. They role play."

Psychologists who assessed the Panchkula boy after the horrific assault say he was so obsessed with the video game that his young mind could no longer distinguish the virtual from the real, game from gore, and guilt from thrill. He even wanted to get a dragon tattoo inspired by a game character. Worryingly, the game (Free Fire), that has over 500 million downloads, is restricted to the 16+ age group but is easily accessible. However, police have not established a conclusive connection between the game and the assault so far.

Image: AI

DIGITAL DESENSITISATION

While it's difficult to pin the blame on a single factor, the discourse around violent video games has raised several questions: Why are younger kids able to access such games without guardrails like age-gating, or why didn't the parents and school spot the warning signs? For younger children, this matters because emotional regulation is still developing. "A child or adolescent acts first and thinks later," Palit says. That developmental reality, she argues, makes adult supervision central. If a child is given a phone, game, or unrestricted feed without being taught how to use it responsibly, the privilege can quickly turn into entitlement.

Vidya Panicker, a Bengaluru-based educator who runs a school, says there is a high level of desensitisation among children today. In many households, the digital devices are shared, she adds, and kids can be exposed to content meant for adults. A child can move from cartoons to violent clips, adult language, or dangerous information through endless scrolling. The second factor psychologists and educators repeatedly identify is parenting, where inconsistent boundaries, weak supervision, and a collapse of coordinated adult response can lead to these problems. Panicker says the response of parents has also changed. Earlier, when a school raised a concern, many parents accepted it as a shared responsibility. "Now, the first response is defensive. Parents brush off negative behaviour and the child starts feeling: 'I can do anything'," she says.

This breakdown is visible inside schools too. Teachers may notice aggression, withdrawal, or bullying, but without a functioning system of counsellors and parents, concerns often surface only after a crisis.

SPOTTING SIGNS EARLY

The early signs, psychologists say, are often visible — but misread. A child who hits, threatens, humiliates others, or becomes unusually defiant is not simply "naughty". A child who withdraws, refuses school, sleeps in class, or repeatedly complains may also be signalling distress. "When negative emotions are running high, children express them through behaviour," says Palit. "We call it maladaptive, but from their perspective, they are acting out against something they are unhappy with."

Dr Kavita Arora, co-founder and senior consultant psychiatrist at Children First, says both "acting up" and "acting down" are warning signs. "Any sign where a child is feeling excluded — whether through verbal aggression or complete withdrawal — should make a teacher or parent ask: what is going on?" Children, she says, often try to tell adults before they react but may not receive a patient hearing. That listening, experts say, is not the same as excusing violence. It means holding the child accountable while also addressing the circumstances that shaped the behaviour.

REFRAMING THE QUESTION

Dr Arora is wary of declaring that children are simply "becoming more violent". She says social media visibility may make violence appear more widespread, but visibility is not the same as epidemiological proof. "I would not begin with the assumption that violence is increasing." Her concern is deeper: the environments in which children grow up are changing in ways that make aggression, distress, and power struggles more visible, and perhaps more available.

The environment includes home, school, digital media, neighbourhood, community, and the larger society. Children born in the last decade have grown up amid academic pressure, competition, bullying, exclusion, screens, online humiliation, aggressive communication, and a public language increasingly shaped by conflict. At the same time, Dr Arora says, the spaces that once taught children cooperation have shrunk. Neighbourhood play has been replaced by malls, structured classes, supervised playdates, and screens, she adds. Parents often tell children that parks and streets are unsafe. Children play less across class, age, and gender. Mixed neighbourhood friendships have thinned. This matters because empathy is learned relationally.

She asks, "Have children become more violent, or are we not able to nurture the other side of a child enough within their environment?"

'White American primacist' Miller is a champion of Trump's unpopular causes

He Believes That Greenland Should Belong To The US

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Any hopes that Donald Trump may soften his policies — or rhetoric — following the midterms debacle seem set to be dashed, with Trump naming anti-immigration hardliner Stephen Miller the new White House chief of staff.

"I am pleased to announce that Stephen Miller...one of my most trusted advisors, will become the Chief of Staff starting Monday. Susie Wiles, who has done an outstanding job, will be moving over to the Trump Political Operation. I want to thank her for her service — She has done a great job!" Trump posted on Truth Social, as he eased her out with finesse in what was clearly a choreographed transition.

For much of the world, including New Delhi, Miller's elevation is unsettling, given his publicly stated views on American primacy, including its purported right to invade and occupy any country in what it deems its sphere of influence. He has also dismissed US-India ties with hauteur, telling Fox News in an interview in Aug 2025, "India portrays itself as being one of our closest friends in the world; but they don't accept our products, they impose massive tariffs on us, we also know they engage in a lot of cheating on immigration policy."

It was an extraordinary broadside, not least because Miller accused New Delhi of "cheating" on immigration policy, which is Washington's remit with no role in it for Indian govt. He also bundled India's trade policy and energy purchases into one indictment of its friendship with America. Although he added that Trump wanted a tremendous relationship with India and PM Narendra Modi, the accompanying message was unmistakable: strategic partnership would not buy New Delhi immunity from the America First treatment.

Miller's remarks were not a passing irritation with trade barriers. He has long been hostile to the expansion of legal immigration, including the H-1B programme which both Indian and US technology companies use to provide services across the world. During Trump's first term, he helped shape the administration's push for the RAISE Act, legislation sponsored by Senator Tom Cotton that sought to slash legal immigration, including family-based migration.

He also advocated changes to the H-1B system, including abandoning its existing lottery in favour of a system that would prioritise higher-paid applicants. Miller's appointment, unlike that of Cabinet secretaries, requires no confirmation hearing, no committee interrogation and no opportunity for lawmakers to examine his views or what he would do with the enormous power that comes with becoming virtually a gatekeeper to the Oval Office and controlling access to President.

Given his reputation as a white American primacist, alarm began coursing through political circles soon after his elevation. Progressive commentator Kyle Kulinski called him a "Jewish Nazi," described him as Trump's "id," and said he represented President's worst instincts. He also invoked the "Hitler in his bunker phase of Trumpism" to describe what he fears is coming next.

While the Nazi comparison is largely polemical, it is a measure of how toxic Miller's reputation has become among opponents of the Trump regime's immigration programme. Miller's critics point to a record that goes well beyond conventional border enforcement.

He championed the family-separation policy during Trump's first term, defended mass deportations, described migrants as an invading force, and most alarmingly, suggested in 2025 that the administration was considering suspending habeas corpus — the very bedrock of American legal and democratic tradition — to accelerate deportations. He has also described the Democratic Party as a "domestic extremist organization."

In other worldviews beyond immigration, Miller has argued that international relations are governed by strength, force and power, defended American claims to Venezuela's oil and said Greenland should obviously belong to the US. His language about the primacy of Western civilisation and his denigration of the developing world has also prompted critics to see something more than conventional American nationalism in his conception of national primacy.

Among his more striking views was a defence of the British Empire he made in a 2022 interview: "The British Empire has been such a benevolent force for good in the world. Its unraveling was a historic tragedy with empires like China, for example, filling that void."

CALLED MIGRANTS 'INVADING FORCE'

- Miller told Fox News in Aug 2025 that **India** presents itself as a close US friend but blocks American products, imposes heavy tariffs, and **engages in "cheating on immigration policy"**
- He has linked **India's energy purchases to financing Russia's war** in Ukraine
- In Trump's first term, **he backed the RAISE Act** to cut legal and family-based immigration
- Miller has described migrants as an **"invading force"**
- Called the Democratic Party a **"domestic extremist organization"**
- Defended American **claims to Venezuela's oil & said Greenland** should belong to the US
- Miller holds the view that **international relations are governed by strength and power**

ON BRITISH EMPIRE

The British Empire has been such a benevolent force for good in the world. Its unraveling was a historic tragedy with empires like China, for example, filling that void
— In a 2022 interview

Woman close to Nvidia CEO likely a China spy, says NYT

US Officials Believe Relationship was Romantic, Says FT

US intelligence officials told the Trump administration that a woman who had become close to Nvidia Chief Executive Officer Jensen Huang was working for a Chinese spy agency, which recruited her to collect information on him, the New York Times reported Friday.

The newspaper cited unnamed sources who it said had been told of American surveillance conducted on the woman, Alice Huang, an executive with an Asian technology company called Megaspeed International. Administration officials learned of the accusations in an intelligence memo, the Times said.

Alice Huang was working for Beijing's ministry of state security, which was manoeuvring to glean more detail about American artificial intelligence chips, according to the Times, and possibly persuade Nvidia to try to make its most sophisticated semiconductors available to the Chinese. It was not clear when or how she met Jensen Huang. The Financial Times, in an article published Friday night, said US officials believe that the relationship was romantic.

The matter has taken on new urgency following this week's US midterm elections, which will give Democrats control of Congress. Republicans also are scrutinising Huang's ties to the alleged spy.

The House Select Committee on China said in a statement Thursday that it had sent a letter to Jensen Huang "requesting his participation in a joint, closed-door briefing."

"The letter details the lawmakers' concerns regarding Huang's interactions with Megaspeed executive Alice Huang, a publicly reported Chinese intelligence asset, and the company's security protocols against foreign adversary espionage," the panel said in the statement. Megaspeed is part of Nvidia's cloud partner network. The Singapore-based company buys equipment from the chipmaker and rents out computing power to AI developers.

Nvidia said in a statement after the New York Times article was published that its cloud partners "do not ask us to seek changes in US law or advocate for sales to China." The company added that "anyone seeking classified information through our NCP customers would have hit a dead end. We neither have nor share classified information with customers."

Asked about the FT report regarding a possible romantic relationship, Nvidia referred to previous comments by Jensen Huang that he had a typical business relationship with Alice Huang.

The Central Intelligence Agency and the Office of the Director of National Intelligence did not immediately respond to requests for comment on Friday evening.

In an interview last week, Jensen Huang defended his dealings with Megaspeed, calling them "normal and not unusual," while stressing that the company has checked to ensure that Megaspeed didn't illegally send Nvidia's artificial intelligence processors to China. BLOOMBERG

Reuters

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang speaks to Microducks, 25cm tall biped robots, at the NVIDIA GTC conference, in Berlin on Oct 21

US offers $20m for Iran's N-info; sanctions 8 Canadian companies

Washington is offering a $20 million reward "and possible relocation" for information about Iran's nuclear programme, the US military said Friday, as President Donald Trump reiterated Tehran wants to make a deal to end the war.

A state department programme, Rewards for Justice, "is offering a reward of up to $20 million and possible relocation for information about Iran's nuclear program, including its facilities, equipment, and associated personnel, such as those in the scientific community," US Central Command said on X.

The programme was established in 1984 under the state department's national security rewards programme to offer money for information that protects American lives and interests.

On Friday, the US imposed sanctions on eight Canadian entities over allegations that they enabled international transactions involving Iran. The treasury department announced new penalties on money services it claimed were helping Tehran and individuals with connections to the country exchange Iranian rials and other currencies for digital assets. According to a statement, some of the entities also worked with Ryan Wedding, a former Olympian accused by the FBI of running one of the world's largest cocaine networks.

The US coordinated the move with Canada's financial intelligence unit, Fintrac, and the Financial Crimes Enforcement Network. BLOOMBERG

US military looks to curb Iranian land commerce

Washington: After a months-long naval blockade on Iran, the US military is setting up a task force to bolster Washington's efforts to restrict Tehran's movement of advanced weapons systems and other sanctioned material across its land borders and Caspian Sea.

The announcement of the task force, which has not been previously reported, will be made later on Saturday by US Central Command, according to a statement seen by Reuters ahead of its release.

Task Force Iron Gate, as it will be called, will be based in Tampa, Florida, and will coordinate with other US govt agencies. Beyond movement of weapons, it will also focus on dual-use and illegal revenue streams. "Strengthening CENTCOM's collaboration with US interagency partners will further constrain Iran's ability to finance terrorism, rebuild weapons factories, and replenish their military," Admiral Brad Cooper, the commander of Central Command, said in a statement. REUTERS

US urges China to meet rare earths commitment ahead of Trump-Xi meet

Washington: The Trump administration warned a top Chinese official on Friday that Beijing must immediately implement its commitments under a nearly year-old trade agreement, particularly on delivery of rare earths and other critical minerals and agricultural purchases, the US Trade Representative's Office said.

Treasury secretary Scott Bessent and US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer urged Chinese vice premier He Lifeng in a call to implement terms of the pact agreed in Busan, South Korea, in Oct 2025, the US agencies said.

"During the call, Ambassador Greer emphasized the critical importance of China taking concrete actions to fully implement its past commitments, particularly as they relate to agricultural purchases, rare earths, and other critical minerals," USTR said in a statement.

During the call, China expressed "serious concern" over recent US trade restrictions targeting Beijing, China's official Xinhua news agency said. But He, China's lead negotiator on trade relations with the US, agreed with his US counterparts to continue using consultation for "stable and positive" development of trade ties.

Presidents Donald Trump and Xi Jinping are expected to meet at the summit of the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum in Shenzhen, China, on Nov 18 and 19, and the Group of 20 summit in Miami on Dec 14 and 15. REUTERS

Pak astronaut to join China's space mission

A Pakistani astronaut will become the first foreigner to visit China's space station when they join the country's next mission into orbit, Beijing's manned space agency said on Saturday.

Pakistan and China are close diplomatic and strategic partners and signed a deal in Feb 2025 setting up a Chinese govt training programme for Pakistani astronauts. The Pakistani astronaut will take off with the Shenzhou-24 crew, the China Manned Space Agency said on social media.

The agency did not name the Pakistani crew member, but said in April that astronauts Muhammad Zeeshan Ali and Khurram Daud had been chosen to start training in China. The statement did not give a date of departure. AFP

Cyberattack shuts down internet fan fiction library

One of the world's most popular fan fiction libraries has been offline for over a week after a cyberattack, denying millions of fans access to their favourite stories. Archive of Our Own, known as AO3, has displayed a maintenance message since Oct 29. Launched in 2008, the platform has over 11 million registered users and nearly 18 million works. Operator Organization for Transformative Works said it did not believe its user database, containing usernames, email IDs and passwords, was stolen, but could not rule this out. It hopes to restore AO3 in a month. AFP

OpenAI raises $11bn at $1.25tn valuation

OpenAI has closed on new funding of $11 billion, the initial part of a round valuing the company at $1.25 trillion, a source familiar with the matter said on Friday. The sum is part of an original target of up to $30 billion, while the valuation fell from the initially sought $1.5 trillion, two investors said. SoftBank and MGX participated. BLOOMBERG

Russia pounds power facilities around Kyiv, damages bridge

Prez: Russia Fired N Korean Missiles

Kyiv: Russian forces hammered energy infrastructure around Ukraine's capital with missiles and drones overnight, straining Kyiv's power supply and heating systems as temperatures headed towards zero, officials said on Saturday. Three days before Russia and Ukraine are due to take part in US-brokered talks, explosions rocked Kyiv as Moscow unleashed waves of ballistic missiles, several of which damaged the Northern Bridge across the Dnipro River.

Strikes on energy facilities outside Kyiv — including systems sending power from two nuclear plants to the city and Ukraine's central regions — caused serious damage, the energy ministry said. "The capital is facing serious difficulties with its electricity, water, and heat supplies," President Volodymyr Zelensky said on X, adding that substations in five other regions were also hit.

He said only four of the 36 ballistic-type missiles launched by Russia had been intercepted, and that some were North Korean-made and hit an important energy facility. At least two people were killed and around a dozen others wounded across Ukraine in the overnight attacks, which also damaged homes, businesses and non-residential buildings, authorities said.

Moscow's defence ministry said it struck what it described as targets in Ukraine's military-industrial sector, as well as energy and transport infrastructure in and around Kyiv.

Ukraine also carried out drone and missile attacks on several Russian regions, causing minor damage but no casualties, Russian authorities said on Saturday. Russia has stepped up air attacks on Ukraine as its ground offensive has largely stalled, pounding energy infrastructure in Ukrainian cities. REUTERS

Reuters

People attend the funeral of police officers killed in a Russian airstrike on an underground shelter in the frontline town of Komyshuvakha, in Zaporizhzhia region, on Saturday

NZ govt holds narrow lead in poll nailbiter

New Zealand's centre-right governing coalition has a path to return to power after taking a narrow lead in a closely fought election. With 97% of the vote counted early Sunday, National Party and its allies the libertarian ACT party and the nationalist New Zealand First party have 67 seats between them, enough to govern in a 130-seat parliament. But that small majority could yet be overturned when special ballots are counted, and the opposition hasn't conceded defeat.

"It is heartening to see that on the numbers so far, National is once again the largest party in parliament, and we have a pathway to forming the next government," Prime Minister Christopher Luxon said.

One of the big stories of the night was the rise of the centrist Opportunity Party, which will enter parliament for the first time and could end up holding the balance of power once the final result is known at the end of the month. BLOOMBERG

Gunman kills 6 in Polish city Krakow

Warsaw: A gunman shot dead six people and wounded more than 10 on Saturday in the main square of the southern Polish city of Krakow, police said, before they shot and arrested him.

The injured included two police officers who were hurt in a shootout with the attacker, who police said wore "military-style" clothes. Police said they started to receive reports at around 3pm that an assailant had opened fire from a car and shot randomly at people in the square.

Unverified footage shared on social media showed people fleeing the scene as shots and police sirens rang out.

AFP

An emergency medical services helicopter in Krakow on Saturday

Other video showed people lying on blood-spattered paving stones and bystanders trying to resuscitate them. "I saw shots being fired from the driver's side window, and smoke was coming out. I ran to the police station in the main market square; when I burst inside, it was full of people hiding on the floor," a man who gave his name only as Konrad and witnessed the shooting, told news website Interia.

PM Donald Tusk said on X he was being kept informed about the incident in the historic centre of Krakow, Poland's second-largest city, which is a Unesco World Heritage Site. "The man was wearing military-style attire," a police spokesperson told reporters, adding: "During the arrest, officers used their weapons, but the man returned fire; as a result, two police officers are among the injured". REUTERS

An election of firsts: MAGA cooked in America's melting pot

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: From the first Black woman governor and the first Muslim senator to a Native American woman taking the governor's mansion and an openly gay man entering the Senate, the 2026 US midterms have produced a remarkable roll call of political trailblazers.

At first glance, Donald Trump's midterm humiliation was hardly unexpected. American presidents have a habit of getting walloped halfway through their terms. Barack Obama suffered a particularly brutal drubbing in 2010, losing 63 House seats. In comparison, Trump's Republican Party has given up only around 30 seats.

But the significance of this election goes well beyond the familiar American tradition of voters giving the president's party a midterm spanking. Look more closely, and something rather extraordinary emerges. This was an election that challenged the political, cultural and demographic assumptions of Trumpism. In a country increasingly defined by its diversity — racial, religious, ethnic and cultural — voters sent an unmistakable message about who gets to occupy the corridors of power, rejecting the MAGA movement's unsubtle effort to enforce white male primacy.

There were Black, Latino, Native American, Muslim and openly gay winners. Women broke barriers in states that had never elected a woman governor. A Muslim doctor made history in the Senate. A Native American woman moved from the lieutenant governor's mansion to the Senate. And a Black woman who once presided over Atlanta is about to preside over Georgia.

In short, America did not merely elect a new crop of politicians. It considerably expanded the guest list at a political establishment that has historically been rather selective about whom it lets in.

Here is an extensive roll call of the historic firsts from the Nov midterms, covering the Senate, House, and gubernatorial races:

SENATE: BREAKING THE ULTIMATE POLITICAL GLASS CEILING

First Muslim elected to the US Senate | Abdul El-Sayed (Michigan): The physician and former Wayne County health director defeated Republican Mike Rogers to become the first Muslim ever elected to the US Senate

First openly gay man elected | Chris Pappas (New Hampshire): The Democratic congressman becomes the first openly gay man elected to the upper chamber. He will join the Senate alongside his husband, Vann Bentley

3 Black women serving simultaneously in the Senate for the first time: Juliana Stratton's victory in Illinois means that, beginning Jan 2027, three Black women will serve together: Stratton, Angela Alsobrooks of Maryland and Lisa Blunt Rochester of Delaware

First woman elected from South Carolina | Annie Andrews: The Democratic paediatrician becomes the first woman elected to represent South Carolina in the Senate. Also the state's first Democratic woman senator

First Republican woman elected to the Senate from Louisiana | Julia Letlow: Also the first woman to hold the state's Senate seat since 2015

First Black senator from Mississippi since Reconstruction | Scott Colom

First Native American woman elected to the US Senate | Peggy Flanagan (Minnesota): A member of the White Earth Nation and Minnesota's outgoing lieutenant governor, Flanagan is the first Native American woman to serve in the Senate

First Native American woman elected governor | Deb Haaland (New Mexico): The former interior secy becomes the first Native American woman to govern a US state. She was also one of the first two Native American women elected to Congress in 2018

A collective milestone

Five Black governors serving simultaneously for the first time in American history
Keisha Lance Bottoms in the state of Georgia
Byron Donalds, Florida
David Crowley, Wisconsin
Aaron Ford, Nevada
Wes Moore, Maryland, who was already in office

Democratic women break 100 | At least 102 Democratic women won House seats, topping the party's previous record of 95 and putting a single party past 100 women in the House for the first time. Together with Republican women, the House is set to beat the 2024 record of 127 women

A record 17 women governors | Women will now lead nearly a third of the 50 states, the most ever

Governors: The biggest breakthrough of all

Several states elected someone from a demographic group that had never before occupied their highest elected office

First Black woman elected governor in US history | Keisha Lance Bottoms (Georgia): The ex-mayor of Atlanta is the first Black woman elected governor anywhere in the US, and the first Black person and first woman elected governor of Georgia

First time two of America's largest states will have Latino governors simultaneously: First Latino guvs – Gina Hinojosa of Texas and Xavier Becerra of California — will helm 2 states with huge Latino populations

First Black guv of Florida | Byron Donalds

First Black governor of Wisconsin | David Crowley

First Black governor of Nevada | Aaron Ford

First woman elected governor of Ohio | Amy Acton

First woman elected governor of Minnesota | Amy Klobuchar

First woman elected governor of Tennessee | Marsha Blackburn

WORLD DIGEST

AP

REMEMBRANCE OF THINGS PAST: A Communist Party supporter walks near the Aurora cruiser in St. Petersburg, Russia, Saturday, marking the anniversary of the Bolshevik Revolution. In Oct 1917, crew members aboard the vessel fired a blank shot from its forward gun as a signal to begin the revolution

Giant pandas make public debut at US zoo

Giant pandas Ping Ping and Fu Shuang delighted visitors to Zoo Atlanta during their public debut Friday, chewing bamboo and lounging in their new US habitat while on loan from China. A male named Ping Ping and female Fu Shuang arrived from Chengdu in Sept via a FedEx flight dubbed the "Panda Express," and are to be hosted in the southern US facility for the next 10 years.

Cornell faculty vote 'no confidence' in leadership

A governing body of Cornell University professors and instructors passed a vote of no confidence in university leadership over its handling of sexual assault, as rape allegations by a former student roil the Ivy League school. The Cornell Faculty Senate Friday approved a resolution expressing "no confidence in the ability of the central administration to effectively address the ongoing crisis of sexual assault," said a statement. About 56% of the 135-member body voted in favour.

TIMES SPORT

SUNDAY TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | NOVEMBER 8, 2026

HARDIK PANDYA SET FOR PBKS MOVE, ARSHDEEP POISED FOR MUMBAI SWITCH IN IPL TRADE DEAL

A MONTH AFTER RETIREMENT, GAEL MONFILS NAMED CAPTAIN OF FRANCE DAVIS CUP TEAM

SLIPPERY TURF, WATCH YOUR STEP!

Rahul Holds Nerve In Difficult Batting Conditions To Seal 2-0 Series Lead After Young Quicks Shine With Ball In Gripping, Rain-Hit Affair

Pix: AFP, AP

GURNOOR BRAR

KL RAHUL

IND VS NZ 2nd ODI

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It has been a while since bowlers dominated a white-ball series quite so emphatically, putting batters under pressure and dictating terms. In an era of 350-plus totals and 300-run chases, these low-scoring contests have been a refreshing reminder that tight bowling, rather than brute-force batting, can make for compelling cricket.

India's star-studded batting lineup was blown away by New Zealand's pacers before a composed KL Rahul produced a vital, unbeaten 26 off 38 balls, including two sixes and two fours, to guide the visitors to a hard-fought four-run win via the DLS method in a rain-affected second ODI in Wellington on Thursday. Rahul, aided by vice-captain Shreyas Iyer's 30 off 46 balls and veteran opener Rohit Sharma's 23 off 28, made sure India's young fast bowlers were rewarded for their excellent work. Gurnoor Brar was the standout, returning career-best figures of four for 30 in his 10 overs.

India now lead the five-match series 2-0 and will have a chance to seal it in the third ODI in Hamilton on Tuesday. Chasing 135 in 47 overs, they were in trouble at 113 for seven after 26 overs, still needing 22 with three wickets in hand, when rain returned. With the DLS par score at 109 at that point, India edged home.

Brar was India's standout performer, using his height to extract steep bounce and operating with raw pace and aggression. He removed Tom Latham (7), Glenn Phillips (0), Mitchell Santner (31) and Nathan Smith (3). The tall Punjab pacer found strong support from Auqib Nabi, who took two for 31 in seven overs, and Anshul Kamboj, who returned two for 25 in eight. The three seamers shared eight wickets as India bowled New Zealand out for 134 in 41 overs, making full use of the pace, bounce and movement on offer.

India were never going to find the chase easy on such a surface, but the task proved tougher than expected. Skipper Shubman Gill fell for a rare first-ball duck, caught at second slip by Henry Nicholls off Jacob Duffy in the second over. Duffy struck again when Virat Kohli drove uppishly to short cover, leaving India 17/2.

Rohit lived dangerously after being dropped by Nathan Smith at deep backward square leg, but briefly counterattacked with his trademark pull shots, hitting Kyle Jamieson for two sixes. Axar Patel, promoted to No. 5, struggled for timing before ramping Matthew Fisher to deep backward point for 7 off 17 balls, leaving India 47 for four in the 13th over.

Shreyas played a few attractive strokes but once again fell to the short ball, with Jamieson dismissing him for 30. At 86 for five, India were in trouble before Rahul steadied the innings. He produced some of the shots of the match, pulling Smith for a four and a six in the 16th over before dispatching Jamieson for another six in the 23rd. India lost Naman Dhir (12) and Kamboj (1) late, but Rahul's calm presence kept them ahead of the DLS mark.

Earlier, playing his third ODI, Nabi claimed his maiden international wicket when Tim Seifert was caught by Kamboj at mid-wicket for a duck. He then removed Will Young (11), who edged a fine delivery to Rahul. Kamboj had Nicholls playing on before Brar struck twice in the 20th over, dismissing Latham and Phillips with short-pitched deliveries.

Axar also impressed, taking 2/28 in nine overs, including the key wicket of Daryl Mitchell, who made a fighting 55 off 104 balls.

11 Defeats suffered by New Zealand against India in 16 matches across formats in 2026, the most by them against an opponent in a calendar year. They had lost 10 out of 12 to Australia across formats in 2005.

4-30 Gurnoor Brar has produced his first four-wicket haul in ODIs, bettering the 3/27 vs Afghanistan in Dharamshala on June 13, 2026. He won his first Player of the Match award in ODIs.

2 Brar's figures are the second best by an Indian pacer vs New Zealand in ODIs in New Zealand, behind the 4/23 by Javagal Srinath in Auckland on Dec 26, 2002.

1978 Kohli's run-aggregate at 56.51 in 38 innings against New Zealand in ODIs, a world record. He bettered Ricky Ponting's tally of 1971 (ave 45.83) in 50 innings.

—**Stats:** Rajesh Kumar

SCOREBOARD

New Zealand: W Young c Rahul b A Nabi 6, T Seifert c Kamboj b A Nabi 0, H Nicholls b Kamboj 11, D Mitchell c Kamboj b Patel 55, T Latham c N Dhir b G Brar 7, G Phillips c Kamboj b G Brar 0, M Santner c Rahul b G Brar 31, N Smith c R Sharma b G Brar 3, K Jamieson b Patel 7, B Tickner b K 2, J Duffy not out 1; **Extras: (b2, lb2, nb1, w6): 11; Total (41 overs): 134; FoW:** 0-1, 2-11, 3-23, 4-53, 5-53, 6-112, 7-119, 8-127, 9-132; **Bowling:** Arshdeep 7-1-16-0, A Nabi 7-0-31-2, A Kamboj 8-0-25-2, G Brar 10-2-30-4, A Patel 9-1-28-2

India: R Sharma c Nicholls b Jamieson 23, S Gill c Nicholls b Duffy 0, V Kohli c Young b Duffy 7, S Iyer c Latham b Jamieson 30, A Patel c Duffy b Fisher 7, KL Rahul not out 26, N Dhir c Seifert b Duffy 12, A Kamboj c Duffy b Jamieson 1, A Nabi not out 1; **Extras (lb-1, nb-1, wd-4) 6; Total : (in 26 overs) 113/7; FoW:** 1-4, 2-17, 3-39, 4-47, 5-86, 6-108 7-111; **Bowling:** K Jamieson 10-1-35-3, J Duffy 7-1-35-3, N Smith 5-1-19-0, M Fisher 4-0-23-1.

Result: India won by 4 runs (DLS method)

Player of the Match: Gurnoor Brar

Khawaja bombshell: Entire Oz team knew about 'Sandpapergate'

USMAN KHAWAJA

Sydney: Usman Khawaja claimed on Saturday that the entire Australian team knew about the 2018 'Sandpapergate' scandal in Cape Town and said they also employed the tactic during the previous Test in Port Elizabeth. Captain Steve Smith, his deputy David Warner and Cameron Bancroft were sent home in disgrace and found by a Cricket Australia investigation to be the only three players with prior knowledge of the ball-tampering plot. Smith was banned for a year and sacked as skipper, Warner was suspended for 12 months and stripped of all leadership roles while Bancroft was slapped with a nine-month ban.

Khawaja, who retired this year after playing 88 Tests, told the *Sydney Morning Herald* that "everyone knew". "It was all of us. Not the batters, not the bowlers, not the staff. All of us," he said ahead of the release of his autobiography.

Khawaja said he spoke in the dressing room after the Cape Town Test urging the team to take collective responsibility, rather than scapegoating Warner, Smith and Bancroft. "In an ideal world, I don't want to do this," Khawaja said. "I don't want to be the one who comes out and talks about the truth. The issue is that I genuinely thought after eight years the truth would have been out by now. Maybe I thought Davey (Warner) would have exposed it, or someone else would have talked about it more. I just didn't think it was going to come down to this."

Darren Lehmann, who was head coach at the time, denied there was widespread knowledge of the plot, while claiming ball-tampering was once ever-present in international cricket. REUTERS

AHEAD OF TESTS, JAISWAL HITS FORM WITH SECOND CONSECUTIVE CENTURY

IND 'A' VS NZ 'A'

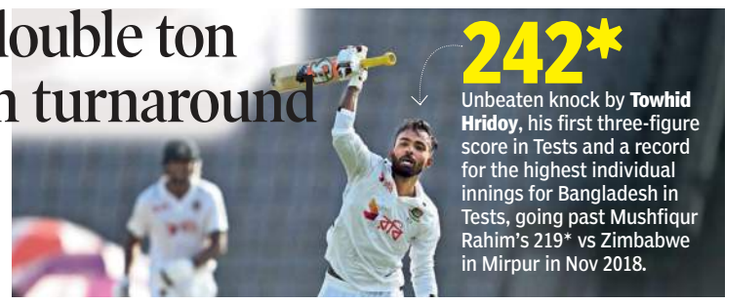
Lincoln: Yashasvi Jaiswal scored his second consecutive first-class hundred, steering India 'A' to 227/2 at stumps on Day One of the third unofficial 'Test' against New Zealand 'A' here on Saturday. Jaiswal (102 off 138), whose form became a matter of concern after the first red-ball game of the tour, now seems to have regained his sublime touch ahead of the two Test series beginning on Nov 19.

Play was called off after rain lashed the Bert Sutcliffe Oval in the 70th over of the day. The pitch had a greenish look to it but the Indian batters had a good time batting on it. Sai Sudharsan (77 batting off 205) and captain Dhruv Jurel (12 batting off 24) were in the middle when stumps were drawn.

The game has added significance with the presence of Jasprit Bumrah, Ravindra Jadeja and Prasidh Krishna, who are the playing the final India 'A' game as part of their preparation for the Test series. PTI

Brief scores: India 'A' 227/2 (Jaiswal 102, Sudharsan 77*, Ferns 1-16) vs New Zealand 'A'.

Hridoy's epic double ton fashions B'desh turnaround



242* Unbeaten knock by **Towhid Hridoy**, his first three-figure score in Tests and a record for the highest individual innings for Bangladesh in Tests, going past Mushfiqur Rahim's 219* vs Zimbabwe in Mirpur in Nov 2018.

WI VS B'DESH 2nd TEST

Sylhet: Towhid Hridoy broke the record for the highest individual Test score by a Bangladesh batter when he struck an unbeaten 242 against West Indies in Sylhet on Saturday.

Playing only his third Test, Hridoy became just the fourth Bangladesh batter to score a Test double century, reaching the milestone off 304 balls. Hridoy's sparkling knock included 22 fours and 11 sixes and carried Bangladesh into an unlikely 23-run lead on the third day of the second Test.

The 25-year-old almost single-handedly hauled Bangladesh to a total of 386 after it seemed West Indies would establish a commanding lead. "That was an outstanding, unbelievable innings," Bangladesh head coach Phil Simmons said. "Understanding the game, knowing which shots to play, when to give the last three batsmen the strike, everything he did was exceptional in this innings," he added.

West Indies had Bangladesh in deep trouble at 184-7, with opener Shadman Islam unable to bat because of an ankle injury. Hridoy led an astonishing turnaround, though, as Bangladesh passed West Indies' first-innings score of 356. "I just think he batted extremely well. I've got to give him his credit. He played a beautiful innings, he put Bangladesh in a good position," West Indies spinner Jomel Warrican said. "We were thinking about what lead we could have gotten or how big the lead could have been. But the way he batted was special."

West Indies reached seven without loss at stumps, with opener Brandon King batting on five and Joshua Da Silva unbeaten on two. Warrican was the most successful bowler for the visitors with 4-104, while Jayden Seales claimed 2-58. AFP

Brief scores: West Indies 356 and 7/0 (King 5*, Da Silva 2*) trail Bangladesh 386 (Hridoy 242*, Mushfiqur 34, Warrican 4-104, Seales 2-58) by 23 runs.

GALLERY

Gatha in pre-quarters

Indian archer Gatha Khadake entered the pre-quarterfinals of the women's recurve U-18 event with a straight-set 6-0 win over Ivory Coast's Sita Sore at the Youth Olympics in Dakar.

Raiza-Mairaj finish fourth: Raiza Dhillon and Mairaj Ahmad Khan finished fourth in the skeet final at the ISSF Shooting World Championships in Doha.

Shelton in Paris Masters final: Ben Shelton beat local favourite Luca Van Assche 5-7 6-3 6-4 and go into the Paris Masters final on Saturday.

Pranavi tied 57th: Indian golfer Pranavi Urs carded another even-par 73 to remain one-over after three rounds and lie tied 57th at the 2026 Aramco China Championship in Shenzhen. The Asian Games gold medallist has now returned cards of 73, 72 and 73.

GST & Customs prevail: GST & Customs claimed a comfortable 63-30 win over Sahakarnagar BC in the men's section of the State Association Cup championship in Bengaluru on Saturday. **Results: Men:** DK 67 (Shailen 17, Amruth 13) bt Hebbal BC 50 (Arun 14, Ashwath 14); Viveks 73 (Tyagi 26, Anshul 15) bt Orions 47 (Keerthan 17, Rakshith 11); Mandya 64 (Shashidhar 20) bt Bangalore Sporting 46 (Shubam 21); MNK Rao 75 (Shashank 16, Yash 14) bt YMMA 49 (Prabhat Tomar 17). Appaiah BC 62 (Deekshith 20) bt MCHS 48 (Rituraj 8); GST & Customs 63 (Vishnu 17, Joshua 10) bt Sahakarnagar BC 30 (Sohan 7); JSC 66 (Rohith 20) bt Beagles BC 60 (Devcharan 19, Harshan 14). **Women:** Southern Blues 81 (Nidhi 31, Vibha 14) bt Viveks 64 (Jeyashree 23, Arya 16) ; Rajmahal 60 (Aadya 22, Yashasvi 19) bt MCHS 40 (Akshaya 12) ; Young Orions 59 (Sanjana 18, Bindu 12) bt Koramangala 13 (Saloni 6) .

Shyam, Selvasamruddhi bag titles: Shyam Bindiganavile and Selvasamruddhi Selvaprabhu registered straight-game victories to clinch the U-17 boys' and girls' singles titles in the Karnataka state sub-junior championships in Mysuru on Saturday.

Results (all finals): U-17: Singles: Boys: Shyam Bindiganavile bt Gautham Nair 15-6, 15-6; **Girls:** Selvasamruddhi Selvaprabhu bt Keerthi Balaji 15-10, 16-14. **Doubles: Boys:** Mehul Arulmurugan/Satvik Prabhu bt Devansh Chowdhury/Eswar Sai Katam 15-10, 12-15, 15-11; **Girls:** Disha Ravi Bhat/Tanvi Munoth bt Avani Kulkarni/Bhoomi Kulkarni 15-10, 15-17, 15-11; **Mixed:** Eswar Sai Katam/Deborah John bt Evan Fernandes/Disha Bhat 15-13, 15-8. **U-15: Boys:** Yashvardhan SR bt Siddharth Nair 15-11, 15-8; **Girls:** Johanna Ahilan bt Hamsa Muralidhara (Mysuru) 15-3, 15-5. **Doubles: Boys:** Chetas Mundargi/Vishal Anandh bt Gautham Nair/Siddharth Nair 15-13, 19-17; **Girls:** Johanna Ahilan/Punya MN bt Manya Manjunatha/Saachi Ghargi 15-5 15-13; **Mixed:** Yashvardhan SR/Adithi Sushanth bt Mayur G/Hamsa Muralidhara (Mysuru) 15-12, 15-13.

India set for Pakistan clash

U-19 ASIA CUP

Al Amerat (Oman): India and Pakistan will renew their rivalry in a marquee Under-19 One-day Asia Cup Group A encounter on Sunday, with both sides coming into the contest on the back of convincing wins and looking to build momentum in the tournament.

India swept aside Nepal by 10 wickets on Friday, chasing down a modest target of 128 in just 19.1 overs. Pakistan, meanwhile, made light work of hosts UAE, registering a nine-wicket win after overhauling a target of 225 in 37.3 overs. As this is the penultimate round-robin league fixture for both sides, the stakes are high, with the result set to have a direct bearing on the Group A standings.

A victory will not only put the winning team in a strong position to finish as group toppers but also guarantee a place in the top two and a berth in the semifinals. With one league game still to follow, both sides will be keen to secure qualification while keeping the prospect of finishing at the top of the group alive. PTI

Sumariwalla & Ashwini among 13 to pull out

Saina Nehwal Emerges As Potential Usha Challenger

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IOA SOM RACE

New Delhi: The Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) electoral battle has taken an intriguing turn with Olympic medallist Saina Nehwal's name gaining traction as a potential challenger to incumbent president PT Usha, following a dramatic round of withdrawals from the Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) elections scheduled for Monday.

As many as 13 of the 23 validly nominated candidates withdrew within 48 hours of filing their nominations, leaving 10 in the fray. The withdrawals included eight men and five women, fuelling speculation of intense back-channel negotiations, lobbying and political interference. Sources alleged that several candidates were persuaded to step aside.

The biggest development was the withdrawal of former Athletics Federation of India (AFI) chief and World Athletics vice-president Adille Sumariwalla, averting a potential face-off with Usha. Sumariwalla, who was forced to sit out of the 2022 IOA elections, had entered the race this time through the SOM route.

The women's contest, however, has made the leadership equation more interesting. Six candidates — Usha, Nehwal, Dola Banerjee, Anju Bobby George, Rani Rampal and Anitha Paul Durai — will contest for four SOM positions. Nehwal, a former world No. 1 and 2012 London Olympics bronze medallist, is understood to have found backing in influential circles.

Her political association with BJP, which she joined in 2020, could work in her favour, sources said. Her recent nomination, alongside Rahul Dravid, to the proposed governing board for 2030 CWG in Ahmedabad has added to speculation. Among men, Gagan Narang, Vijender Singh, Yogeshwar Dutt and Kamlesh Mehta have been elected unopposed. Apart from Sumariwalla, those who withdrew included Sharath Kamal, Mansher Singh, Ronjan Sodhi, Surinder Singh Shokar, Moraad Ali Khan, Sathish Kumar Sivalingam and B Sai Praneeth.

The five women to pull out were Ashwini Nachappa, Chekrovolu Swuro, Neelam Setti Laxmi, Ragina Kiro and Trupti Murgunde.

Tanvi's silver lining after setbacks

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Bengaluru: Shuttler Tanvi Patri's rise has not been without setbacks. A hamstring injury last year and a disc bulge in early 2026 forced the 15-year-old to miss several tournaments. However, she bounced back with a silver medal at the Youth Olympic Games (YOG) in Dakar, Senegal, giving her confidence as she prepares for the next phase of her career.

Tanvi, who trains at the Centre of Badminton Excellence (CBE) in Bengaluru, lost a hard-fought final to reigning world junior champion Zhang Yi Xin. "I am not that happy (having missed out on gold), but it still feels good to return home with a silver medal. It is one of my biggest achievements. My confidence has also gone up after this tournament," she said. "I had just one or two days of good practice before leaving for Dakar."

QUOTE UNQUOTE

Vimal Kumar, director of CBE, described the silver as just the beginning for the talented Odisha shuttler, who landed at Kempegowda International Airport Saturday afternoon. He cautioned against drawing comparisons with India's leading shuttlers.

THINKING AHEAD: Tanvi Patri

"She has good potential, but I don't like to compare her with (PV) Sindhu, Saina (Nehwal) and others. As coaches, we know she has talent, but we cannot just say she will be the next Sindhu or Saina," he said.

Tanvi already has an impressive list of titles to her credit. She won the Asian U-15 crown in 2024 and the Asian U-17 title in 2026, besides claiming women's singles titles at the Pontianak International Challenge in Indonesia in August, among other achievements.

The focus now is on preparing her for higher-level tournaments while managing her workload. "We want her to play in higher tournaments. She's already doing that. In addition, she may also limit herself to a certain number of tournaments in a year," Vimal said. CBE coaches will also work on an appropriate strengthening programme for her.

The coming year will bring another challenge, with the Badminton World Federation (BWF) introducing the 3x15 scoring system. "I will have to play faster because the game will end early. You cannot make mistakes. It will be quite a challenge," said Tanvi, who is more comfortable with the 21-point format. CBE coach Sagar Chopda said the academy had already begun preparing its players for the change. "We have made a few changes in our training patterns, too," he added.

Sashang stars for Sapphire

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Sangeeta Sashang's all-round performance was the highlight of Sapphire Cricket Club's four-wicket win over Jawahar Sports Club (1) in the KSCA U-14 inter-club cricket tournament here recently. Jawahar were bowled out for 257 in 49.3 overs, with Atharva Sharma picking up 4 for 34 and Sashang returning two wickets. In reply, Sapphire rode on Sashang's 122-ball 124 to complete the chase in 46.3 overs.

Brief scores: Jawahar SC (1): 257 in 49.3 overs (Likith CK 30, Sadvin Chandra VS 34, Chirag Shadakshari 73; Sangeeta Sashang 2-34, Atharv Sharma 4-34) **lost to Sapphire CC: 261/6 in 46.3 overs** (Gukul Rao 33, Sangeeta 124 n.o (122b; 12x4; 2x6), Ankit Sirvi 35; Hruday RB 2-37, Mohammed Ihaan 2-39). **Johnson CC: 165 in 39.4 overs** (Ciranth Krishna 45; Samarth Manjappa 4-22, Farhan Shaikh 3-53) **bt Sir Syed Cricketers: 129 all out in 32.4 overs** (Harshan Gowda 3-24; Aarush Kamboj 2-24, Hrishikesh Kulkarni 2-32, Ciranth 2-22). **Young Cricketers (1): 52 in 37 overs** (Md Ashish 3-13, Taksheel Devadiga 5-9) **lost to Vultures: 57 for no loss in 6 overs** (Vismith KS 33 n.o.). **The Bangalore Cricketers: 132 in 47.1 overs** (Ishaanth Y 41; Laksh Kaul 2-22, Bhavish Sagar 4-17, Chiranth S 2-20) **lost to Bangalore Star CA:** 133/2 in 27.2 overs (Agastya Singh 45, Yashas Gowda 50 n.o.). **Vijaya: 131 in 50 overs** (Krishna Rajput 31, Pratik P Jadhav 2-37, Jaipreeth 2-17, Samvrith Kulkarni 3-14) **lost to RVCE Gymkhana: 132/8 in 46.2 overs** (Shaan M Begur 3-31, Gagan R Metre 2-24). **Bangalore Occasionals: 182/9 in 35 overs** (Lishanth PR 63; Samrudh R 4-22) **bt Cavaliers CC: 54 in 25.3 overs** (Maaksharth Nagpal 2-7, Shreyansh Gupta 3-12, Jishnu S 2-25). (Rain delay, match reduced to 35 overs per side). **Swastic Union CC (1): 337/8 in 50 overs** (Ayush 150 (147b; 15x4), Vivaan Bhusad 57, Shreyas CM 40; Kendrith MS 2-50) **bt YMCA CC (3): 174/5 in 50 overs** (Vihaan Raghavan 55, Sangamesh Hariwal 33). **Jayanagar United: 120/7 in 26 overs** (Devish S 38; Viren Rajesh 2-17, Ayaan Patel 2-22) **lost to Cambridge CC: 122/5 in 23.2 overs** (Abhinav Bavanasi 32, Vedish Reddy 2-17). **Neptune: 109 in 39 overs** (M Danish Ahmad 3-21, Kanala Sathwik 2-16, Sujan P 2-18) **lost to Freelancers: 112/5 in 31 overs** (Sahil Sahani 40; Vardaan Bajaj 3-15, Shaurya Singh 2-19). **Minerva: 147 in 44.1 overs** (Mannemala Yashwin 39; Mokshith Chalicheemala 2-36, Pushkal Menda 2-19, Nihal Gowda 2-16) **lost to Hammonds: 148/3 in 33.2 overs** (Arnav Reddy 34 n.o., MS Akilesh 44, Harikrishna 34).

Tjen to take on Linette in final

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Chennai: As the sound of firecrackers bursting outside the stadium on the eve of Diwali reverberated across the SDAT tennis arena, defending champion **Janice Tjen** went about her business with a composed display to make the WTA 250 Chennai Open final.

The top seed Indonesian overcame American Robin Montgomery 6-4, 6-3 to move a step closer to retaining her title. She will take on third seed Magda Linette, who got the better of seventh seed Anastasia Zakharova 2-6, 6-2, 6-3 in the other semifinal.

CHENNAI OPEN

While Tjen's backhand slice has been her weapon, she brought her forehand into play effectively, using acute angles to break Montgomery's serve before saving two break points to surge to a 4-1 lead.

LR Shankar

Tjen's service has been lethal, and she used it effectively when in danger. Serving for the set, she saved a break-point with a wide ace. However, Montgomery fought back to break Tjen's serve and consolidated the break by holding her own. Although it looked like Montgomery was beginning to rediscover her rhythm, she also committed costly errors, which allowed Tjen to take the set. The top seed had to work harder for her points in the second set. Montgomery had opportunities to break Tjen's serve but failed to capitalise.

Serving for the match at 5-3, Tjen unleashed a running forehand winner, a shot that brought out an unusually emotional reaction from the Indonesian. She then struck another winner to seal her place in the final.

RUTUJA-VAISHNAVI PAIR IN TITLE-CLASH

Rutuja Bhosale and Vaishnavi Adkar registered an upset win against the second-seeded pairing of Alana Smith and Weronika Falkowska 6-2, 2-6, 10-8 and entered the women's doubles final. The Indian duo thus became the first all-Indian pairing to reach doubles final in a Tour-level event.

Abhinav, Himanshi emerge triumphant

Bengaluru: Abhinav Murthy and Himanshi Chowdhary were crowned the men's and women's singles champions in the State ranking table tennis tournament here on Saturday.

Abhinav took a 3-1 lead before prevailing 12-10, 7-11, 11-8, 12-10, 5-11, 11-8 against Aakash KJ in the final. In the women's title clash, Himanshi showed great determination against Deshna Vanshika. After winning the first game, she lost the next three to trail 1-3. But she soon found her range to script a 11-8, 6-11, 5-11, 8-11, 11-7, 11-8, 13-11 win.

TABLE TENNIS

Results: Singles: Men: Final: Abhinav Murthy bt Aakash KJ 12-10, 7-11, 11-8, 12-10, 5-11, 11-8. **Semis:** Aakash bt Yeshwanth P 11-7, 11-13, 2-11, 9-11, 11-7, 11-4, 11-8; Abhinav bt Shubham Trivedi 11-7, 12-10, 11-4, 7-11, 11-9. **Women: Final:** Himanshi Chowdhary bt Deshna Vanshika 11-8, 6-11, 5-11, 8-11, 11-7, 11-8, 13-11; **Semis:** Himanshi bt Kushi V 11-4, 12-10, 11-4, 13-11; Deshna bt Trupti Purohit 12-10, 11-7, 13-15, 11-8, 11-9. TNN

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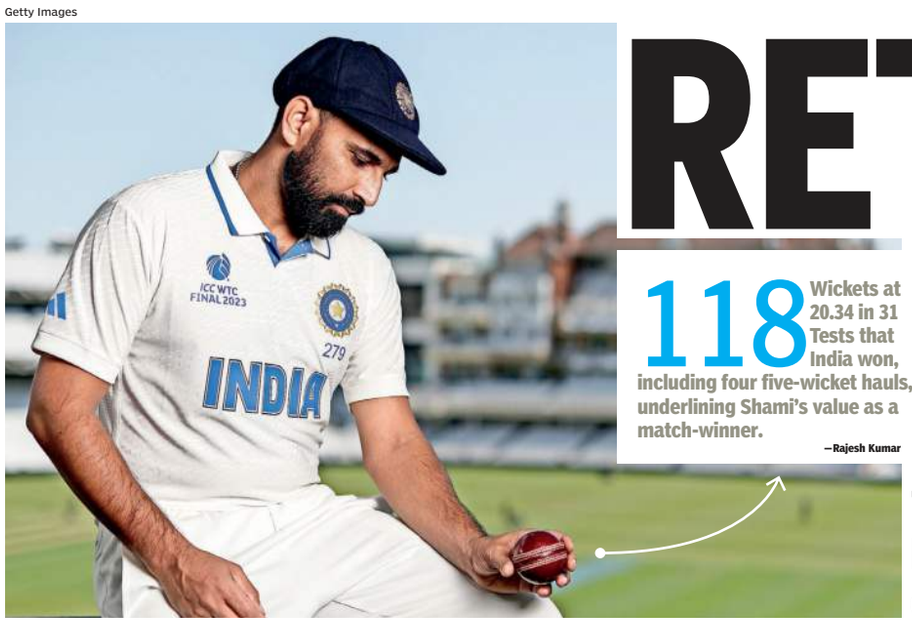

RETIRED, HURT

118 Wickets at 20.34 in 31 Tests that India won, including four five-wicket hauls, underlining Shami's value as a match-winner.

—Rajesh Kumar

Those who worked closely with Mohammed Shami reflect on a career that ended too quietly

Nitin.Naik@timesofindia.com

As tributes poured in from former players, fans and the BCCI after Mohammed Shami announced his retirement from Test cricket on Friday, they all pointed to the same truth: India had bid farewell to one of its finest pacers. Over 13 years and 64 Tests, he had helped transform India's pace-bowling identity. Amid the praise, though, lingered uncomfortable questions: Was he valued enough in the final phase of his career?

Like several senior Indian cricketers before him, Shami's Test journey ended not on a cricket field but through a social media post. There was no farewell Test among passionate fans in a full stadium. For a bowler who had such a massive impact on India's fortunes, the ending felt understated and incomplete. Former India coach Ravi Shastri voiced that sentiment forcefully. "Without him, the fast-bowling unit would not have functioned," Shastri said on *Sony Sports Network* during the second ODI in Wellington on Saturday.

The former coach was convinced Shami still had plenty left to offer. "I definitely thought he had another 30-40 wickets left in him. He should have played in the last 12 months and should have played Tests here."

Former India bowling coach Paras Mhambrey shared a similar view. "Personally, I would have loved to see him represent India again, in Test cricket and in other formats as well," Mhambrey told TOI. "He's played Ranji Trophy and Duleep Trophy, done well and, honestly, he's a joy to watch. He makes everything look so easy." Mhambrey stopped short of questioning the decision-makers, though, acknowledging that outsiders were unaware of the conversations that may have taken place between Shami, the selectors and the team management.

Shastri's strongest criticism, however, was reserved for the repeated doubts over Shami's fitness despite his performances for Bengal in domestic cricket. "He was bowling 15 to 20 overs daily. What else do you want a player to do to prove his fitness?" Shastri asked. Shami's final Test came in the World Test Championship final against Australia at The Oval in June 2023. For a bowler who continued to play domestic cricket thereafter, it felt like a forced full stop.

Ask Mhambrey what made Shami special and the answer arrives quickly. "Very few bowlers in world cricket had that kind of upright seam presentation. As a batter, you never knew whether the ball would come in or go away. " That seam position became Shami's trademark. Few bowlers of his generation attacked the stumps as relentlessly. Of his 229 Test wickets, 101 were either bowled or lbw.

Mhambrey believes another underrated aspect of Shami's success was his simplicity. "He wasn't data-driven. He kept things very simple. He knew what he wanted and how he wanted to prepare." The numbers underline just how valuable he was. On spin-friendly home surfaces, Shami remained a match-winner. He claimed 76 wickets in India at an extraordinary average of 22, and India did not lose any of the 21 home Tests in which he featured.

Why was he so lethal in India? "He surprised people with his pace," Mhambrey reasons. "He was much quicker than batters felt. He had great rhythm. That's why you saw so many bowled and lbw dismissals."

For Shami, bowling was never a chore. It was romance. During the Covid lockdown, he returned to his farmhouse in Amroha, built clay practice tracks and spent hours bowling and running to stay sharp. That old-school philosophy, Mhambrey believes, defined an entire generation of Indian fast bowlers. "Shami, Bumrah, Ishant, Umesh, Bhuvneshwar, they bowled a lot. Skill came first. Fitness supplemented that skill. If you want control, you need to bowl."

Perhaps that is why Shami earned the label "Second-Innings Shami", a bowler whose threat often intensified as matches wore on. Which makes it all the more ironic that he was never afforded a second innings in his own Test career.

"I did fall, I did get hurt, I did get injured. But I stood up again for this badge," he said in his retirement video. Shami deserved one final opportunity to walk away on his own terms, but he probably retired hurt.

BEST OF SHAMI

MOHAMMED SHAMI'S rare blend of pace, seam movement and relentless accuracy made him a match-winner. Diptayan Hazra revisits five of his finest Test spells.

5-47 vs West Indies, Kolkata, 2013
Shami announced himself in style on Test debut. On a sluggish Eden surface, the he generated sharp movement with the old ball and attacked the stumps, finishing with 5-47 in the second innings and match figures of 9-118. Six of his wickets were bowled and one lbw, offering an early glimpse of his trademark dismissal patterns.

6-56 vs Australia, Perth, 2018 On one of the fastest pitches in world cricket, Shami produced the best figures of his Test career. With Australia looking to set up the match in the second innings, he struck at regular intervals, using pace and seam movement to claim 6-56. It's the only six-wicket haul by an Indian bowler in a Test at Perth.

5-28 vs South Africa, Wanderers, 2018
Defending 241 on a lively Wanderers surface, India seemed to be losing when South Africa raced to 124-1. Enter Shami. The pacer ripped through the middle and lower order with a devastating spell of 5-28 to turn the match.

5-44 vs South Africa, Pretoria, 2021
Shami spearheaded India's attack in the opening Test, claiming 5-44 as South Africa were bowled out for 197. His effort helped India secure a crucial first-innings lead of 130, setting the platform for a landmark victory. He claimed three more in the second innings.

5-35 vs South Africa, Vizag, 2019
Proof that Shami could be just as lethal on Indian pitches. After going wicketless in the first innings, he roared back with a superb 5-35 in the second, removing key batters including skipper Faf du Plessis and Temba Bavuma.

How the Kolkata maidans shaped UP-born Shami

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Kolkata: Growing up in a small village in Uttar Pradesh's Amroha district, where life revolved around sugarcane fields and mustard farms, Mohammed Shami's rise to international cricket seemed improbable. Yet the son of a farmer defied the odds to become one of India's greatest fast bowlers.

Fast bowling ran in the family. Shami's elder brother Haseeb was known locally for his pace before injuries curtailed his career. Determined to give his son a chance, father Tousif Ahmed sent Shami to train under coach Badruddin Siddique in Moradabad, 22 km from their village of Sahaspur Alinagar.

The road was far from smooth. Shami failed to make Uttar Pradesh age-group teams for three successive years before an unexpected opportunity changed everything. A Kolkata club approached Siddique looking for a fast bowler and the coach immediately recommended his most promising pupil. Within days, a 16-year-old Shami boarded the Punjab Mail to Kolkata.

Playing for Dalhousie Athletic Club in the Maidan circuit for Rs 500 a match, Shami soon caught the eye of Town Club official Debabrata Das, who signed him for Rs 70,000 a season and accommodated him at his home.

Unlike many modern cricketers, Shami had little interest in gyms or weight training. He preferred running and long bowling spells. His fondness for biryani became legendary in Kolkata's club circuit, with officials jokingly motivating him with promises of a plate after a match-winning spell.

Breaking into Bengal's senior side remained difficult until then chief selector Sambaran Banerjee spotted him in a local match against Eastern Railway.

"I watched him from beside the sightscreen. He took four wickets bowling with the wind. I asked the captain to bring him on against the wind and he took two more. I knew immediately this boy could spearhead India's attack one day," Banerjee recalled.

What impressed him most was a trait that would later become Shami's hallmark."His seam position and release point were exceptional. That very evening I pushed for his inclusion in the Bengal squad."

Shami repaid that faith by claiming three wickets on his Ranji Trophy debut against Assam at Eden Gardens in 2010. Former Bengal captain Manoj Tiwary remembers being struck by his smooth action and natural pace. "He was a lambi race ka ghoda," Tiwary said.

He also points out the influence Wasim Akram had when the Pakistan great joined Kolkata Knight Riders as bowling coach. "Shami wasn't a regular in the XI initially, but I saw how Akram worked on his game," Tiwary recalled.

Arsenal down Hull, Leeds edge Spurs

London: Arsenal banked another three points in the defence of their Premier League title as their trademark persistence once again paid off in a 1-0 home win over stubborn Hull City on Saturday. It was not fluent or convincing but **Martin Odegaard**'s poacher's goal in the 72nd-minute earned Mikel Arteta's side a sixth league win by a single-goal margin this season. Arsenal moved to 27 points from 10 games.

Tottenham Hotspur's recent revival came to a halt as they went down 1-0 at Leeds United for whom Noah Okafor struck the winner 97 seconds after coming off the bench at Elland Road.

There was controversy, though, with Leeds fortunate not to be reduced to 10 men in the first half when Jayden Bogle escaped a red card for a dangerous tackle on Mathys Tel. Fulham and Newcastle United shared the spoils in a 1-1 draw at Craven Cottage.

BAYERN, DORTMUND WIN
Bayern Munich and Borussia Dortmund remained neck and neck at the top of the German Bundesliga table after 2-1 wins over Mainz and Elversberg on Saturday. Bayern and Dortmund, who drew 2-2 in Munich last Saturday, are locked on 21 points, with the defending champions ahead on goal difference after nine rounds. **Results: EPL:** Leeds 1 (Okafor 79) bt Tottenham 0; Arsenal 1 (Odegaard 72) bt Hull 0; Fulham 1 (Muniz 83) drew with Newcastle 1 (Murphy 80). **On Friday:** Everton 3 (Barry 56, 61, Dewsbury-Hall 81) bt Coventry 1 (Gboho 52). **German league:** Borussia Dortmund 2 (Nmecha 55, 71) bt Elversberg 1 (Noel 81); RB Leipzig 5 (Banzuzi 33, Nkunku 35, Raum 45+1, Romulu 60, Baumgartner 66) bt Augsburg 2 (Kade 1, Ogundu 90+2); Mainz 1 (Tietz 90+3) lost to Bayern Munich 2 (Kimmich 14, Karl 57); Paderborn 2 (Obermair 45, Pieringer 73-pen) drew with Eintracht Frankfurt 2 (Burkardt 23, 90+3). **On Friday:** Hamburg 3 (Muheim 11, Nandja 59, Gronbaek 70) bt Borussia Moenchengladbach 1 (Hack 44). **Spanish league:** Malaga 1 (Dotor 28) lost to Racing Santander 2 (Luque 50, Zabiri 60); Espanyol 0 drew with Deportivo La Coruna 0. **On Friday:** Sevilla 0 drew with Alaves 0. AGENCIES

FOOTBALL

EB women make AWCL knockouts

The Moshal Girls made history in Indian football. Anthony Andrews' two-time IWL champions lost 0-2 to North Korean powerhouse 4.25 Sports Club in Kolkata on Saturday but the result was good enough for them to qualify for the knockout stage of Asia's premier women's club competition as one of the two best third-placed teams reports **Nilesh Bhattacharya.** EB women began their final Group B match well aware of what was required. Myanmar's Ayeyawady FC, ended their campaign with a 3-0 win over Iran's Bam Khatoon FC. TNN

Ice On Fire for Rajyotsava Cup

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Ice On Fire, trained by Pradeep Annaiah and with A Ashhad Asbar in the saddle, appeals most in the Rajyotsava Cup. The plum event over seven furlongs will be held on the opening day of the Bengaluru winter racing season on Sunday. Once You Go Black, from J McKeown's stable, to be ridden by Suraj Narredu, looks the strongest challenger. The first race starts at 1:30 pm.

1. The November Plate 1200m: Hold Your Breath 1, Anzac Parade 2.
2. The Gomos Plate 1400m: Quattro 1, Irish Coffee 2. **3. The Udupi Plate 1400m:** Glorious Strides 1, Circle Of Dreams 2.
4. The TB Hanumantharaj Memorial Trophy 1200m: Doncaster Belle 1, Solara 2.
5. The Rajyotsava Cup 1400m: Once You Go Black 1, Ice Of Fire 2.
6. The Bengaluru City Police Cup 1400m: Tyche 1, Perfect Dream 2.
7. The Malaprabha Plate 1200m: El Rey 1, Excellence 2.
8. The Jog Falls Plate 1400m: Valor Queen 1, Como 2.
Day's Best: Tyche
Jackpot: 4, 5, 6, 7 & 8
Mini Jackpot: 5, 6, 7, 8
First Treble: 3, 4 & 5
Second Treble: 6, 7 & 8.

RACE SELECTIONS

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302004

S. No : JDA/EE & TA to Dir. Engg.-I/2026-27/D- Date : 06.11.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID

NIB No. : EE & TA to Dir. Engg.-I/26/2026-27

Bids are invited from interested bidders for following works :-

S. No.	UBN No.	Cost of Work (Lacs)	Nature of Work	Last Date
1.	JDA2627WSOB00404	342.27	Road Safety Works	25.11.2026

Other particulars of the respective bid may be visited on Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in.

Executive Engineer & TA to Dir.Engg-I

Raj.Samwad/C/26/13095

Government of Karnataka
Dharwad Institute of Mental Health & Neurosciences, Belagaum Road, Dharwad-580008,
e-mail : director.dimhans@gmail.com
No. DIMHANS/AHS/M.Clin./453/2026-27 Date: 07-11-2026

MASTER OF CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGY ADMISSION NOTIFICATION 2026- 2027

Applications are invited from eligible candidates of Karnataka domicile, for 5 seats (UR-3, SC-1, Cat-IIB-1) in the prescribed format, for admission to 'Master of Clinical Psychology' course, (M.Clin.Psy.) which is RCI recognized and affiliated with Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences, Bangalore.

Commencement of online application : **08-11-2026**

Last Date for Submission of Application : **17-11-2026**

For application form, eligibility criteria, entrance exam date and other details,visit: https://dimhans.karnataka.gov.in

Sd/- Chief Administrative officer
Dharwad Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences, (DIMHANS) Dharwad

DIPR/DWD/763/KSMCA/2026-27

DELHI TRANSPORT INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.
(An Enterprise of GNCT of Delhi)

Advertisement for inviting Applications to Various Post in DTIDC Ltd. on Deputation/Contract Basis

1. DTIDC, an enterprise of Govt. of NCT of Delhi, having its office at 2nd Floor, Maharana Pratap ISBT, Kashmere Gate, Delhi, invites applications from the eligible and interested candidates for the following posts on Deputation/Contract basis (initially for one year):-
   (a) Name of Post: Assistant General Manager (Works-Civil)/ Executive Engineer (Civil) - 01 Post on Deputation/Contract.
   (b) Name of Post: Assistant General Manager (Works-Electrical)/ Executive Engineer (Electrical)- 01 Post on Deputation/ Contract.
   (C) Name of Post: Data Entry Operator (DEO)- 02 Posts on Contract.
2. The Application Form duly completed in all respects should reach the office of the Executive Director, DTIDC, 2nd Floor, Maharana Pratap ISBT, Kashmere Gate, Delhi-110006, on or before the last date, i.e. 23/11/2026. Other details shall be displayed on the DTIDC website i.e. **www.dtidc.co.in**.

Sr. Manager (Admin.)
DTIDC Ltd.

Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF YOUTH EMPOWERMENT AND SPORTS
State Youth Centre, Nrupathunga Road, Bengaluru – 560001
Tel: 080-22215601, 22211246, Fax:080-22215602

Tender No: DYES/SW/ SSC/02/2026-27 Dated: 07-11-2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION (15 days E-Procurement Portal)

The Deputy Director (Admin), Department of Youth Empowerment and Sports, State Youth Centre, Nrupathunga Road, Bengaluru - 560001, KARNATAKA INDIA invites Tender for Operation and Maintenance of Sport Science Centre with all necessary human resources at Mysore in Karnataka.

Operation and Maintenance of Sport Science Center at Mysore with all Necessary Human resource. EMD Amount: Rs 1,00,000/-

a) Last Date and Time for Submission of Tender Documents through e-Procurement Portal: **Date: 23-11-2026, time 11.30 am.**
b) Opening of Pre-Qualification Offers: **Date: 24-11-2026, time 12.00 noon**.
c) Opening of Commercial Offers: Will be intimated

The Tender shall be submitted through e-Procurement Portal (**https://KPPP.karnataka.gov.in**). Bidders need to register in the e-Procurement Portal to submit their bids online. The tender document can be viewed free of cost from the e-Procurement Portal. Each bid shall be separate.

Additional information may be obtained during office hours at the above mentioned Address.

The following are the authorities for the purpose of this tender:

Sd/- Deputy Director(Welfare)
Youth Empowerment and sports.

DIPR/CP/3604/Zen/2026-27

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
(PUBLIC WORKS, DEPT.)

No. PWD/BGM/TND/TA/AE/2026-27/5371 Date: 07.11.2026

-: {TENDER NOTIFICATION (KPP PORTAL) :-

The Executive Engineer, PWD Belagavi Division Belagavi invites item ratetenders from the eligible contractors registered in KPP Portal in Public Works Department under KW-1,2,3 & 4 Standard tender documents for a work under 5054 KRDCL, 2059 Department Buildings, 5054 MDR Improvements, 5054 SH Improvements,3054 SH Maintenance, 3054 MDR Maintenance, 2059 Vidhanasoudha, Vikasasodha, Vivi Gopura, Suvarnasoudha Belagavi Bulding Maintenance, 4059 CMIDP-SCP and TSP, 4059 Department Buildings Total 30 number of works with minimum and maximum tender amounts of Rs. 6.36 Lakhs and Rs. 678.31 Lakhs respectively and minimum and maximum EMD amount of Rs. 8,000/- and Rs. 9,17,500/-, Part-1: Tender receipt Date is on 16-11-2026 up to 4.30 PM , Technical Bid Opening Date is on 17-11-2026 after 4.45 PM Part-2: Tender receipt Date is on 20-11-2026 up to 4.30 PM and Technical Bid Opening Date is on 21-11-2026 after 4.45PM, Part-3: Tender receipt Date is on 30-11-2026 up to 4.30 PM and Technical Bid Opening Date is on 01-12-2026 after 4.45PM, Part-4: Tender receipt Date is on 14-12-2026 up to 4.30 PM and Financial Bid Opening Date is on 16-12-2026 after 11.00AM, For more information contact the office of the undersigned and www.Kppp.karnataka.gov.in after 07-11-2026. (Note:1) If no bids received, 3 days One Time auto extension activated.

Sd/-Executive Engineer,
Public Works Department. Belagavi Dn. Belagavi.

DIPR/BGM/RO-NO-1074/KSMCA/2026-27

Bangalore University
Office of the Registrar, Jnanabharathi, Bengaluru -560 056

No.Aca-III:A1:Affiliation:Notfn:2027-28 Date :06.11.2026

ADVERTISEMENT

Bangalore University invites applications for various types of affiliation as prescribed in Sections 59 and 62 of the KSU Act, 2000, from the affiliated Colleges/Managements situated in the Bangalore University jurisdiction as specified in the Karnataka State Universities (Amendment) Act, 2015 i.e., Karnataka Legislative Assembly constituencies of Vijayanagara, Padmanabhanagar, Bommanahalli, Anekal, Bangalore South, Yeshwanthapura, Rajarajeshwarinagar, Dasarahalli, Mahalaxmi Layout, Govindarajnagar of Bangalore District, Nelamangala of Bengaluru Rural District, Magadi, Ramanagara, Kanakapura and Channapatna of Bangalore South District for the academic year 2027-28 vide notification No.Aca-III:A1:Affiliation: Notfn:2027-28, dated: 06.11.2026. The notification is available in the University Website www.bangalore university. karnataka.gov.in.

Colleges/managements are informed to submit the application through online affiliation of the State Government Website https://uucms.karnataka.gov.in

Last date for submission of filled-in application of Rs.2200/- is 25.11.2026 without fine & 30.11.2026 with a fine of Rs.2,000/-

Additional information, if any may be obtained from the Academic Section -III, Bangalore University, Jnanabharathi, Bengaluru-560 056 (Contact No: 8618709950)

sd/-
REGISTRAR

DIPR/CP/3623/Zen/2026-27

Karnataka Road Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Karnataka Enterprise)
No.8, "Samparka Soudha", Dr. Rajkumar Road, Rajajinagar 1st Block, Bengaluru-560 010. Telephone : 080-22024000
e-mail : mdkrdcl@gmail.com Website: http://www.krdcl.in

No: KRDCL/IFB/Company Secretary/2026-27/2143 Date: 06-11-2026

Notification for the Service of Company Secretary

Karnataka Road Development Corporation Ltd is a Govt. of Karnataka Undertaking, here by issues this notification **for the Service of Company Secretary,** on contract basis, in accordance with the provisions of the Company Act-2013 and with the approval of the Competent Authority. The Company is looking for high profile, dynamic, result oriented and innovative candidate for the post of Company Secretary. The details are as follows:

Post	**Company Secretary (on Contract basis)**
No. of Post	One
Duration of Service	Three Years.
Place of Work	Head Office, Bengaluru
Maximum Age	60 Years
Qualification	Degree with ACS Certificate, Membership of Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI), preferably Law Graduate.
Language	Writing & Reading in Kannada & English is Mandatory.
Experience	Minimum 3 to 5 Years in the relevant field and preferablly work with Govt. Departments/ Board/Corporation/PSU's
Consolidate Monthly Pay	Rs.1,25,000/-
Last date for submission of application with details	Submit the application along with experience details, Qualifications, Certificates, ID & Address Proof & ICSI Membership Certificate copies **on or before 18-11-2026,** during office hours by physical or mail.
Postal Adderss & Contact No.	Managing Director, No.08, "Samparka Soudha", 3rd Floor, Dr.Rajkumar Road, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560 010 080-22024000.
e-mail	mdkrdcl@gmail.com

Sd/- Managing Director
KRDCL, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/YC/3609/2026-27

KARNATAKA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD
#49, "Parisara Bhavan", 1st to 5th Floor, Church Street, Bengaluru-560001, Karnataka,
Phone: 25581383, 25589112, 25586520, Fax: 080-25586321
E-mail: ho@kspcb.gov.in, Website: https://kspcb.karnataka.gov.

NO. PCB/71/SEO/MINES/EPH/2026-27/3584 DATE: 06.11.2026

ENVIRONMENTAL PUBLIC HEARING NOTIFICATION

Smt. B. L. Rani Samyuktha has proposed to undertake **"Doddabyladakere Iron Ore Mine"** with expansion in production of Iron Ore from 0.161 Million TPA to 0.495 Million TPA, Overburden (Waste) of 0.218 MTPA (Total Excavation: 0.713 MTPA) along with Screening, Crushing, installation of 0.495 MTPA capacity of Iron Ore Beneficiation Plant and Utilization of 99,000 TPA of tailings in an existing Mine Lease Area of 60.92 Hectares at **Sy. No. 59 (Part), Doddabyladakere Village, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District.** This project proposal falls under Category 'A', Schedule 1(a) – 'Mining of Minerals' and 2(b) – Mineral Beneficiation' as per the Environmental Impact Assessment Notification, 2006 and its amendments".

As per the Environmental Impact Assessment Notification dated:14.09.2006 and its Amendment dated:01.12.2009, the project proponent has to obtain prior Environmental Clearance from the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India and is required to go through the process of Environmental Public Hearing. As per the Terms of Reference letter vide F. No. J-11015/276/2006-IA-II(M) dated: 29.09.2026 issued by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India and request letter of the project proponent dated:01.10.2026 and the Environmental Officer, Regional Office, Chitradurga letter dated:19.10.2026 intimating the date, the Environmental Public Hearing is being conducted by the KSPCB.

The details of the project are as follows:

1. Name & Address of the Project Proponent : Smt. B. L. Rani Samyuktha No. 52, 2nd Cross, Huda Office Lane, College Road, Shantinagara, Hosapete, Vijayanagara – 583 201

2. Location of the proposed Project : Sy. No. 59 (Part), Doddabyladakere Village, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District

3. Details of proposed Project : Proposed to undertake "Doddabyladakere Iron Ore Mine" with expansion in production capacity of Iron Ore from 0.161 Million TPA to 0.495 Million TPA, Overburden (Waste) of 0.218 MTPA (Total Excavation: 0.713 MTPA) along with Screening, Crushing, installation of 0.495 MTPA capacity of Iron Ore Beneficiation Plant and Utilization of 99,000 TPA of tailings in an existing Mine Lease Area of 60.92 Hectares at Sy. No. 59 (Part), Doddabyladakere Village, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District.

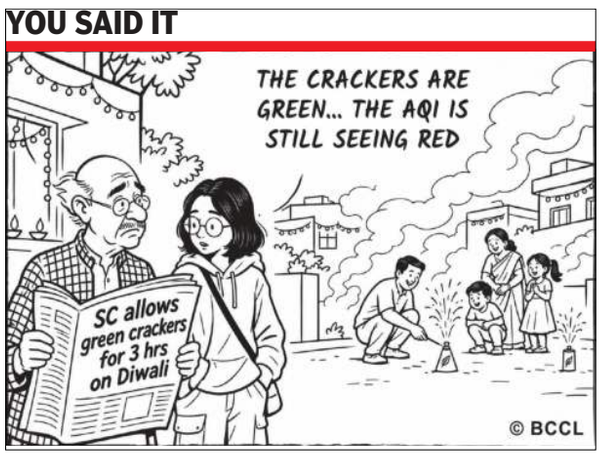
4. Date, time and venue of Environmental Public Hearing : Date : 10.12.2026 (Thursday) Time: 11:00 AM Place: Project Site, Sy. No. 59 (Part), Doddabyladakere Village, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District.

5. Places of availability of project documents as per EIA Notification, which is kept open to public are :**(a)** Office of the Deputy Commissioner, Chitradurga District, Chitradurga. **(b)** Chief Executive Officer, Zilla Panchayat, Chitradurga District, Chitradurga. **(c)** District Industries Centre, Chitradurga District, Chitradurga. **(d)** Tahasildar Office, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District. **(e)** Department of Mines & Geology, Chitradurga **(f)** Taluk, Panchayat Office, Hosadurga, Chitradurga District. **(g)** Gram Panchayat Office, Chikkabyaladakere, Hosadurga Taluk, Chitradurga District. **(h)** Office of the Zonal Office, Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Davanagere. **(I)** Office of the Regional Office, Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Chitradurga. **(j)** Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change, South Zone Office, E-3/240, Kendriya Sadan, 4th Floor, E & F Wing, 17th Main Road, 2nd Block, Koramangala, Bengaluru – 560 034 **(k)**HELP DESK, Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Ground Floor, No. 49, Parisara Bhavana, Church Street, Bengaluru – 560 001

Note: Suggestions, views, comments and objections of interested bonafide residents, environmental groups and others located at project site and likely to be affected by the proposed project are invited within 30 days from the date of publication of this Notification to make oral/written/E-Mail suggestions to the Karnataka State Pollution Control Board/Chairman, Environmental Public Hearing Committee **(Deputy Commissioner, Chitradurga District, Chitradurga)**. Interested public can participate in the Public Hearing at the above place. **For details please visit our Website: https://kspcb.karnataka.gov.in/.**

Sd/-
Member Secretary

YOU SAID IT

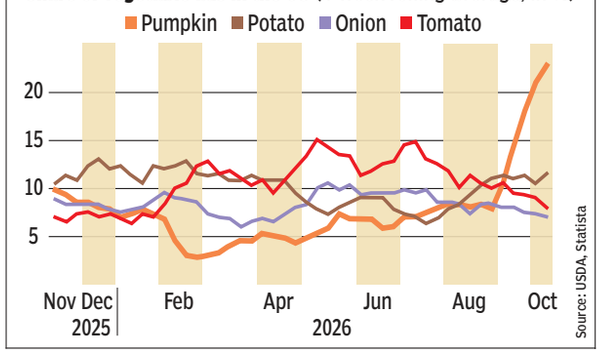


STATISTICS A slice of life in numbers

Halloween brings a pumpkin-sized ad rush in US

Advertising for pumpkin and squash surged around Halloween (Oct 31), together accounting for more than a fifth of vegetable ads tracked by the US dept od agriculture in mid-Oct 2026. Potatoes, onions and tomatoes remain amongst the other most advertised veggies yr-round

Share of vegetable ads in the US (4-week rolling average, in %)



'Little regard for people's rights': HC slams UP cops

Rajesh Kumar Pandey | TNN

Prayagraj: Allahabad HC has rebuked UP police for showing little regard for citizens' fundamental rights and civil liberties, calling the situation in the state "shameful", and ordered the immediate release of a Bijnor resident detained illegally. The court flagged a recurring pattern of missing CCTV footage in police stations, warning that claims of camera malfunction could be treated as evidence of deliberate concealment.

A bench of Justice Atul Sreedharan and Justice Achal Sachdev allowed in a Nov 3 order a habeas corpus petition filed on behalf of Aausad Ahmad and directed his release if he was not wanted in any other case. It also ordered the state to pay him Rs 20,000 in costs within seven days.

Ahmad's daughter alleged that police and special operations group personnel in plain clothes forcibly took him away outside Nangal police station in Bijnor on Sept 5, 2026, but his formal arrest was recorded only on Sept 7. Both had gone to the police station after being summoned in connection with a case accusing Ahmad of honey-trapping. According to the petition, they reached the station around 2.30pm on Sept 5 and contacted the SHO while sitting in their vehicle. A car then arrived near the station gate, and four men allegedly surrounded their vehicle and forcibly took Ahmad away.

> The situation that exists in the state of UP relating to civil liberty is shameful... **infringement of these rights seems to have become a matter of routine for UP Police** —Allahabad HC

To verify the allegation, HC had sought CCTV recordings from the police station covering 1pm on Sept 5 to 10am on Sept 7. The state told the court that the footage was unavailable because a thunderstorm had caused rainwater to seep through a cable into the CCTV system, leading to its malfunction. It relied on a general diary entry dated Sept 5.

Rejecting the explanation, the bench said that in case after case, police cited similar reasons for the non-availability of CCTV footage.

The bench also censured Nangal SHO Anoo Kumari, holding that she had deliberately failed to provide CCTV footage relevant to the case. It directed that its displeasure be recorded in her service records and asked the state to consider whether she should continue in her present posting.

TN native convicted in 2018 rape of UK tourist in Goa

Colva: A sessions court has convicted a Chennai native of raping and robbing a 48-year-old British tourist at Palolem in Dec 2018, nearly seven years after the assault, while acquitting him of destroying evidence. The court will hear Ramchandran Chendayellappa on the quantum of sentence before pronouncing punishment.

Principal district and sessions judge Sharmila Patil convicted him under sections 376, 392 and 394. She acquitted him under section 201, which deals with causing the disappearance of evidence of an offence or giving false information to screen an offender. TNN

Lawrence gang member wanted in extortion cases detained in US

Dishank.Purohit
@timesofindia.com

Jaipur: A key member of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang – the subject of a nearly two-year international manhunt who faces charges of supplying weapons and coordinating extortion and shooting attacks in India from abroad – has been detained by US immigration enforcement authorities in California, Rajasthan police said Saturday.

Anti-Gangster Task Force (AGTF) ADG Dinesh MN said Rajasthan police are coordinating with central agencies to have 40-year-old Harichand Jat, alias Harry Boxer, brought back to India.

He is wanted in 22 criminal cases registered against him across Rajasthan on charges that include attempted murder, extortion, illegal arms possession and organised crime. He is also named in multiple criminal cases in Haryana and Mumbai.

Boxer fled India in April 2023. As per AGTF, he continued to coordinate criminal activities for the Lawrence gang and the Rohit Godara syndicate while overseas, arranging weapons supplies and masterminding extortion threats.

Diljit can't uncork 'Patiala Peg' at Indore show, govt bars 4 songs

Karishma.Kotwal
@timesofindia.com

Indore: Four songs by singer **Diljit Dosanjh** have been flagged for a Nov 15 concert in Indore, with the District Child Protection Officer (CPO) issuing orders to ensure they are not performed, not even with modified lyrics.

CPO Rajnish Sinha cited a July 2019 Punjab and Haryana HC order which called for preventing songs glorifying liquor, drugs and violence from being played at live shows. In a letter dated Nov 6, Sinha asked the management of C-21 Mall, the concert's venue, not to allow Dosanjh to sing 'Patiala Peg', '5 Taara Theeke', 'Jeb Vicho Feem Labhi aa' and 'Jatt Uthe Fire Karda Jithe Pabandi Hathiyara Di'.

"The directions follow a complaint by Chandigarh-based professor Panditrao Dharenavar," said Sinha.

Vantara steps in to save Keralam's jumbo calf Maya battling fractures in both front legs

Times News Network

Maya, an elephant calf found alone as a newborn on a riverbank 18 months ago, was airlifted from Keralam to Vantara's hospital in Jamnagar on Nov 5, after fractures in both front legs left her unable to stand.

Acting on an initiative by RIL executive director and Vantara founder Anant Ambani, the organisation deployed a specialised veterinary team following a transfer order from Kerala's chief wildlife warden, P Pugazhendi.

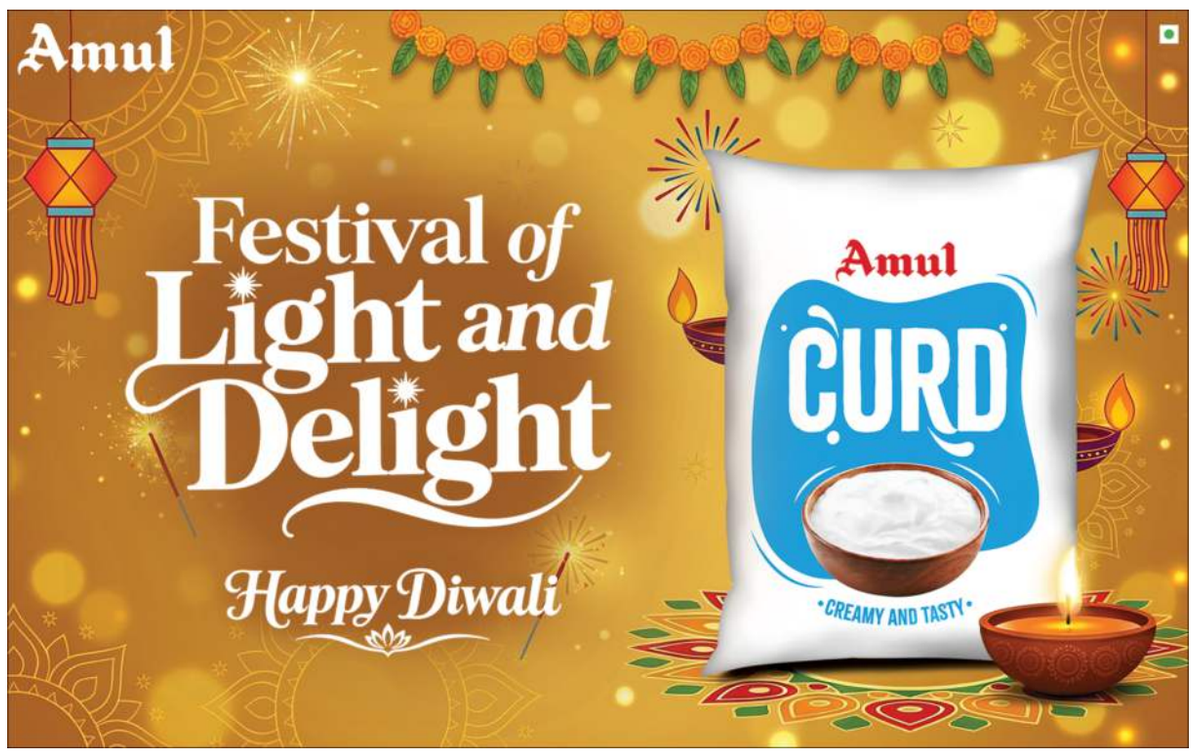
Found near Kaprikkad on Apr 19, 2025, the weak, dehydrated newborn had not received her mother's milk and couldn't even suckle. Assistant forest veterinary officer Binoy Babu and caregivers fed and nursed her for over a year.

RIL exec director Anant Ambani initiated the deployment of a specialised veterinary team to airlift elephant calf Maya to Vantara for treatment

In July 2026, Maya slipped while playing and injured her shoulder. Despite physiotherapy, splints & supplements, her bones became increasingly fragile. By Oct, she had front-leg fractures, a chest infection and pressure sores. Her prognosis was grave.

After Kerala's chief wildlife warden sought wider expert opinion, Vantara veterinary adviser Kushal Konwar Sarma identified a possible parathyroid-related disorder that may respond to treatment. Yaduraj Khadpekar, head veterinarian at Vantara's Elephant Care Centre, concurred, and the medical board unanimously agreed.

Maya travelled by a life-support airlift, accompanied by three Vantara elephant veterinarians, paravets and caregivers, along with Binoy C Babu and her familiar caregiver, Nikhil Babu. She will receive round-the-clock monitoring, pain management, advanced diagnostics, hydraulic lifting support and hydrotherapy where appropriate. Vantara — a global wildlife rescue, care, welfare and conservation initiative based in Jamnagar — will facilitate her return to Abhayaranyam after treatment.



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The fragrance edit for festive homes

Home & Living

A growing interest in niche and artisanal scents is inspiring homeowners to create a distinctive fragrance identity for their spaces

Anagha Sawant

As Diwali brings festive gatherings and entertaining, home fragrance is becoming essential for setting the mood. Alongside fine tableware, floral arrangements and curated décor, homeowners are exploring niche perfumery, distinctive scent compositions and sculptural fragrance objects to create a welcoming atmosphere. Moving beyond conventional room fresheners, the focus is on layering fragrances that reflect personal taste while adding a sensory edge to festivities.

"In Indian homes, fragrance has always been part of festive ritual – from incense in the *pooja* room to *ittar* on festive days. What's changing is how consumers are elevating that same instinct with more refined formats – sculptural candles, ceramic diffusers – without losing the warmth of tradition," says Priya Bhagi, Fine Fragrance Head at MANE and a fragrance expert.

> The shift towards more nuanced compositions is gaining ground. Globally, home fragrance is evolving along the same lines as fine perfumery, embracing smoky woods, resins and darker florals rather than one-dimensional scents
> – Priya Bhagi, fragrance expert

@diptyque

Home fragrances are becoming a reflection of personal taste, chosen to shape the mood and atmosphere of each space

> Scented candles can be used throughout the home to create an elegant ambience... Combined with the warm glow of crystal, they help create an environment that feels inviting and refined
> – Alexandrine Reille-Linyer, export director of a French luxury brand

Curating for every space

Entrance: Welcome guests with bergamot, orange blossom, mogra or white musk, layered with hints of spice.

Living room: Create warmth with amber, sandalwood, vanilla, saffron or oud.

Dining area: Opt for understated citrus and light florals that complement the menu.

Bedrooms: Choose soothing notes of iris, neroli, musk or sandalwood.

Outdoor spaces: Explore fresh woods and vetiver to complement the glow of *diyas*.

Live perfume bar: Offer guests a bespoke fragrance as a personalised keepsake.

(As suggested by Priya Bhagi, Rishi Chhabria and Husain Sabu)

Fragrance accessories doubling as décor

Home fragrance is becoming as much a design element as a sensory experience. The choice of vessel, material, finish and craftsmanship can turn fragrance objects into decorative accents that complement art and fine tableware. Neha Kataria, interior designer and creative director, The Right Address, says, "Muriel Ughetto's Scented Rolling Stones are an interesting example. Arranged in a tinted beechwood dish, semi-precious stones, lava stones and brass details become a decorative composition that also releases fragrance. Scented candles and diffusers can similarly sit alongside flowers and tableware, complementing a festive tablescape without competing with it."

Rishi Chhabria, fragrance architect and founder of Aerome, adds, "Consumers are moving beyond room fresheners, recognising scent as a luxury in its own right. The way a home smells is becoming as important as its architecture."

@baccarat

Presented in the iconic Louxor Votive, this Baccarat scented candle combines an exquisite fragrance with the artistry of crystal craftsmanship

Diwali's scent palette

Diwali's fragrance palette draws on familiar aromas of fresh flowers, sandalwood, incense and festive sweets. Rishi notes that jasmine, rose, white florals and saffron remain popular, finding new expression in nuanced compositions. He says, "Jasmine, for instance, doesn't always have to smell like traditional *mogra*. Paired with soft musk or fresh citrus notes, it can feel modern. Similarly, oud and amber can introduce depth and richness without overwhelming a space."

For intimate game nights, Arushi Agarwal, founder of Seva Home, recommends layering amber, musk and vetiver with gentle citrus or woody notes. "A Diwali games evening is about bringing people together. These notes create a cosy atmosphere, and add freshness," she says.

@muriel_ughetto

"Muriel Ughetto's fragrance collection offers varied scent profiles, from the woody warmth of Opale to the fresh citrus and floral notes of Améthyste," says Neha Kataria

Choosing the right format

Reed diffusers: Choose refined compositions and sculptural vessels for a subtle, continuous fragrance.

Scented candles: Opt for sophisticated notes and statement holders to create warmth during festive gatherings.

Incense: Try sandalwood, saffron and resin-based blends for traditional rituals.

Layering scents: Combine complementary notes to create a cohesive fragrance experience across different spaces.

(As suggested by Arushi Agarwal)

Setting the mood with scent

When thoughtfully coordinated with flowers, lighting, and décor, fragrance can shape the ambience. Recalling a recent celebration, Piyush Jhunjhunwala, founder of a wealth-management platform, says, "At our Diwali event, we focused on creating a warm atmosphere through natural aromas, floral arrangements and festive décor. Abundant flowers added freshness, complemented by the aroma of traditional sweets."

Event planner Husain Sabu recommends choosing scents that complement the setting. He says, "For marigold and mogra arrangements, I opt for soft notes of jasmine, sandalwood and rose. For contemporary settings with gold accents and candlelight, I prefer richer compositions of amber, oud and warm woods."

Emerging trends in home perfumery

Home fragrance is becoming an expression of personal taste and considered living, with niche scents shaping each room's identity. Neha Kataria says, "People are creating a progression of fragrances that gives each room its own identity while maintaining continuity. There is also greater appreciation for fragrance objects that combine sensory appeal with design, from scented candles and diffusers to Scented Rolling Stones."

This blend of perfumery and craftsmanship is evident in Baccarat's creations. Alexandrine Reille-Linyer, export director of Baccarat, says, "Our scented candle, presented in the iconic Louxor Votive, brings together fragrance and crystal craftsmanship. The creation contributes to a home's atmosphere while serving as a decorative accent."

WINDOW TO THE WORLD

@coperni

COPERNI BOWS OUT AS INDIE FASHION FACES A TOUGH SPELL

The luxury industry is facing a rough patch, and independent labels are feeling the strain. The latest to bow out is Coperni, whose founders Sébastien Meyer and Arnaud Vaillant have announced its closure after months of financial difficulties and a deadlock with majority shareholder Tomorrow Ltd. "Unfortunately, despite all our efforts, no solution could be found," the duo wrote in a statement to the press and retailers. Calling the label's journey "extraordinary", they said they were proud of what they had built. Known for technology-led experiments and unconventional runway shows, the designers staged a Disneyland Paris spectacle featuring Kylie Jenner in a princess gown and made headlines when Bella Hadid had a dress spray-painted onto her body in real time. The founders added that there was "still so much we want to explore and reinvent."

Coperni's closure comes amid a difficult period for independent French fashion. Charles de Vilmorin's eponymous label has entered judicial liquidation, while luxury womenswear brand Vaillant, founded by Alice Vaillant, is attempting to continue trading under court-supervised reorganisation proceedings, according to *Fashion Network*.

THE 2027 MET GALA THEME IS 'EXTRAORDINARY'

Bhavitha Mandava (in 2026) and A$AP Rocky (2023) seemingly dressed on theme before its reveal

Two months after facing backlash over its plan for a 2027 Met Gala exhibition centred on John Galliano, the Metropolitan Museum of Art has announced a new theme: extraORDINARY: Fashion and the Poetics of the Everyday. The exhibition will examine how designers transform everyday staples and commonplace materials into unexpected fashion statements, exploring the creative possibilities of jeans, T-shirts and puffer coats, as well as paper, plastic and metal.

The Costume Institute's lead curator Andrew Bolton told *Vogue* that he "didn't have a plan B". "It was really important to come up with an exhibition that wasn't just a masterwork show or something that we could do a little bit more easily," he said.

@dolcegabbana

Watches get a creative styling rethink

Anagha Sawant

Luxury watches are moving beyond the wrist to become statement accessories. From necklaces and belt details to bag charms and rings, designers are exploring new ways to incorporate timepieces into personal styling. This shift reflects a growing interest in individuality, with watches becoming as much about self-expression as functionality.

However, Richa Chopra, a luxury consumer behaviour expert, sees this as a fashion-led shift in how watches are worn. "Consumers are certainly becoming more experimental with how they style accessories, but I don't think anything will replace the classic wristwatch. What is interesting, though, is how brands are responding to this appetite for experimentation," she shares.

Dolce & Gabbana styles timepieces as statement belt accessories

> For younger consumers, watches offer a renewed appreciation for analogue objects in an increasingly digital world. Whether worn as a pendant, ring or bag accessory, they become a tactile expression of personal style rather than just timekeeping devices
> – Richa Chopra, luxury consumer behaviour expert

@louisvuitton

Louis Vuitton gives its Monterey watch a new look as a belt-loop accessory

Chanel's Coco Game necklace blends horology with high jewellery

@chanelofficial

Styling watches as accessories

- **Layer it**: Pair a delicate watch with gold chains to create an interesting necklace.
- **Add it to a bag**: Use a statement-dial watch as a charm to elevate the appeal of a simple handbag.
- **Stack it up**: Wear smaller timepieces with chunky bracelets for a layered look.
- **Experiment with placement**: Style a watch over sleeves for an unconventional approach.
- **Play with proportions**: Let the timepiece stand out as a conversation-starting accessory.

(As suggested by Niharika Jain, a fashion influencer)

@leatherlibraryy

A colourful Royal Pop timepiece adds a playful touch to a classic handbag as a bag charm

Make a statement without disrupting the look

Luxury houses are exploring new ways to wear watches beyond the wrist. At its men's SS27 show, Louis Vuitton styled ceramic Monterey watches as charms suspended from belt loops, while Dolce & Gabbana's men's AW26 collection featured vintage-inspired pocket watches worn at the waist as chain-detailed belt accents. For those looking to experiment, Niharika Jain, a fashion influencer, advises choosing distinctive silhouettes, dials, textures and finishes that complement their personal style. "A watch should make a statement while feeling cohesive with your outfit," she says.

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Pics: Karthikeyan Sairam; Location: Rangoli Gardens; Hair: Vinod Kumar BS; Costume Designer: MS Chaitrashree; Makeup: Reena Radhika; Jewellery: Kevali

VIKRAM RAVICHANDRAN

'Deepavali reminds us to hold on to the innocence of childhood'

For actor Vikram Ravichandran, Deepavali brings back childhood memories of crackers and family celebrations. Following their losses, the family paused Deepavali celebrations for over a decade. This year, they are coming together to celebrate again

P6

WHEN GLAMOUR MET STYLE

Manish Malhotra brought his signature glamour back to Lakmē Fashion Week, and the occasion called for a starry frame. Pictured (L-R) are Manish, Sara Ali Khan and Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer, Marketing and Sales, Maruti Suzuki India Limited, at the NEXA showcase

P3

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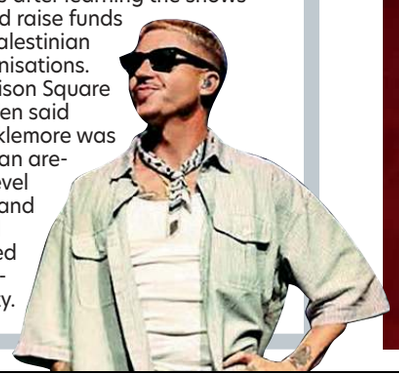
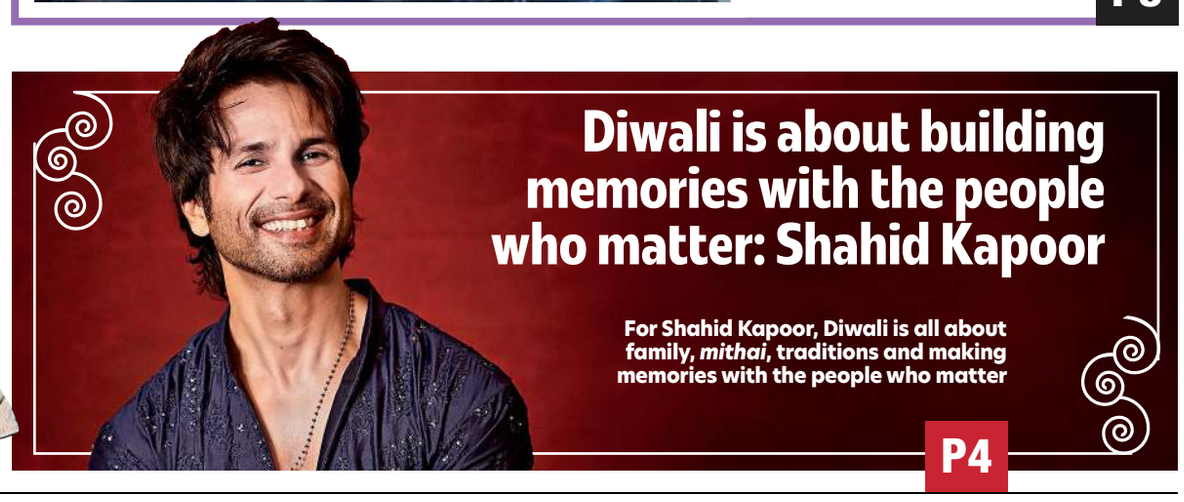
Buzzstop

MACKLEMORE'S BENEFIT TOUR FACES VENUE HURDLES IN US

American rapper **Macklemore** has said nine major US venues, including New York's Madison Square Garden and Los Angeles' Kia Forum, declined to host his Free Palestine benefit tour. He claimed the venues withdrew available dates after learning the shows would raise funds for Palestinian organisations. Madison Square Garden said Macklemore was "not an arena-level act" and cited limited availability.





Diwali is about building memories with the people who matter: Shahid Kapoor

For Shahid Kapoor, Diwali is all about family, *mithai*, traditions and making memories with the people who matter

P4

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You do not find the happy life. You make it - Camilla Eyring Kimball

YOUR POV

Here's what your point of view was to our POV

Nov 2: He is an artist, bro!

We want public figures to have a voice, but only as long as it echoes our own. If they speak, they risk criticism; if they remain silent, their intentions are questioned. Choosing to focus on one's craft should not be mistaken for indifference. Perhaps we need to stop expecting celebrities to validate our opinions and learn to appreciate them for their professional contributions instead.

– Anshul Nagpal, New Delhi

I agree with Diljit's stance. We often expect celebrities to have an opinion on every social issue forgetting that their primary identity is that of an artist. Disagreeing with someone's views should not mean dismissing their art or questioning their intentions. An artist deserves the same freedom to express create entertain and at times simply remain an artist without being dragged into every controversy.

– Lavanya Wadhwa

Nov 1: The party will find its own room

I fully agree with the writer's observation that a Diwali gathering should not become a performance review of our home interiors. Diwali is a sort of get-together in many families. Socialising skills of hosts and guests will be on full display during the celebration. Diwali certainly brings joy and light to households.

– S Ramakrishnasayee, Chennai

Nov 3: That time of the year when we all go nuts

There was a time when we valued relationships more than expensive dry-fruit hampers, expressing affection through handwritten greeting cards. Today, AI helps transform those sentiments into attractive digital posters. The medium has changed, but the spirit of remembering and nurturing relationships must remain unchanged... Our relationships are more valuable than hampers, wisdom is more enduring than wealth, and meaningful giving is greater than expensive gifting.

– Prof MM Goel, Delhi

Scan the QR code to check Your POV

Agree? Disagree? Got a POV idea?
Write to us at: pov@timesofindia.com

Champagne gold steals the festive style glow

Colour story

Team champagne gold with cream, chocolate or navy

Yellow gold is enjoying a fresh moment, but its softer side deserves the spotlight. Champagne, soft gold and warm beige bring a mellow glow to jewellery and wardrobes, making everyday dressing feel a little more special. For a restrained look, team champagne accents with cream, chocolate or navy, allowing texture to do the talking. Prefer a statement? Let one cuff or pendant lead. The styling sweet spot: warm tones, clean lines and considered shine.

Get the glow

Palette: Champagne • Soft gold • Warm beige
Try: Brushed hoops, a fine chain or one sculptural cuff
Pair with: Cream, chocolate brown or navy
Style cue: Give one standout piece room to shine

Would you bring champagne tones into your everyday wardrobe?

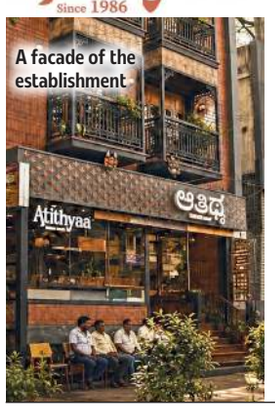
A festive spread to celebrate South Indian culinary traditions

WHAT'S HOT
IF IT'S HAPPENING, IT'S HERE.

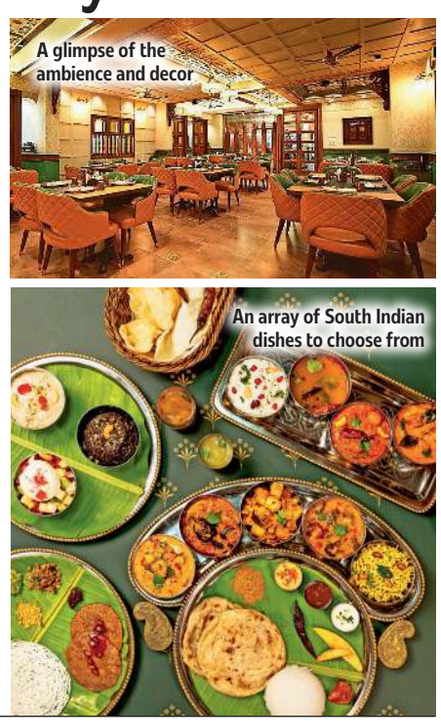
A traditional vegetarian feast takes centre stage at Atithyaa this Deepavali, with a special *bhojanam* featuring regional preparations and festive delicacies," says a spokesperson. They add, "The menu includes *Kharproli Dilsopu* Dose, Malabar Parota with *Kadale* Curry and *Chandra Hara* with Badami Halu." Located in Gandhi Bazaar, Atithyaa has welcomed guests since 1986, drawing on Bengaluru's culinary heritage and the philosophy of '*Atithi Devo Bhava*'. They add, "Sampradaya, our fine dining restaurant, serves regional specialities from all five South Indian states. We serve breakfast, lunch and dinner." Prathama and Dwitiya offer private dining spaces, while Mela, the Darshini, serves everyday favourites. Samudyatha hosts larger celebrations in its party hall. Atithyaa also offers 17 premium guest rooms, they share.

Visit: Atithyaa; 92, 93, Gandhi Bazaar, Main Road, Basavanagudi; **or call:** 70192 29605

Atithyaa® Since 1986



A facade of the establishment



A glimpse of the ambience and decor

An array of South Indian dishes to choose from

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Book **Anupam V Kapil** for appt/written predictions:
9822042295 or anupamvkapil@gmail.com.

See what the stars have in store for you – according to your moon sign.

ARIES

You might have an opportunity to network and make a great impression on a current or potential client. You're, like, really popular right now, but you still might experience some discontent with where you are in life. Your social calendar will be full in the week ahead.It's the best week for you to make amends. Set up a coffee date or just text a friend you feel like you're growing apart from. Rebuild those bridges.

TAURUS

There might be some anxiety around money, family or love. It doesn't mean that it's true, but it may come up. Whatever arises, choose to stay mindfully occupied, and know that you can trust that just as the contraction flowed in, it will flow out when it's time. You might feel fear, doubt, and as if you're being squeezed by grief or pain. Try to relax until the planets change course and you can move forward in a clear direction.

GEMINI

Not only will you seek out physical connections, but you'll probably also want some emotional connection. Be wary of relying on your own perception this week, especially when it comes to your social circle. This week may seem remote from that situation, but it has its part to play, as there is clearly someone or something to follow and be guided by.

CANCER

This is the kind of week when, if your personal birth chart agrees, you could sign a book deal or snap up a contract. In other cases, the outcome is less dramatic, but it will make a dazzling difference to your efforts to reach people, persuade them, or just engage and inform them. You can expect a milestone discussion, piece of news, signature or letter this week, and there will be more than one discussion to follow.

LEO

This is a period to analyse your cash flow, income, and earning power; make material concerns a priority as there may be some financial worries. You are more practical and rational in your approach to finances now. With your conscious mind focused on money and possessions, as well as personal values, this can be a strong period for gathering new money-making ideas.

VIRGO

There's nothing worse than your secret getting out and having to drop a friend because they're untrustworthy. Don't let a few awkward moments ruin your whole vibe. There's a great deal to be earned from the very things that pain you this week. Don't allow your ego to throw you off track. It's time for you to step up and take some risks.

LIBRA

You'll be happier if you fill your agenda with stuff that gets you moving, out and about. Don't turn down opportunities to socialise because you're tired or not in the mood, as people you meet in this month will turn out to be super beneficial to you down the road. It will feel good to get something off your chest this weekend.

SCORPIO

You know what you want this weekend, and now you just need to go about figuring out how to get it. Find a way to expand beyond your boundaries. Move forward with action. Flow freely, fueled by the force of your own motivation. Take on the challenges that you've been circling. Wherever there was hesitancy, there can be forward movement. But don't forget about care, compassion and open-hearted love. The passion in your horoscope this week is a great thing to share with somebody else, if you know what I mean.

SAGITTARIUS

This is a good week to make new friends. Your theme this week should be unbothered. Whatever life throws at you, whether it be an annoying email from your super or a misunderstanding with a friend, you'll just get it over with and move on. Your understanding of your spirituality, religion, or dedication can help you define your direction. Discover new beliefs through travel, reading, or some other kind of explorative journey.

CAPRICORN

To keep from stressing about money this week, try to centre yourself and get back in touch with nature. Just picture the most awkward conversation you could have at this point in your life and prepare for that. You have travelled far. Now it's time to rest. Settle in, make space, slow down. Mellowing out the pace will help you feel more secure. You'll need this space and time so that you can process any emotions that need to be processed.

AQUARIUS

Sometimes you hit a cycle when work, unpaid work or study becomes so much more. This is it. The next seven days are about your own ambition, status and success. You want true success; it's not enough to go through the motions. You've got to actually be a friend to yourself. If you get too fixated on your version of who and what you are, you'll stop exploring, asking questions, and growing.

PISCES

You can't save the world, but you can make improvements in your own life. Those improvements will have a greater impact than you can imagine. Nothing is meant to stay the same forever. Look into possibilities, even the ones that would require you to make sweeping changes. You're ready to see things as they really are, and from that place to better envision how they could be.

LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

	1					6		8
		4			5			
				2	6			1
5	6				7		2	
4								9
	7		2				3	5
7			5	4				
			7			3		
9		3					1	

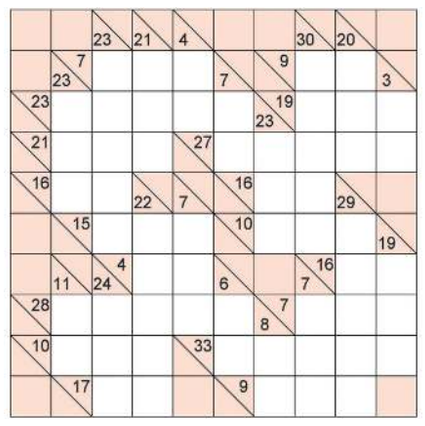
HOW TO PLAY

Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

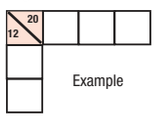
TIMES KAKURO

HOW TO PLAY

The numbers in the coloured squares refer to the sums of the digits that you must fill into the empty spaces directly below or to the right of the coloured square containing the number. For instance, in the given example, the 2 boxes below 12 must contain 2 digits that add upto 12, whereas for 20, the 3 boxes placed horizontally next to it must add upto 20. No zeroes are used here, only the digits one through nine.



Note: A digit cannot appear more than once in any particular digit combination. For instance in the example, we cannot have the combination of 8+4+8 for 20.



EVENTS

WORKSHOP

Holige Making: Learn how to make Karnataka delicacy holige or obattu at Kamat Restaurant in Whitefield on November 8 from 5 pm onwards.

Diya And Mandala Painting: Paint and decorate handmade clay diyas or learn how to make mandalas at Fabrizo - Creativity Hub in BTM Layout on November 8 from 11:30 am onwards.

Email us at bangalore.times@timesofindia.com

SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
01-average | 02-good | 03-outstanding

How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

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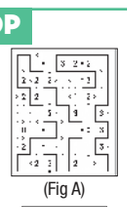
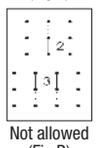
LOOP THE LOOP

RULES

- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)



Not allowed (Fig B)

HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

RRZAO

DNUOT

AEUVDL

IRSYFK

HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

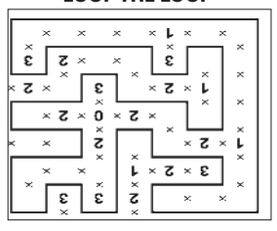
Good __ ends with good ___
- Geoffery Neighbor (4,,,4)

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

7	1	4	2	8	6	5	3	9
3	5	2	1	9	7	4	6	8
6	8	9	3	4	5	1	2	7
5	3	8	6	4	2	9	7	1
9	6	7	8	5	1	3	4	2
4	2	1	7	9	3	8	5	6
8	4	6	9	7	3	2	1	5
1	9	5	4	2	8	6	7	3
2	7	3	5	6	4	7	9	8

LOOP THE LOOP



TIMES KAKURO

SPELLATHON

grey, gyre, SYNERGY

SCRAMBLE

Words: Razor, donut, valued, frisky
Answer: Good food ends with good talk
- Geoffery Neighbor

Automotive elegance meets contemporary glamour on the ramp

From Manish Malhotra's much-awaited Luxury Prêt collection to fresh creative expressions at NEXA Spotlight, the runway recently celebrated glamour, individuality and the power of design

Diana Penty

Manish Malhotra's return to Lakmē Fashion Week after three years added to the buzz around the NEXA showcase. The designer presented Luxury Prêt 2026 at the event, held in partnership with FDCI, marking his return to the fashion week platform. Alongside the collection, NEXA Spotlight gave emerging designers Linetribe_ by Gaurav Jagtiani and Richa Khemka an opportunity to present their work on the runway, bringing two distinct yet complementary fashion moments to the event.

Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer, Marketing and Sales, Maruti Suzuki India Limited, said, "What a wonderful celebration of creativity! From Manish's signature glamour to the fresh ideas of our NEXA Spotlight designers, both showcases were truly inspiring. Congratulations to all the designers. We're delighted to collaborate with such incredible talent and celebrate the spirit of design that is expressive, distinctive and truly individual."

BRINGING A NEW MOOD TO GLAMOUR

At Luxury Prêt 2026, Manish's signature aesthetic took centre stage, with Sara Ali Khan and Ayushmann Khurrana as showstoppers. The collection explored the changing approach to dressing up, blending Indian craftsmanship with a contemporary, effortless style.

The mood was expressive and individual, reflecting a generation that likes to make a statement on its own terms. It also echoed the "Dare to Go Glam" spirit of NEXA's Stunning New Baleno, highlighting how personal style is expressed not only through clothing but also through everyday design choices.

EMERGING DESIGNERS SHINE ON THE RUNWAY

Alongside Manish's showcase, NEXA Spotlight gave promising designers an opportunity to present their creative perspectives. The initiative invites budding designers to compete for a chance to showcase their collections on the Lakmē Fashion Week runway.

This season, Linetribe_ by **Gaurav Jagtiani** and **Richa Khemka** presented their interpretations of The Unseen, with **Diana Penty** as the showstopper. Their collections explored stories, perspectives and creative expressions that often remain beyond immediate view.

The contrast made for an interesting fashion narrative: one showcase featured a designer with an instantly recognisable signature style, while the other gave emerging voices space to experiment and gain visibility.

From Manish's contemporary take on glamour to the creative expressions of emerging designers, the two showcases highlighted different dimensions of design. For NEXA, the collaboration brought distinct perspectives to one platform, reinforcing its association with fashion and contemporary lifestyle.

Ayushmann Khurrana and Sara Ali Khan walked as showstoppers for Manish Malhotra

(L-R) Sunil Sethi, Chairman, FDCI, Diana Penty, Richa Khemka, Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer, Marketing and Sales, Maruti Suzuki India Limited, Sakshi Sindwani and Gaurav Jagtiani

UP TO DATE

WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

Diljit Dosanjh to bring Punjabi music to Latin Grammys

Punjabi music is set to take centre stage at the 27th Latin Grammy Awards, with Diljit Dosanjh joining the star-studded performer lineup. The ceremony will take place on November 12, 2026, at the MGM Grand Garden Arena in Las Vegas. According to *PTI*, the *Lover* singer will share the stage with international music stars, including Karol G, Bizarrap, Daddy Yankee, and Rosalía. Diljit's team celebrated the announcement by commenting, "Punjabi AA Gaye Grammy Oye," on the Latin Recording Academy's Instagram post. His appearance is also expected to spotlight the growing global popularity of regional Indian music and introduce Punjabi sounds to a wider audience. Dosanjh is currently touring India as part of his Aura India Tour, with an Indore performance scheduled for November 15.

Sourav Ganguly's name in Doosra must come with a disclaimer, says Delhi HC

The Delhi High Court on Friday has directed the makers of *Doosra* to add a disclaimer at the beginning and end of the film, stating that Sourav Ganguly did not consent to the use of his name, according to *LiveLaw*. The notice must appear in English and Hindi, in large font, within two days. Justice Tejas Karia said the film could remain available to viewers, as removing selected scenes was not a workable option. The order came in an interim plea by Ganguly and Luv Films, which allege the film uses his identity and achievements without authorisation. The court found a prima facie case that his persona had been used to generate commercial interest and ordered the filmmakers to provide a ₹2-crore bank guarantee. The court clarified that its order does not decide the merits of the suit.

HOT TAKES

Prince Harry, Meghan to highlight online risks for children at Brussels

Prince Harry and Meghan Markle

Prince Harry and Meghan Markle are set to speak about the dangers children face on social media at an event in Brussels. The Duke and Duchess of Sussex will attend the opening of The Lost Screen Memorial at the European Parliament on November 10. The installation honours children who have lost their lives due to harm experienced online.

According to *AFP*, the couple will deliver a joint speech before joining a panel discussion with international activists. The event, hosted by Spanish MEP Antonio Lopez-Isturiz, aims to highlight the "urgent need to make the digital world safer for every child".

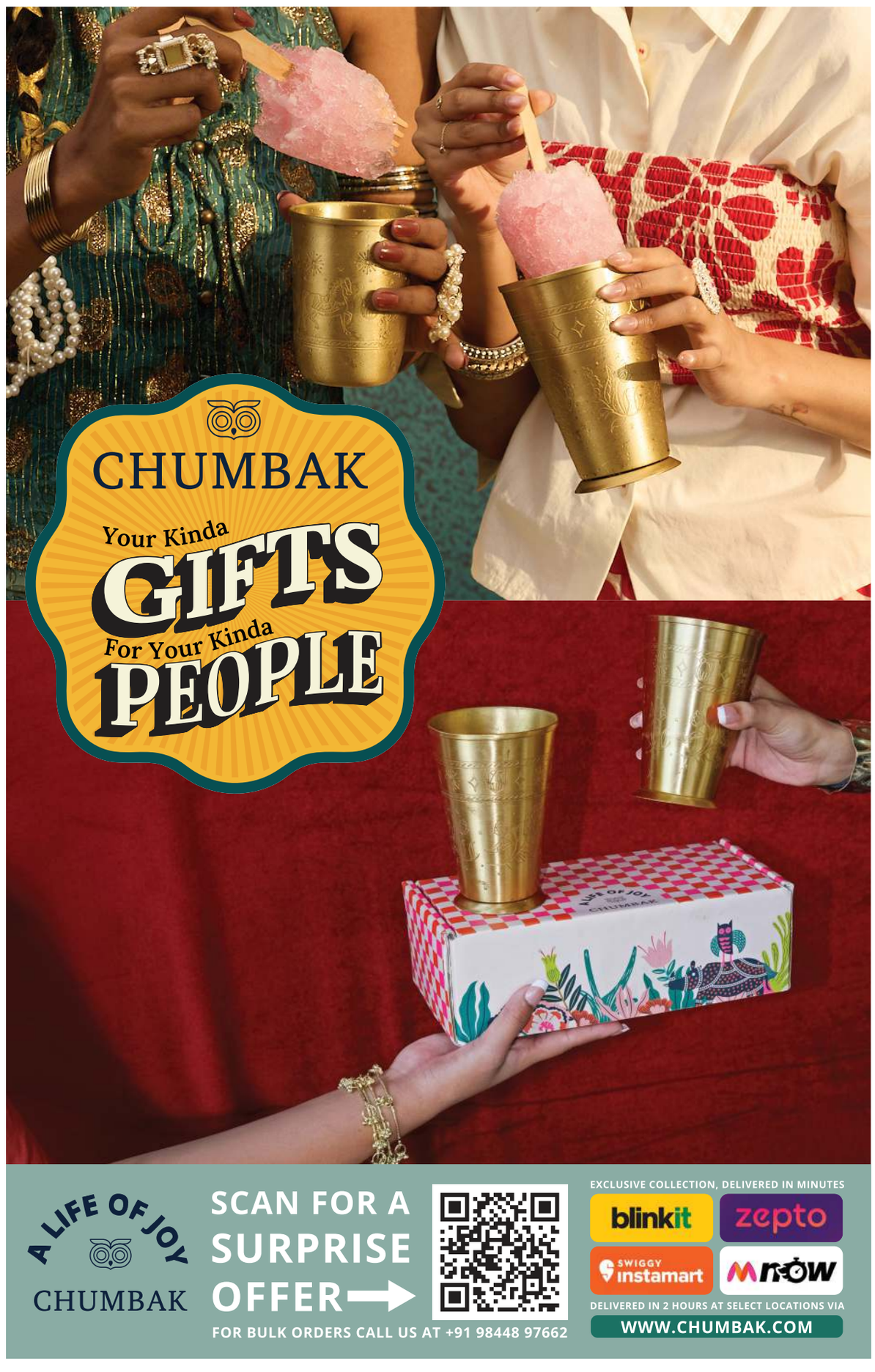
It will be Meghan's first public appearance since reports emerged that police in the Philippines had found child sexual abuse material on devices at the former home of her estranged father, Thomas Markle.

The installation features 50 enlarged images of children who died following online harm. It was previously displayed in New York, Los Angeles and Geneva.

— Agencies

Delhi HC protects Kriti's personality rights

The Delhi High Court has granted interim protection to Kriti Sanon against the alleged misuse of her identity through AI-generated content, sexually explicit deepfakes and fake accounts, reports *Live Law*. The court directed the removal of identified objectionable URLs and restrained defendants from creating or circulating similar material, including morphed images, videos, audio and impersonation content. The court clarified that its observations were preliminary. The matter will be heard next on Dec 10.



THIS DEEPAVALI, LET THERE BE LIGHT

Can Bengaluru celebrate without the noise?

Jyotsna Basotia

Actor Dia Mirza didn't expect a political storm to erupt from a short video. But her pollution-awareness message has triggered a nationwide debate on a cracker-free Deepavali. The city has been given a two-hour window for bursting crackers, but residents are asking whether celebration should come at the cost of those who cannot escape the noise.

Pet parents and environmentalists are urging the city to embrace a more mindful Deepavali — one where the glow of diyas outshines the din, and the festivities bring joy without causing distress.

Images generated from AI; for representational purpose only

A greener Diwali: Celebrating without fireworks

The frustration in local residents about bursting firecrackers is evident on online forums. A Kumaraswamy Layout resident, posting on Reddit, described people bursting *bijli* crackers while walking down a residential road at 11 pm, followed by another minute-long burst nearby.

"I find it appalling that people can be so inconsiderate," the user wrote, adding that no amount of police patrolling would help curb the practice. For some, the cost of green crackers is another deterrent. Another user complained about paying ₹400 for a packet of phooljharis, while another said they preferred spending the money on sweets, fairy lights and gifts instead of crackers.

The cost of a loud night

Raghav Joshi, a 25-year-old charter pilot, says his three-year-old Great Dane, Master Obi Wan, is "terrified" of firecrackers. "It always breaks my heart. It seems like it takes years of life off him to live through it," he says, and adds, "They pretend to like it because it is an established tradition," he says. Urban strategist Vinod Jacob calls for substantial fines and, where legally permissible, imprisonment for repeat offenders. "We must strictly protect the hours between 10 pm and 6 am from firecracker noise, with particular consideration for seniors, children, animals and neurodivergent people. Responsible celebration means respecting everyone's right to peace, well-being and clean air."

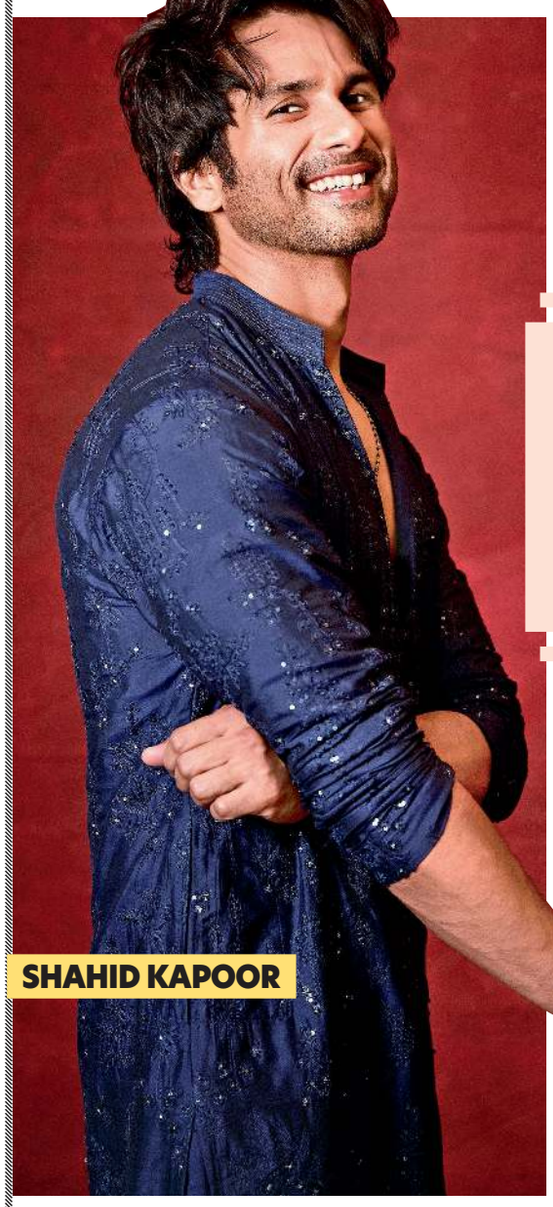
A little less boom for pets, elders and sensitive ears

Sudden, loud bursts can leave pets trembling, hiding or on high alert. For senior citizens, noise and smoke can disrupt sleep and aggravate breathing difficulties. Neurodivergent children and adults can also find the sensory overload distressing. "My pets' favourite time of day is the evening on the balcony, except during Deepavali. They get anxious and flinch at every nearby cracker burst," says a psychology student. Closing the windows to keep out the smoke and noise, he says, "does little good".

8 PM TO 10 PM: BENGALURU'S CRACKER WINDOW

The Karnataka government has restricted firecracker bursting to 8 pm-10 pm during Deepavali, in line with Supreme Court guidelines on noise and air pollution. "This will be the only period during which bursting of crackers will be permitted," shares Forest, Environment and Ecology Minister Ramalinga Reddy.

We all need to celebrate the festival responsibly, says Shahid



SHAHID KAPOOR

Vinay MR Mishra

For Shahid Kapoor, Diwali is less about elaborate celebrations and more about the simple joys of being surrounded by loved ones. In a conversation with us, Shahid opens up about his childhood Diwali memories, family traditions and why he believes celebrations must come with a sense of social responsibility.

'FESTIVALS ALLOWS YOU TO CONNECT WITH EACH OTHER AND REMEMBER WHAT YOU STAND FOR'

> When your life flashes before your eyes, I think a lot of it will eventually be the moments you spend with the people who matter, and the high points in your life where you felt most fulfilled and loved. Festivals are about that

The actor says, "The best part about this year's Diwali is that we have so many plans that we haven't picked one yet. But eventually, Diwali is about tradition, family and building memories together. It will be with our closest people. There are small traditions in the family that we follow, which will always be with our parents and the larger family. For me, festivals are always about paying homage to the kind of value systems that have come down in your family. They are opportunities to connect with each other and remember what you stand for."

'WE HAVE A SOCIAL DUTY TO CELEBRATE THE FESTIVAL RESPONSIBLY'

With concerns around air pollution and government advisories urging people to exercise caution while bursting firecrackers, Shahid believes that celebrations must also be mindful of the environment. "There is a social responsibility that we have and I think we all need to exercise it. It's a very personal thing. I don't think you can decide how anyone else should or shouldn't celebrate a festival. But whenever there is a government advisory, it's usually keeping in mind the climatic conditions and the amount of pollution that we have to deal with. So, of course, you keep these things to a minimum and find healthier ways to celebrate. We all need to celebrate the festival responsibly," he shares.

> I sweat it out throughout the year, so it is fine to indulge in sweets during Diwali. It's good to train hard, but what do you train for if you can't enjoy yourself once in a while? I do have a sweet tooth, so when I get a chance, I go for it

'These are moments to pause, enjoy life and soak it all in'

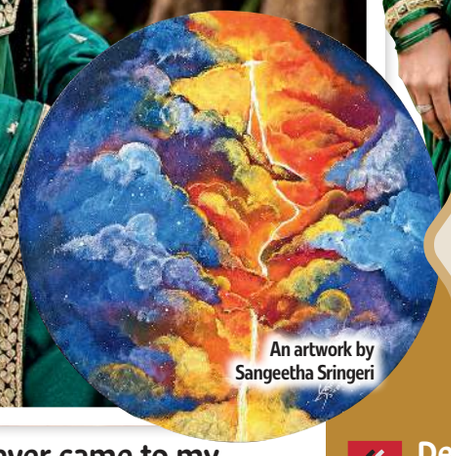
Shahid believes that festivals are about the feelings and memories they leave you with. "These are moments to pause, enjoy life, let it soak in and focus on those simple things that will probably stay with you till the end of your life. When your life flashes before your eyes, I think a lot of it will eventually be the moments you spend with the people who matter, and the high points in your life where you felt most fulfilled and loved. Festivals are about that," he says.

BEYOND THE DEEPAVALI SPLURGE: FESTIVE SHOPPING WITH A PURPOSE

Yemen S

Deepavali is a good excuse to shop, but the trick is to look beyond one-time purchases. Whether it's a versatile outfit, a home makeover, a new gadget or a thoughtful gift, choose things that offer value long after the festivities. Here are ways to make your festive shopping count.

Sangeetha Sringeri



An artwork by Sangeetha Sringeri

Shop for a new hobby

Use the festive season to invest in an interest you've been meaning too pursue. A camera, musical instrument, fitness equipment, art supplies or a collection of books could be the beginning of something new.

"I simply painted whatever came to my heart and thoroughly enjoyed the process. I feel creativity is the opposite of anxiety, and I need to channel my energy into something meaningful. I created a painting titled A Flow of Hope, depicting how even beyond the darkest clouds, there is always light – Sangeetha Sringeri

Anusha Rai

Give your home a festive makeover

Refresh your living spaces with statement lamps, brass accents, cushions, rugs, pottery and tableware that work beyond Diwali.

"Deepavali is about creating a warm, happy and positive atmosphere at home. I love decorating with diyas, glowing lights and grand floral arrangements. I like keeping the traditional essence alive and add a touch of elegance and grandeur – Anusha Rai

A festive makeover of your home can light up the mood for everyone

Upgrade your everyday gadgets

If a new smartphone, smartwatch, pair of headphones or home appliance is on your wishlist, festive sales offer an opportunity to compare options and deals. Pick technology that serves a purpose and fits your lifestyle.

Invest in versatile festive fashion

Choose outfits that can be styled for different occasions rather than worn just once. A statement kurta, classic saree, embellished jacket or contemporary ethnic ensemble can become a wardrobe staple.

"I like investing in statement accessories, multi-coloured and embellished jackets, and skirts that can be paired with simple everyday outfits. These can be styled differently and worn on multiple occasions – Ragini Dwivedi

Ragini Dwivedi

A statement necklace

Make gifting personal

Skip predictable hampers and choose gifts that reflect the recipient's interests. Curated books, customised accessories, artisanal products, gourmet treats and experience vouchers can make for more thoughtful presents.

Nail art based on the theme of Deepavali

Invest in beauty and grooming

Festive gatherings are a good reason to upgrade your beauty routine. A signature fragrance, quality skincare, makeup essentials or haircare products that suit your needs can be worthwhile additions.

Discover and support homegrown brands

Explore independent designers, local fashion labels, handmade jewellery, artisanal décor and homegrown beauty brands. Bengaluru has plenty of homegrown labels offering distinctive finds for those looking beyond mainstream shopping.

Handmade wooden showpieces for gifting

Leave room for little indulgences

Not every purchase needs to be practical. A statement handbag, a pair of shoes, a piece of jewellery, a luxury fragrance or even a favourite dessert can make for a satisfying festive treat. Set aside a budget for the things you simply want.

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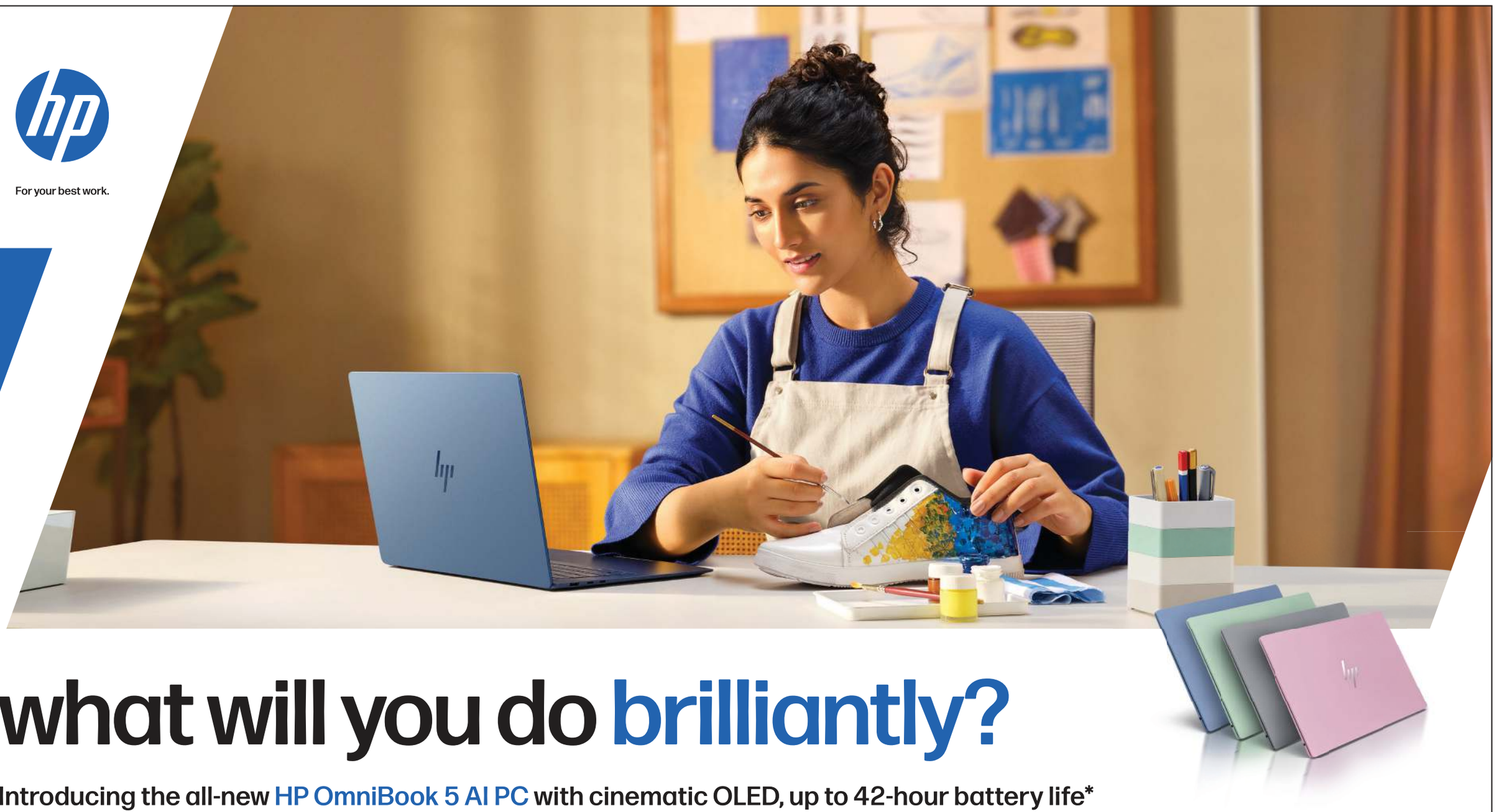

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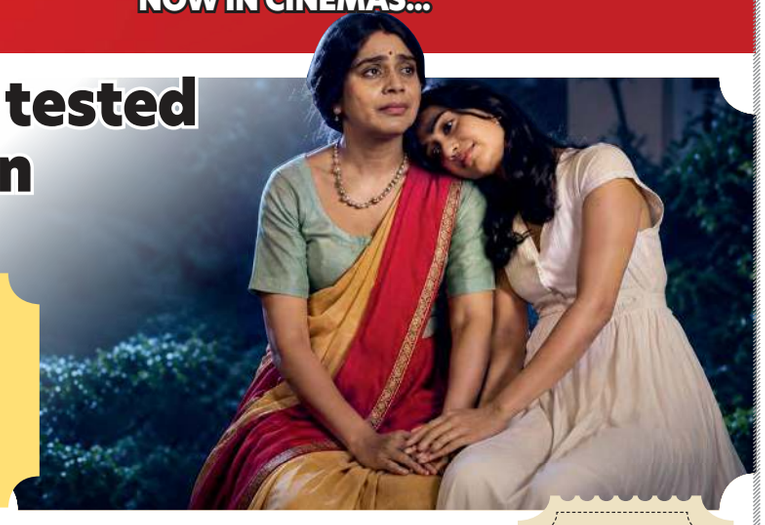
The sincere wish to be good is half the battle - Louisa May Alcott

FILM REVIEWS
NOW IN CINEMAS...

A relationship tested by the question of acceptance



BHAVANTARA
(Drama) ★★★
Cast: Karthik Sharma, Tanvi Rao, Pranav Sridhar, Shree Vaishnav
Director: Karthik Sharma
Duration: 1hr 42mins
Language: Kannada (A)

Review in short

Bhavantara is an intense drama that explores the complexities of acceptance through the story of a filmmaker who unexpectedly reunites with her transgender former lover at the Koovagam festival. As she struggles to reconcile her past relationship with her former partner's identity, the film examines the challenges of acceptance within personal relationships. It also sheds light on the emotional and social struggles of transgender women, including acceptance and support even among those closest to them and limited livelihood opportunities. The detailed portrayal of the Koovagam festival adds cultural and mythological context to the narrative. While compelling in its subject and central conflict, the film's slow-paced initial portions and generic sequences occasionally affect engagement. Nevertheless, it makes a thought-provoking statement on acceptance and identity.

– Susmita Sameera

Should you watch it?

Worth watching for its realistic portrayal of the journey towards acceptance and the emotional challenges that come with it.

Pics: Karthikeyan Sairam; Location: Rangoli Gardens; Hair: Vinod Kumar BS; Costume Designer: MS Chaitrashree; Makeup: Reena Radhika; Jewellery: Kevali

VIKRAM RAVICHANDRAN

'After a decade, we are celebrating Deepavali at home again'

Kavya Christopher

For actor Vikram Ravichandran, Deepavali has always been associated with childhood memories of crackers, family gatherings and three days of celebrations with cousins. However, the festival has also carried a sense of loss for his family. Having lost his grandmother and an aunt during this season, the family stopped celebrating the festival for more than a decade. This year, they are getting together to celebrate again, making it a particularly meaningful occasion.

The return to celebrations is about more than just reviving old traditions, according to Vikram. It is also about finding some light in life. "You might be going through a tough phase, but celebrating Deepavali can be a refreshing break. There is something about the festival that makes you feel like a child again. It reminds me that some innocence still exists within me," he says. He believes this is perhaps the festival's most important message. "Deepavali should remind us that we were once children and that we still have that child within us. We should look at life with some innocence rather than too much maturity."

Vikram also feels that today's generation is dealing with an unprecedented amount of pressure, particularly when it comes to careers. Being the son of actor V Ravichandran brings its own set of expectations, but he is quick to point out that being from a film family does not guarantee success. "My father probably had the opportunity to do 10 to 15 films to prove himself. Today, I feel I have to prove myself in one film. Even if I don't put that burden on myself, it impacts my career because I may not get a second chance to show that I can improve," he says.

"Being a responsible actor also means being accountable for a film's commercial performance, while constantly working on my craft. Improving yourself is something you have to do until the end. Every day, I am going to learn something new. I don't want to be someone who gives one hit and moves on. I want to be associated with 100 films, provided I have the talent and strength to get there," shares Vikram. Away from work pressures, some of Vikram's fondest Deepawali memories revolve around family rituals and food. When it comes to festive food, his mother's cooking is non-negotiable. "Whatever my mother prepares, I have to taste. I am not much of an outside-food person. My favourite is *kadubu*. I can easily eat 30 to 40 in one sitting!" he laughs.

> I don't particularly enjoy serious films. I'd love to do the kind of films that youngsters like me can relate to, while also communicating something meaningful

On the professional front, Vikram is looking at a gradual but steady expansion of his career. His film *Mudhol* is completed and is expected to release in 2027, with two more projects in the pipeline. He is also looking at the possibility of directing a film, either towards the end of next year or in 2028. Having learnt the importance of patience, he is no longer looking at success through the lens of instant gratification. "Life is not like a 29-second reel that reaches two million people. It is a slow, patient process," he says.

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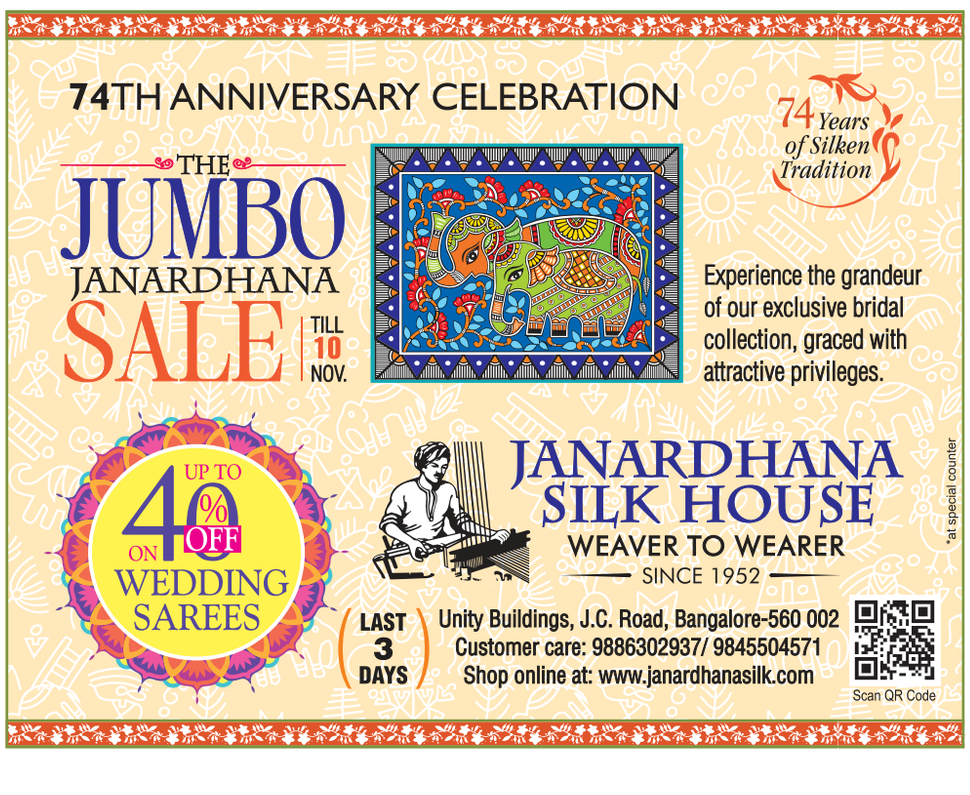

EVENTS AND EXHIBITIONS TIMES interact Connecting People, Connecting Needs.

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Did You Know?

Heath Ledger improvised the Joker's slow clap

In *The Dark Knight* (2008), the Joker's slow clap while imprisoned was an improvised moment by Heath Ledger. The gesture perfectly captured the character's mocking attitude. The scene takes place when Gordon is promoted to acting police commissioner, and the Joker responds with a sarcastic, unhurried applause from behind bars.

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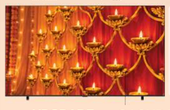
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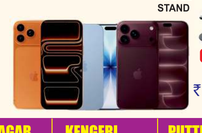

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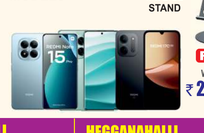

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